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EYE

Virtually A Winner

Esports is no longer a fad. It's here to stay and do the victory lap with scores of fans behind it — as seen in Paris during the Esports World Cup

SCREEN

Actor-dancer Shobana on making Bharatanatyam accessible by adapting the classical dance to newer formats

DAILY FROM: AHMEDABAD, CHANDIGARH, DELHI, JAIPUR, KOLKATA, LUCKNOW, MUMBAI, NAGPUR, PATNA, PUNE, VADODARA

MODI BACK IN SRCC AFTER HIS 'GLASS FULL OF WATER AND AIR' ANALOGY BEFORE 2014 POLLS

Opp can't digest India growth, look at 2013 and now, PM tells students

Promises another 'upswing', attacks critics for being 'negative' on road to development

Vikas Pathak & Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, September 5

RETURNING TO the Shri Ram College of Commerce in New Delhi Saturday, 13 years after his "glass full of water and air" analogy delivered a strong message of optimism and possibilities in the run-up to the 2014 Lok Sabha elections, Prime Minister Narendra Modi targeted the Opposition, calling it the "naaraaz fufa" (the sullen, angry uncle) with a negative mindset. He said the Opposition was in the habit of questioning every government move to take the country forward, even the growth numbers.

In 2013, Modi was Chief Minister of Gujarat and the prospective BJP candidate for Prime Minister.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

PM Narendra Modi interacts with children on the Metro while on his way to Shri Ram College of Commerce in New Delhi, Saturday. PTI

FRAMES PAST VS PRESENT AND FUTURE

Gen Z nod: OG, *naaraaz fufa* (angry uncle), *Dhurandhar*, 'your seniors couldn't dream'

Vikas Pathak & Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, September 5

IN FEBRUARY 2013, this was the venue where he spoke as the challenger, foreshadowing the "Modi wave" at the tail end of a sputtering UPA government. Almost 13 years later, Narendra Modi returned to Shri Ram College of Commerce Saturday as a third-term Prime Minister in the wake of unprecedented student protests in the capital that forced his government's hand and led to the resignation of the Union Education Minister.

His framing, therefore, was clear. He was reaching out to students at SRCC, a highly selective college, a generation that will be first-time Lok Sabha voters in 2029 but were barely in school in 2013. He was also addressing the disgruntled young who, through their protests, have put under a cloud his party's dominance over all rivals for the first time since he won in 2014.

Modi underlined this: he told

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

JHIRAM GHATI ATTACK KILLED 27 PEOPLE

13 yrs after Maoist ambush killed top Cong leaders in Chhattisgarh, 10 convicted

Sentencing on Sept 16; some top Maoists listed as accused have since surrendered

Jayprakash S Naidu
Raipur, September 5

THIRTEEN YEARS after a Maoist attack in Bastar's Jhiram Ghati killed 27 people and nearly wiped out the Chhattisgarh Congress leadership, a special National Investigation Agency (NIA) court in Jagdalpur Saturday convicted 10 accused in the case. They will be sentenced on September 16.

An eleventh accused died during trial while another 28, named in the chargesheet as accused, have been listed as wanted.

The 10 who have been convicted are Pramila Modiyam, Chaitu Lekam alias Munna, Sumita alias Punem Modiyam, Mukka Mandvi, Kosa Kavasi alias Kosaram, Aayata Markam, Madkami Deva, Joga Madkami, Banjami Sanna alias Chamru and Mahadev Nag.

Among the prominent Maoists chargesheeted in the

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Outside the NIA special court at Jagdalpur in Chhattisgarh's Bastar district on Saturday. ANI VIDEO GRAB

Jhiram Ghati attack, a turning point in battle inside Red Corridor

Deeptiman Tiwary
New Delhi, September 5

THE MASSACRE in Chhattisgarh's Jhiram Ghati on May 25, 2013 was among the most audacious attacks carried out by Maoists. While there had been attacks with higher casualties — the 2010 Tadmetla attack, for instance, killed 76 CRPF personnel — Jhiram Ghati had a different impact. For the first time, Maoists had virtually wiped out an entire generation of a state's political leadership in one strike.

Among those killed were then Chhattisgarh Congress president Nand Kumar Patel and his son Dinesh, former Leader of Opposition Mahendra Karma, former Union Minister Vidya Charan Shukla and former MLA Uday Mudliyar.

The attack came at a crucial

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Channi-Warring feud: Pilot replaces Baghel as Congress in-charge of poll-bound Punjab

Asad Rehman & Man Aman Singh Chhina
New Delhi, Chandigarh, September 5

Bhupesh Baghel; Sachin Pilot

AFTER WEEKS of infighting in Punjab Congress, the party high command on Saturday replaced Bhupesh Baghel as the All India Congress Committee's (AICC) state in-charge and brought in Sachin Pilot.

Sources in the party claimed that former Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Baghel's standing in the state unit was damaged by allegations that he was "favouring" state Congress President Amrinder Singh Raja Warring who is locked in a feud with former CM and Jalandhar MP Charanjit Singh Channi. Channi wants to replace Warring as the Punjab Congress president in the run-up to next year's Assembly elections and has rebuffed Baghel's attempts to mediate a truce.

"The state unit will be pleased with this change as a neutral person, Sachin Pilot, has been given the responsibility now. He can start work from scratch and listen to all sides," said a senior Congress MP from Punjab.

Baghel who has been

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

President Droupadi Murmu pays tribute to former President Dr Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan, whose birth anniversary is celebrated as Teachers' Day, at Rashtrapati Bhavan, Saturday. PTI

REPORTS, PAGE 6

Honouring teachers

PRESIDENT DROUPADI Murmu felicitated 82 teachers and educators at the National Teachers' Award ceremony at Rashtrapati Bhavan, Saturday.

THESE INCLUDED 48 teachers from the Department of School Education and Literacy, 21 teachers or faculty members from higher educational institutions and polytechnics, and 13 trainers from the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship.

POLITICS PAGE 5

EAM JAISHANKAR PAYS TRIBUTE AT MEMORIALS IN WARSAW

EXPRESS special

LETTER SENT AFTER GSLV LAUNCH FRIDAY

ISRO staff question trajectory of space privatisation, want chief to clarify

IN-SPACe head Pawan Goenka's remarks that ISRO will not manufacture launch vehicles spark concerns, employees say

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, September 5

KEY EMPLOYEE associations at the Indian Space Research Organisation have written to ISRO chairperson V Narayanan, questioning the direction of the agency's privatisation drive and its implications for the existing workforce and the agency's future role.

The letter, obtained by *The Indian Express*, was sent Friday, just hours after ISRO successfully launched an earth observation satellite aboard a GSLV rocket following a months-long hiatus.

Even as ISRO continues to deliver on its core missions, the letter showed that questions are mounting within about what role it will play as private players take on a growing share of the country's space activities.

At the centre of the controversy are remarks made on August 21, at a Business Today event, by Pawan Goenka, chairperson of the Indian National Space Promotion and Authorization Centre (IN-SPACe), the nodal body, under the Department of Space, announced by the Prime Minister in 2020 to open India's space sector to private participation.

Said Goenka, who also chairs the board of governors at IIT Madras: "Eventually, ISRO will not manufacture any launch vehicles, that will be

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Happening today

- **UNION HOME HOME** Minister Amit Shah, who is in Goa on a three-day visit, will chair a meeting to review matters related to the state across various divisions of the Ministry of Home Affairs.
- **AS THE IRAN** war continues to disrupt oil exports through the Strait of Hormuz, seven core members of the oil-producing alliance OPEC+, including Saudi Arabia and Russia, will meet to discuss their output policy.

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Jharkhand: BJP BLA held over 200 forms to delete minority voters, gets bail

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, September 5

A BOOTH Level Agent (BLA) of the BJP in Jharkhand's Godda district was arrested following an FIR accusing him of submitting around 200 Form 7 applications seeking deletion of voters' names, as part of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise in the state. The BLA, Vinay Kumar Mandal, is now out on bail.

The complainant and the Booth Level Officer (BLO), of Booth No. 231 of Pachrukhi village in Godda block, have both submitted that all the applications by Mandal were in the name of voters belonging to the minority community. Among the voters whose names were

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EXPRESS investigation

Jharkhand SIR faceoff: BJP agents seek to delete voters, BLOs raise red flag

The *Express* report dated Sept 2 on submission of forms by BJP BLAs against voters in Godda

After NCLT flip-flop, CBI books Chandra in Rs 1,322-cr LIC case

LICHFL alleged loss linked to two loan facilities granted in 2018 and allegedly secured by Chandra's personal guarantees

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 5

THE CENTRAL Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has registered an FIR against Zee founder and Essel Group chairman Subhash Chandra, several companies and their directors for allegedly inflating his net worth to avail of loans from Life Insurance Corporation Housing Finance Ltd (LICHFL). The loans subsequently turned into defaults, causing a loss of over Rs 1,322 crore to the public sector lender.

The FIR, registered by the CBI's Banking Securities Fraud Branch on August 31, is based on a written complaint by Neeta Menghani, general manager of LICHFL.

In the FIR, LICHFL has alleged wrongful loss of over Rs 1,322 crore, plus interest and

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

• Lenders' exposure

HDFC Bank	₹775 cr
LIC Housing	₹1,322 cr
IndusInd	₹240 cr
Canara Bank	₹348 cr
Union Bank	₹164 cr
RBL Bank	₹119 cr
Franklin Templeton	₹729 cr
Edelweiss	₹565 cr

• CURRICULUM DEVELOPED IN COLLABORATION WITH NGO BREAKTHROUGH AND THE ABDUL LATIF JAMEEL POVERTY ACTION LAB

Fighter jet as gift, Razia Sultan story: On gender bias, Punjab textbooks turn new page

Divya Goyal Gopal
Ludhiana, September 5

WHAT SIDHAK wants is a kitchen set. All her friends have one, and when her "*Daarji*", who's cooking in the kitchen, ignores her, she gets petulant. "*Daarji* just doesn't care," she says. Instead, her grandfather asks her to watch the Republic Day parade.

Reluctantly, Sidhak watches it and sees a woman fighter pilot salute the national flag. "How big are these? Can I also fly them?" Sidhak asks, just as her grandfather intended. She forgets all about the kitchen set and instead gets a miniature fighter jet as a "gift".

PAGE 1 anchor

The story, titled 'A Gift for Sidhak', is part of the Class 7 curriculum in Punjab government schools and the state government's campaign to buck gender stereotypes and redefine gender roles. Five years after the Punjab Education Department collaborated with the NGO Breakthrough and Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab South Asia (J-PAL) in 2021 to integrate 'Gender Sensitisation' into the regular curriculum, the change is visible on the pages.

From explaining how gifting kitchen sets to girls and cars or aeroplanes to boys can influence gender roles to highlighting women previously relegated to the margins of history, the new curriculum is aimed at one thing: understanding, questioning and countering gender biases from a very young age. These changes have been made in phases for the past three years, most recently in this academic session.

These efforts are particularly visible in the English and social studies curriculum — from stories such as 'A Gift for Sidhak' to viewing important historical figures such as Razia Sultan and Nur Jahan through a different lens.

The efforts are not just for students but also for teachers,

A story in the Class 7 English textbook talks about a girl who chooses a fighter jet as a gift instead of a kitchen set. EXPRESS

Sunita Prabhakar, component head for the Gender Sensitisation curriculum of the Punjab Education Department, tells *The Indian Express*.

"The teaching material or books alone can't bring the change. We have trained teachers on how to convey such lessons in the classrooms. The curriculum now also includes stories on how families should support women's career ambitions and men should also participate in household chores," she says.

Bucking gender norms

The books that saw the most changes belong to Classes 6 to 8, although some topics are also covered in Classes 9 to 12.

In the Class 6 English textbook, a chapter called 'A Forgotten Wish' explains how married women too can take care of their parents, and that they are not a "burden or a stranger". In it, Khwahish, a married woman, is keen to care for her "*bebe*" (mother), although the latter believes that married women belong in their husbands' homes. That changes when *bebe* falls ill, and her son cannot travel back from abroad.

It's Khwahish who takes over — she's the one who gets her mother's eye surgery done, and she's the one who cares for her.

A chapter from the Class 8 English book helps students understand the opportunities some married women lose because of rigid social norms. The chapter, called 'Smashing the Glass Ceiling', tells the story of Paramjeet, the daughter of a house help, and Geet, at whose house Paramjeet's mother worked. By the time they meet again after 25 years, their lives have taken diametrically opposite courses: Geet, a well-qualified woman with a master's degree, is a homemaker whose family doesn't approve of her working, while the less-educated Paramjeet has her own computer business and is now a confident woman.

The story, which ends with Geet seeking work from Paramjeet, sets the tone right at the outset. "People generally think women can't have their own businesses, but excellence and talent are not based on gender. Even if a girl is highly educated, she is only expected to take care of family," the chapter says. "They have to work harder to prove their worth."

Sunita Prabhakar of the Punjab Education Department explains why lessons like this

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PM

Addressing the SRCC centenary celebrations Saturday, Modi drew a comparison between the situation now and the condition of the country in 2013 when the UPA II was faltering. He asked the students to go to the internet and look up India's condition in 2013.

"A gang these days will cut this into small pieces," he said, adding that he was focusing on what the media reported then. The killing of Indian soldiers at the Line of Control, the downgrading of the GDP numbers by the World Bank, and a helicopter scam were in the news at that time.

"These things tell us about the situation of the country at that time. Growth was down on the ground and inflation was sky high. The world talked about policy paralysis in India and counted it among the 'fragile five' economies, but now views it as the fastest-growing major economy," Modi said.

He sought to suggest that while he had discussed his vision of national development at the SRCC in 2013 and chosen not to vent his anger against the then UPA government, he had fulfilled that vision in 12 years. He promised another "upswing", a developed India in 2047 for which, he said, students should prepare, so that they can prove that India is second to none in the world.

He attacked the Opposition and his critics for questioning his government, calling them the "naaraaz fufa", forever negative and for being "Dimaagi Naxals".

"The 7.8% growth has enthused the country. This comes at a time when a war is on in West Asia. This shows India's capability. But those known for pushing India into the fragile five cannot digest these figures," Modi said, referring to the latest row over the GDP numbers released by the government.

Insinuating that his critics belonged to a bygone era and were compulsively negative about the prospects of the country, he said, "Lekin Bharat ne aisi saare fufaaon ko jawaab diya (the country has given all such uncles a reply)."

The country, he said, had gathered new speed on the path to development. "Today the country is much safer in economic and social terms than in 2013," he said, adding that some people were displeased with this.

"From the Red Fort, I had spoken about such people. That I gave them a homoeopathic dose which initially makes the disease seem more intense. That dose was the Dimaagi Naxal. It first intensifies the disease and then treats it." All the 'Dimaagi Naxals', he said, began emerging immediately, and the people were now seeing their true colours.

Modi said there were many crises in the last six years, from Covid to wars, and many said the country wouldn't survive. "My 'prashansaks' (sarcastically referring to his critics as admirers) were happy that 'Ab to Modi phansaa, ab to Modi giraa, ab to use kuchal hi denge (now Modi is caught, now he is going to fall, now we will crush him)," he said, adding that the "blessings" of his countrymen was so strong that the desires of those who didn't wish India well were collapsing.

"We are proud that Indians are leading top companies in the world. So, why should companies made by Indians not lead the world... All this is possible," he said.

Modi recalled that in his 2013 speech at the college, people expected that he would attack the then Congress-led government. Despite being in the Opposition and a critic of the government, he said he did not use this stage to attack it.

He said he offered a vision and spoke with conviction. He recalled he had said a "half-filled glass of water can be viewed in three ways: some see it as half-full, some as half-empty, and some full to the brim with water and air". "India is growing and providing new avenues for employment," Modi said, adding that for the "naysayers, the glass had been half-empty since 2013", and would remain so.

"I had spoken about pro-people, good governance here in 2013. Those in power earlier woke up only during crises. I have changed this approach and have proved it since 2014," he said.

At the outset, the PM recalled that SRCC's journey began in Delhi's Daryaganj area and the institute had now become "huge" giving "generations of students the opportunity to learn, grow, and make a difference". "In your language, the alumni from here are OG. They have spread the name of SRCC across the world," he said.

Gen Z nod

the SRCC students that they were too young at that time to know the crises that had gripped the country then urging them to check the news headlines from those days. He blended two messages. One, his 13 years had translated into better governance making progress on a range of issues and, two, those who were critical of him were out of sync with this young generation — they were the *naaraaz fufa* (angry uncle), he said, the source of all negativism.

In this, he was trying to distance the student protesters who were severely critical of him — he "forgave" them in an earlier message — from those who have always been arrayed against him. By calling them angry uncles, he tried to show that he wasn't fazed by their attack, they were an irritant that had got triggered, he said, when he used "dimagi Naxal" in his Red Fort address.

Speaking to the students, he invoked Gen Z phrases as he recalled that he had talked to their seniors about his vision — using the Gen Z term OG (original gangster, used for the older ones among the Gen Z); how he had refrained from criticising the government of that day.

He urged the students to prepare themselves to scale new peaks as India prepared to become a developed country by 2047. "In your language, the alumni from here are OG. They have spread the name of SRCC across the world," the PM said.

He made a reference to the recent hit *Dhurandhar* while referring to the college and its alumni: "*Dhurandhar na ho, lekin dhoom to machayi hai* (you might not be *Dhurandhar*, but must create a splash)."

He recalled his former colleague Arun Jaitley, an alumnus of SRCC who kept intact his bonds with his alma mater till his last days. "Our Arun Jaitley ji studied here, and I can say that perhaps there was no meeting of ours in which he did not narrate some incident of SRCC. Sometimes, I would get tired because he used to tell the same incident again and again...there are people in my team and my other colleagues who studied from here... It is not that only people from the world of economics have emerged from here but artists to leaders, lawyers to judges, everyone has come out from here, meaning the people of SRCC have made their mark in every field," the PM said.

"I am happy that you are ambitious, because ambition cannot be taught by any coaching...Ambition comes from an environment that inspires you to dream big. Today a young person says, If I do something of my own, I will begin a startup. If I build a company, I will make it a unicorn. If I connect with sectors such as space and drones, I will do something big. I will build cutting-edge AI solutions. I will bring innovation to agriculture," Modi said.

He said that 13 years ago, "your seniors could not have such dreams". But today, he went on, "you are dreaming these dreams also because today's India has also created an ecosystem that supports those dreams". He added that now was the time to set big goals and achieve them.

From internal security to terror, economy to global relations, he kept going back to 2013 to claim the "distance" travelled. "Friends, that was a day when there was struggle, struggle on every front in the country and this is today. Today, those spreading terrorism are on the backfoot. If Pakistan does any nefarious activity, India's forces enter their home and strike...from Jammu and Kashmir to the Northeast, peace has been restored. The backbone of Maoist terrorism and Naxalism has been broken. The world that was worried about policy paralysis in India then, today that world is discussing India's policy dynamism..."

He continued in this vein to reinforce his past versus present theme. "Remember, when you were perhaps still in school, when the Kedarnath disaster happened in 2013, the entire government was surrounded by the crisis. They could not understand what to do, how to do it. In 2008, when the banking crisis came, the government at that time had tried to bend before that crisis in 2007. It did not even have the courage to touch it. The entire banking system of India was brought to the brink of collapse. In 2008 itself, there was a horrific terrorist attack in Mumbai. The government at that time came under pressure from outside and did not even have the courage to teach Pakistan a lesson," he said.

Chandra

charges, in relation to two loan facilities granted in 2018 and secured by personal guarantees allegedly executed by Chandra.

Apart from Chandra, the accused named in the FIR include: Vasant Sagar Properties Pvt Ltd, its director Pankaj Suroliya; Pan India Infrastructure Pvt Ltd; Digital Subscriber Management and Consultancy Services Pvt Ltd, its director Amish Pandya; Spirit Infra Power; Multi Ventures Pvt Ltd and its director Rajeev Dholakia, besides unknown public servants and others.

This FIR comes days after the NCLT constituted a Special Bench to hear the personal insolvency proceedings involving Chandra, after its August 25 order approving a repayment plan under which creditors would receive only about Rs 6.25 crore against guarantees of around Rs 22,000 crore signed by Chandra. Chandra has questioned the validity of the order before NCLAT.

Banks and other creditors had questioned the NCLT plan. Banks pointed out that at least five entities—which held 61.78% of the votes cast and backed the repayment plan—were linked to Chandra.

The personal insolvency proceedings against Chandra were initiated in 2024 after a petition by Indiabulls Housing Finance and relate to personal guarantees by Chandra for borrowings of Essel Group-linked companies. After the NCLT's August 25 order, the creditors also pointed to the sharp contrast between Chandra's historical financial standing and the assets disclosed during the insolvency process. Creditors pointed to net-worth certificates issued in 2017 and 2018 showing figures of about Rs 45,888 crore and Rs 40,562 crore, respectively. Against that, the insolvency process recorded Chandra's current assets at roughly Rs 31.79 crore.

Textbooks

are important, especially in government schools. "Since more of the government school children come from underprivileged backgrounds, their career choices are also narrow and biased. Girls think that at best, they can be teachers or nurses. We are trying to change this," she says.

Among the most significant changes in the textbooks is how students are being taught to view history — and the women in it. The books have highlighted the roles of Razia Sultan, the Sultan of the Delhi Sultanate from 1236 until 1240, and Nur Jahan, the chief consort of Mughal emperor Jahangir and widely considered the real power behind the Mughal throne.

Nur Jahan wasn't just Jahangir's "wife", and Razia Sultan was not just Sultan Shams ud-Din Iltutmish's "daughter", the chapters say. "What was the cause of Razia Sultana's murder?" an activity-based question at the end of a chapter on Razia — Delhi's first and only female Muslim ruler — asks.

The chapter answers the question too: "She was killed because men did not want to obey and follow a woman leader. The Army Generals did not want to spend their life under a woman. Razia Sultana was the first female Muslim ruler. She trained in military warfare since childhood, wore clothes that didn't show her gender and discarded the veil, which shocked the conservative society... People believe that men are natural leaders and women have to work much harder to get into governance and politics..."

Rashmi Dwivedi, the state head for the project from the NGO Breakthrough, says: "We are working on changing children's aspirations... The focus now is not on whose daughter or wife these great women were, but on the identities that they scripted," she says.

ISRO staff

done by the private sector or PSU. They will not do any day in day out kind of satellites. They will do the satellites that are for special purpose, for orbits for scientific research or to develop new technology that will then get transferred to the private sector."

The employee associations argue that these statements were never followed by any formal communication from the Department of Space explaining the policy, its legal basis, its timeline, or its impact on current staff and future recruitment.

Signed by representatives from across ISRO's centres, including the Space Applications Centre and the Liquid Propulsion Systems Centre, the letter asks the chairperson to issue a "written clarification" on whether Goenka's statements represent an "approved decision" of the government of India, space commission, or the department of space.

The letter raises several specific concerns: what ISRO's future role as a public organisation will look like, whether PSUs will also be excluded from manufacturing work, what safeguards exist for current employees, and how publicly funded technologies are being transferred to private companies. It also asks whether employee associations will be consulted before any "irreversible decision" affecting the agency's structure, mandate, or staffing is finalised.

Despite calls and messages, neither Goenka nor Narayanan were available for comment.

The associations describe the activities referenced by Goenka as ISRO's "core competence," warning that withdrawing from them threatens the organisation's long-term viability. Employees who built their careers around ISRO's stability and public character, the letter says, now face uncertainty, and shrinking recruitment — already limited by vacancies and attrition — will discourage talented young professionals who see ISRO as a respected public-sector career path.

Since the space sector was opened to private participation in 2020, the government's stated approach has been for ISRO to mentor emerging companies, gradually shifting routine work to them while ISRO focuses on missions of scientific and strategic significance. The letter notes that ISRO has already transferred around 120 technologies to industry, including the Small Satellite Launch Vehicle and the PSLV. Separately, the new spaceport being developed at Kulasekharapatnam is expected to focus on small satellite launches, a segment where private capability is already fairly advanced.

The dispute is likely to fuel broader debate over ISRO's future direction.

Ajay Lele, Deputy Director General at the Manohar Parrikar Institute for Defence Studies and Analyses, said the sector's opening up was overdue and could have helped India capture a larger share of the global market sooner. With ISRO now focused on major undertakings like Gaganyaan, the Bharatiya Antariksh Station, and a crewed lunar mission, he said some functions would naturally shift to private players — but cautioned that launch services and vehicle development remain core to ISRO's mandate.

"The situation should not be like NASA, where they are completely dependent on SpaceX for their launches," he said. "ISRO should remain capable of launching some of its own satellites, especially the strategic ones."

BJP BLA

allegedly sought to be deleted from the booth were the BLO, Sajida Bibi, and her husband.

The FIR was registered at Godda Muffasil Police Station on September 3 against Mandal — identified as 'BLA 2' — under Sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita dealing with forgery and "intentional insult intended to provoke breach of peace", and Section 31 of the Representation of the People Act, which covers "false declaration" during preparation of electoral rolls.

The complainant, Mukarram Ansari, is also among the voters of Booth No. 231 against whom Form 7 was allegedly submitted by Mandal. In his complaint, Ansari said that all the voters against whom Form 7s were submitted by Mandal are genuine voters.

Ansari told *The Indian Express* that Mandal submitted around 200 Form 7s, all relating to voters of Booth No. 231, to the BLO, Sajida Bibi. "When we came to know that our names could be deleted through these forms, we informed senior officials," he said.

According to Ansari, Mandal was subsequently asked to come to the village and questioned about the forms. Mandal reportedly said the forms had been given to him after a meeting of BJP BLAs.

Sajida Bibi confirmed that Mandal had brought around 200 Form 7 applications to her on August 29. The BLO said Mandal handed the forms to her husband, and sought that these be signed and he be given a receipt for the same. She refused to sign as she first wanted to verify the forms, Bibi said.

"I later checked and found they were all Form 7s. There were many names, including my own and my husband's," she said, adding that all the forms related to Muslim voters.

BLOs are employees of the state government, which is currently headed by a JMM-Congress coalition.

Godda Muffasil Police Station Inspector Anand Sah confirmed that a case was registered on the basis of the complaint, and Mandal was arrested on Thursday, and released on bail hours later.

Vinay Mandal told *The Indian Express* that he had gone to submit the Form 7s to the BLO after he was told to do so, and that Bibi initially agreed to receive the forms and give him a receipt. He was called to Pachrukhi village by Bibi to collect the same on Thursday, Mandal said. "But I was surrounded by several people and beaten up," he said, adding that he was kept forcibly from 9.30 am to 1.30 pm, and that a villager intervened to stop the assault.

Asked whether he knew that Form 7 was used to seek deletion of a voter's name from the electoral roll, Mandal said he knew the form could be used to raise a claim or objection before a BLO, and that the BLO would verify the details before taking any action.

While he also admitted that the around 200 forms he deposited had largely Muslim voters, Vinay Mandal said similar forms had been submitted by a BLA in his own village, which he described as predominantly Hindu.

Congress district general secretary Akbar Ali, who took up the matter, said that on hearing about the bulk Form 7s, he visited Bibi's residence. Local residents then decided to call Mandal and question him, Ali said. "After we called him, police and block officials also reached the spot. The villagers then filed the complaint."

An investigation by *The Indian Express* earlier showed mass submission of forms by BJP BLAs against voters in Godda district's Maheshtikri block, a majority of them belonging to the minority community, with the BLOs of at least four booths refusing to accept the forms and registering a complaint. Subsequently, the District Election Officer ordered a probe into the submission of the forms.

Jharkhand Chief Electoral Officer K Ravi Kumar told *The Indian Express* that BLOs could not refuse to accept the forms, and that any deletion on the basis of Form 7 happens only after a probe.

Former Godda BJP MLA Amit Mandal said the party's BLA, Vinay Mandal, had been "wrongfully held hostage" by some people, and alleged that there was threat of a lynching-like incident.

The BJP leader also claimed the hand of the RJD in the incident, adding: "They did all this wrongfully and forcefully, but despite this what is the result?... No one could even touch my BLA. I got my BLA out on bail." The RJD is part of the ruling coalition in Jharkhand.

In the last Assembly elections, in 2024, Amit Mandal lost to Sanjay Prasad Yadav of the RJD from the Godda Assembly seat.

Yadav's son Rajnish slammed Amit Mandal, saying: "Does he know the meaning of mob lynching? No one harmed his BLA." The whole incident was rather of "stealing and then acting brazenly", the RJD leader said.

Baghel

appointed the AICC's Assam in-charge expressed "gratitude to the top leadership for this new responsibility". "Congratulations also to all newly appointed General Secretaries / State In-Charges ... Thanks to all Congress worker comrades and leaders of Punjab for their cooperation," he said.

Channi was quick to thank the high command for the reshuffle, saying, "A warm welcome to Shri Sachin Pilot Ji on his appointment as General Secretary In-charge of Punjab Congress. Heartfelt thanks to the Congress Party High Command for this important decision."

Even as he welcomed the change, Warring praised Baghel, calling him a "guide and mentor". He said Baghel's guidance has been instrumental in strengthening the party at the grassroots level. "Personally, I have learnt a lot from him and will always remain indebted to him," he said. Warring said Pilot's "energy and dynamism" would add to the "vigour of the party" ahead of the elections.

The Leader of the Opposition in Punjab, Partap Singh Bajwa, welcomed the appointment of Pilot. "Heartiest welcome to Shri @SachinPilot, General Secretary in-charge of Punjab Congress. Looking forward to working together to strengthen the organisation and take the Congress forward in Punjab," Bajwa wrote on X.

A leader close to Channi blamed Baghel's "partisan role" for his "ouster". "It has come as a big relief for us. He failed to read the pulse of the people as well as the Congress cadre. We repeatedly told him that a change was required, but he refused to listen to reason. We are now quite certain that Warring would be replaced in days to come and the Congress can finally get down to fight the coming Assembly polls," he said.

Gurdaspur MP Sukhjinder Singh Randhawa, the AICC in charge of Rajasthan, also congratulated Pilot, posting on X, "His experience, leadership and connect with the people will give new strength and momentum to the Congress organisation in Punjab. Best wishes for a successful tenure ahead."

A section of the party, however, claimed that the change was part of a "routine reshuffle" and not an attempt to address any disquiet in the state unit.

NIA court convicts 10

case but shown as wanted accused are Thippiri Tirupathi alias Devuji, a CPI (Maoist) politburo member who surrendered in Telangana in February this year; Barse Deva, who succeeded Madvi Hidma as commander of the PLGA Battalion 1, and surrendered in January this year; and Ganesh Uikey, a CPI (Maoist) central committee member who was killed in a December 2025 encounter in Odisha.

NIA judge Ajay Singh Rajput convicted the accused and the court will announce the sentences on September 16. Confirming this, Arvind Choudhary, the defence counsel for eight accused, said, "The quantum of punishment will be declared on September 16. Once we get the order, we will go through it and will decide on approaching the High Court against it."

In first remarks on the court order, former Chhattisgarh Chief Minister and Congress leader Bhupesh Baghel said, "It feels like this is incomplete justice." He alleged that the NIA removed the names of top Maoist leaders from the FIR. He questioned why the alleged political conspiracy angle was never probed.

(News agency ANI quoted Chhattisgarh Deputy Chief Minister Vijay Sharma saying that the court decision validated the NIA investigation. "When the case was given to the NIA for investigation, the UPA government was in power at the Centre. It was their government. In the state of Chhattisgarh, there was a BJP government. The BJP government immediately transferred the case to the NIA within two days so that no one would have any doubts," he said.)

The Jhiram Ghati attack took place on May 25, 2013, when over 150 Maoists ambushed a Congress Parivartan Rally convoy and killed several people, including Mahendra Karma, who was instrumental in founding the banned anti-Maoist militia Salwa Judum; state Congress chief Nand Kumar Patel and his son Dinesh; and senior leader and former MLA Uday Mudliyar.

According to investigators, the attack near the inter-district border of Bastar and Sukma districts was primarily aimed at Karma.

According to the NIA chargesheet, the attack was meticulously planned as part of the banned CPI (Maoist)'s Tactical Counter Offensive Campaign (TCOC). Maoist commanders conspired during meetings in early 2013 to target "class enemies", specifically targeting Karma.

The Maoists triggered a landmine blast beneath a red Bolero vehicle, creating a 5-foot-deep crater and blocking the road with a stalled truck. Surrounding hilltops were used to rain indiscriminate gunfire and throw grenades on the trapped 20-vehicle convoy for nearly two hours.

The 27 people killed included 10 security personnel. Police records show that the Maoists also looted a 9 mm pistol with two magazines and 20 rounds, two AK-47 rifles with 14 magazines and 455 rounds, 10 hand grenades and communication sets.

The NIA took over the investigation two days after the attack. On September 25, 2014, it filed a chargesheet against nine arrested accused before the NIA Special Court in Jagdalpur.

On September 28, 2015, it filed a supplementary chargesheet against another 30 accused. A total of 11 accused were arrested in the case but one of them died during trial. At least 28 more accused who were chargesheeted are wanted in the case.

The trial lasted more than a decade, with at least 294 hearings. After final arguments were completed this month, the NIA court delivered its judgment Saturday.

Jhiram Ghati

point in the evolution of the counter-Maoist strategy and, according to security establishment officials involved in operations in Bastar at that time, ended up reinforcing rather than disrupting that strategy.

By then, the Centre had already begun mounting sustained pressure on the Maoists. In 2006, Prime Minister Manmohan Singh had described Maoist violence as the country's biggest internal security threat. When P Chidambaram became Union Home Minister in 2008, the government's resolve to tackle the insurgency had hardened.

The strategy that emerged was broadly described as "clear, hold and develop". Security forces would enter Maoist strongholds, push them out, establish camps to hold the territory and allow the civil administration to follow with roads, schools, hospitals and other infrastructure.

In Bastar, however, this was a slow and difficult process. In early 2013, security forces had set up a camp at Minapa in Sukma. It was a sign that security forces were beginning to move into the Maoist core areas. The Maoists were increasingly being forced into battles inside territory they had traditionally dominated.

It was against this backdrop that Jhiram Ghati took place.

"The Jhiram Ghati massacre was planned as a way to disrupt this forward march by rattling the political establishment. But it only solidified the resolve as the Centre was now convinced that the strategy of setting up bases inside Maoist core areas was right," said a senior security establishment officer who was in Chhattisgarh then.

The attack also had a particularly symbolic target in Mahendra Karma, who had been closely associated with Salwa Judum, the controversial anti-Maoist mobilisation launched in 2005 in which tribal civilians were armed and organised to fight Maoists.

In 2011, the Supreme Court restrained the state from continuing the practice of arming tribal youth as Special Police Officers to fight the insurgents, effectively striking down the model.

The Jhiram Ghati incident also exposed another weakness in the "clear, hold and develop" approach: the state's security footprint was expanding faster than its administrative footprint.

Security camps could be established deep inside the forests, but roads and communications often did not follow. In 2022, the CRPF said 331 km of roads sanctioned in the Sukma-Bijapur-Dantewada region in 2010 remained only about 50 per cent complete. Some projects sanctioned in 2012 had barely progressed.

"The Jhiram Ghati attack quickened the pace. It convinced the political class that they too could come under attack and so the matter was taken more seriously," another security establishment officer said.

There were also more immediate operational lessons. One was the need for night evacuation. Helicopters had earlier generally not flown into these areas at night because of the difficult terrain and poor visibility. But following the Jhiram Ghati attack, the victims were evacuated through the night. Security forces subsequently pushed for similar capabilities for their own personnel, and night sorties gradually became routine.

The larger transformation, however, came later.

A senior CRPF officer said the campaign acquired a sharper momentum after Amit Shah took charge as Union Home Minister in 2019. "He took keen interest in injecting pace. The Maoists were already fighting a losing battle, but he wanted to make their defeat decisive and quick. He would personally speak to Chief Ministers and state police, extend full support to the Central forces and give them a free hand in dealing with Maoist violence. He personally drove coordination between the Central and state forces and the civil administration," the officer said.

The results of that sustained strategy are now visible. More than 15,000 km of roads have been built to take security forces into forested interiors, over 9,000 mobile towers have been installed and nearly 200 new security camps have come up in core Maoist areas. Left Wing Extremist-related incidents and deaths have fallen by more than four-fifths since 2010.

While Jhiram Ghati was not the beginning of the end of Maoist violence, the incident was a turning point in the political understanding of the conflict. The attack demonstrated that Maoists could retaliate spectacularly when the state pushed into their core areas. But instead of forcing the state to retreat, it convinced the political establishment that retreat was no longer an option.

Second day in row, Delhi, Gurgaon see massive waterlogging after heavy rain

Express News Service
New Delhi, Gurgaon, September 5

Commuters wade through knee-deep water in Sangam Vihar in Delhi as heavy rain lashed several parts of city, including Anand Vihar (below). PRAVEEN KHANNA

DELHI AND GURGAON saw massive waterlogging for the second day in a row as heavy rain lashed the neighbouring cities on Saturday. In Gurgaon, where rain has brought life to a halt several times this monsoon, the district administration urged people to avoid "non-essential travel" and steer clear of waterlogged roads, underpasses, and low-lying areas. Delhi Traffic Police too cautioned motorists against stopping vehicles or parking on waterlogged stretches, underpasses and under bridges.

The civic administration in both the cities stepped up efforts to clear waterlogging as commuters complained of traffic snarls. In Delhi, Safdarjung, the Capital's base station, recorded 29.88 mm of rainfall between 8.30 am and 5:30 pm, according to the India Meteorological Department (IMD). Chhattarpur saw the highest rainfall at 39.5 mm, followed by Palam recording 35.6 mm during the same period. Gurgaon and Noida reported 27 mm and 22.5 mm, respectively, during the same period.

Delhi CM's surprise checks

A day after the Capital saw waterlogging at the Indira Gandhi International Airport and on the arterial routes of the city, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Saturday conducted a surprise inspection of waterlogged areas near Sadbhavna Park in East Delhi. "She directed officials to immediately deploy pumps and other necessary resources in waterlogged areas and ensure swift clearance of accumulated water," the Chief Minister's Office said in a statement.

The downpour left the National Highway-48 between Indira Gandhi International Airport and Dhaula Kuan inundated.

Traffic movement was also hit in several other areas, including Dwarka and Najafgarh-Nangloi.

This comes at a time when the city is preparing to host the two-day BRICS Summit, starting September 12 and preparations and rehearsals are underway.

Upscale Gurgaon goes under, again

Even as Gurgaon saw a lighter spell of rain on Friday, the civic gaps were laid bare yet again following heavy showers on Saturday. Massive waterlogging was witnessed in the upscale Mayfield Gardens in Sector 51. Several trees fell in the industrial hub of Udyog Vihar's Phase IV after heavy showers in the afternoon.

In the advisory released by the District Disaster Management Authority (DDMA), commuters were strictly warned against attempting to cross waterlogged stretches on foot or in vehicles, with the administration highlighting the difficulty in assessing water depth and hidden road hazards beneath the surface. Citizens were also advised to keep a safe distance from trees, electricity poles, and overhead power cables vulnerable to snapping in squally winds.

The inner streets of neighbourhoods in Gurgaon — like C Block of Palam Vihar — saw residents wading through ankle-deep water.

GMDA officials said they mobilised quick-response field teams, mobile suction tankers, and high-discharge dewatering pumps across chronic inundation points.

Field personnel were deployed along critical arterial stretches, including the Delhi–Gurugram Expressway service roads at Narsinghpur, Hero Honda Chowk, Subhash Chowk, Sheetla Mata Road, and sections of the Golf Course Extension Road. "Teams are on the ground clearing fallen trees and branches along the roads in Sectors 18–19, Udyog Vihar, following the rain. Swift clearance is underway to restore safe and smooth movement and keep the road corridors clear. Pumping machinery has been deployed at Sector 51, near Mayfield Garden, as part of ongoing flood relief measures. Field teams are on the ground to facilitate the quick discharge of rainwater and minimise disruption," a GMDA spokesperson said.

• Skywatch

Forecast: September 6, 2026

Spell of light to moderate rain likely at several places

MAX: 31-33°C
1.1°C below normal

MIN: 24-26°C
1.6°C below normal

- *Sunrise: 6:02 AM (September 6)*
- *Sunset: 6:37 PM (September 6*
- *Moonrise: 3:14 PM (September 6)*
- *Moonset: 01:36 AM (September 7)*

• AQI Tracker

Anand Vihar Satisfactory **AQI: 66**	**Chandni Chowk** Moderate **AQI: 101**
ITO Satisfactory **AQI: 62**	**Narela** Satisfactory **AQI: 64**

- Good (0-50)
- Satisfactory (51-100)
- Moderate (101-200)
- Poor (201-300)
- Very Poor (301-400)
- Severe (401-500)

GOVT LAB REPORT FLAGS 17 DISCREPANCIES BETWEEN ABHAYRAB AND SAMPLES

Spurious rabies vaccines seized, racket busted after raids in April

Searches at Delhi flat led to 4 arrests

Tabshir Shams
New Delhi, September 5

A RAID at a flat in North Delhi's Mukherjee Nagar earlier this year has exposed a fake rabies vaccine racket, according to a statement by the Central Drug Standards and Control Organisation (CDSCO) on Saturday. The top regulatory body said that spurious samples of human rabies vaccine Abhayrab were found during the searches — conducted by the Crime Branch and Delhi Police, along with Drugs Inspectors from the Drugs Control Department — at the flat in April. Four people were arrested after the raids.

Even as the vials, with Batch number KE25012, carried the Abhayrab label, testing confirmed it wasn't made by Indian Immunologicals Ltd (IIL), the firm that holds a 40% share of the domestic rabies vaccine market and produces the vaccine. During the tests by the government's Central Drugs Laboratory in Kasauli, a field sample of the vaccine did not meet potency requirements and classified it as "not of standard quality" and a "misbranded" drug, according to officials.

"The CDSCO drew vaccine samples from an unlicensed residential premises located at Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi," Sunil Tiwari, Vice President, Quality Management, IIL, underlined in a statement on Friday. The CDL's report, according to IIL, found 17 differences between the seized vials and the retention samples of the same batch held at the lab. These included discrepancies in labelling, artwork, QR code verification, cap colour, licence details and packaging text.

The genuine batch, the firm said, was released only after government checks, with all 83,370 vials supplied strictly through its authorised distribution network, and no market complaints were received against it. The IIL said it has shared its manufacturing and distribution records with CDSCO and asked authorities to trace the source of the counterfeit vials.

Earlier, in a communication dated August 27, the Drugs Controller General of India had asked all state drug controllers to step up vigilance on the batch's movement and availability, and flagged the specifics of the misbranding to states for regulatory action.

Every batch of Abhayrab, IIL has said, undergoes independent government testing before release and that vaccines supplied through authorised channels, including hospitals and licensed pharmacies, were unaffected by the issue.

The case brings back to spotlight the rabies burden India has struggled to shake off for decades. A 2025 study by the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR), the country's top medical research body, in The Lancet Infectious Diseases, based on a nationwide survey of nearly 79,000 households, estimated 5,726 human rabies deaths occurring annually in India, with three in every four animal bites in the country caused by dogs.

A rabies vaccine works by training the immune system to recognise the rabies virus and make antibodies against it. After an animal bite, if given quickly, it effectively builds immunity against the virus.

Abhayrab is a series of vaccine shots that a patient must receive after being bitten by a dog, cat, or any other mammal, ideally within 24 hours. Other common rabies vaccines are Rabipur, Verorab, and Indirab.

India still accounts for 36% of the world's rabies deaths, according to estimates by the World Health Organization, and nearly one in five bite victims never receives any anti-rabies vaccination at all, with almost half of those who start the course failing to complete it. These numbers make the integrity of the supply chain crucial for the life and death of thousands who are affected.

Man found dead in farmhouse

New Delhi: A 28-year-old gardener was allegedly beaten to death inside a room at a farmhouse in the Maidangarhi area, with injury marks also found on his neck, police said on Saturday. They said Istiyaq Ali's body was found lying face down inside the room at a farmhouse in South Delhi on September 2. Officials said a man who was staying with Ali is missing following the incident, and police are searching for him.

Police said the preliminary investigation revealed that Ali had an altercation with another gardener working in the vicinity. They said the suspect allegedly assaulted Ali during the quarrel and fled the scene after the incident. Police are conducting raids at several locations to trace the accused. PTI

118 teachers honoured

From principals and vice-principals to librarians, educators and sports teachers, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta honours 118 teachers from government and MCD schools with State Teachers Awards, on Teachers' Day on Saturday. @GUPTA_REKHA/X

24 'high-performers' set to show the way to 1,500 MCD schools

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, September 5

WITH AN aim to boost public confidence in the education system run by the civic administration in the Capital, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Saturday said that 24 schools have been marked as 'Nigam Shri Schools of Excellence'. The Capital has over 1,500 MCD schools.

Speaking with *The Indian Express*, Yogesh Verma, Chairperson, Education Committee, MCD, said that two "high-performing" schools from each of the 12 MCD zones were picked as model schools along the lines of PM-SHRI and CM-SHRI school initiatives. "After months of assessment and screening, two schools from each zone have been carefully selected for this initiative. These schools will serve as model institutions and set an example for the rest of the schools. This is just the beginning. More schools will be selected gradually," he said.

Saturday's announcement came during the Teachers' Day ceremony at the Kedarnath Sahni Auditorium, Civic Centre, in New Delhi's Minto Road.

In an official statement, the civic body underlined, "These institutions are designed to create visible benchmarks of quality and build public confidence in the municipal education system. These can serve as benchmarks for quality education, infrastructure and school leadership within the MCD education system. Rather than acting in isolation, each Nigam Shri school will function as a catalyst and school complex, mentoring three to five neighboring MCD schools through academic guidance and resource sharing."

During the event, the MCD also announced two other initiatives. 'Pratibhagita', one of the two initiatives, is aimed at strengthening parental engagement and foundational learning; and the MCD Football Mini League, the other, seeks to create a structured grassroots sports ecosystem for students.

According to the MCD's Education department, Pratibhagita is being introduced in collaboration with Rocket Learning, a nonprofit, to strengthen school-parent communication and enable parents to support their children's learning at home. Under the initiative, parents of pre-primary students will receive play-based foundational learning activities and audio-visual content, and parents of primary school students will receive information on students, MCD initiatives and school announcements.

Verma said, "Parents are not in the loop as far as their child's day-to-day activities in schools are concerned. Now, parent participation will be strengthened. WhatsApp groups will be created and daily updates will be given about their child's activities including their attendance and participation in school's curriculum." The three initiatives were announced alongside the felicitation of 87 teachers during the Teachers' Day event, recognising their contribution to education in MCD schools.

Elder sister turns down marriage proposal, man kidnaps 11-yr-old

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 5

A FOUR-DAY chase to rescue an 11-year-old boy kidnapped by a man whose marriage proposal for his elder sister was allegedly turned down by her family ended on Friday at Azadpur Flyover in Delhi with the arrest of the accused, said officers. Identified as Dharam Pal, 26, the accused allegedly consumed poison in an attempt to evade arrest as a team of officers from Jahangirpuri Police station were closing in to apprehend him. He was immediately taken to Babu Jagjivan Ram Memorial Hospital for medical treatment, said police.

The 11-year-old went missing on August 31. His family said he left home for school but did not return. Officers said the child's mother then allegedly received a call from an unknown number. The caller identified himself as Dharam Pal, who was known to the family, and told her that the boy was with him.

The investigation later revealed that Dharam Pal wanted to marry the boy's sister. However, she and the family had turned down the proposal. Investigators claim Dharam Pal kidnapped her younger brother in an attempt to force the family to agree to his demand. Following the complaint, an FIR under Section 137(2) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) in the kidnapping case was registered at Jahangirpuri police station.

"A team comprising ASI Ashok Kumar and ASI Suraj Bhan was tasked with tracing the child and identifying the accused's movements. Police said the team used technical inputs as well as field investigation to develop leads on the whereabouts of the accused and the child," said a police officer.

EXPRESS special

A 66-acre lake in Delhi was declared revived. But a new report tells a different story

• THE RED FLAGS

- A recent water quality test conducted DPCC reveals that the lake remains polluted.
- Biological Oxygen Demand, Chemical Oxygen Demand, and fecal coliform levels failed to meet prescribed standards for supporting wildlife and fisheries, according to the report.
- Kitchener Lake's water quality not only affects its ability to support wildlife and fisheries, but also the health of the surrounding forest in the ecologically-sensitive Central Ridge.
- NGT seeks response from DDA over the failing standards despite the ongoing restoration work and financial spending.
- The next hearing is scheduled for November 25.

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, September 5

A 66-ACRE lake inside the protected Central Ridge forest in Delhi was supposed to be on the road to revival.

But months after the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) told the National Green Tribunal (NGT) that the water quality of the Kitchener Lake met the prescribed standards, a recent report from the Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPCC) submitted before the green court late August flagged multiple concerns.

The NGT, which has been holding proceedings on the water quality of the lake since 2024, on September 1 sought a response from the DDA within a month to explain the gaps even as cleaning work to the tune of Rs 36 lakh has already been awarded.

The DDA has been undertaking cleaning and in-situ bioremediation at the lake.

The order referred to DDA records on a tender acceptance of Rs 14.08 lakh for cleaning the lake in 2025. It also cited a second tender acceptance, dated July 30, for Rs 22.58 lakh for cleaning work over 365 days.

Failing standards

According to the DPCC's water-quality report filed before the NGT late August, the lake's water failed to meet prescribed norms for key parameters, including Biological Oxygen Demand (BOD), Chemical Oxygen Demand (COD) and fecal coliform.

The lake recorded a BOD of 40 mg/l and COD of 88 mg/l. Fecal coliform was recorded at 15×10^3 MPN/100 ml, as per the analysis of samples collected from the lake in July, revealed the DPCC report. "It is noted that the requisite parameters including fecal coliform, BOD and COD are not meeting the prescribed norms," the NGT's September 1 order read.

The sample also recorded a pH of 8.1, dissolved oxygen (DO) of 4.9 mg/l and free ammonia of 0.195 mg/l. Total dissolved solids stood at 1,880 mg/l, while total suspended solids were 136 mg/l. Chloride was recorded at 765.8 mg/l and hardness at 644 mg/l.

> ***The NGT, which has been holding proceedings on the lake's water quality since 2024, on September 1 sought a reply from DDA within a month to explain the gaps, even as cleaning work worth Rs 36 lakh has been awarded***

The water was assessed against Class-D criteria, intended for propagation of wildlife and fisheries. Under the criteria cited in the NGT order, pH should be between 6.5 and 8.5, dissolved oxygen should be at least 4 mg/l and free ammonia should not exceed 1.2 mg/l. This means some parameters specifically listed under the Class-D criteria — including pH, DO and free ammonia — were within the prescribed range.

Previous hearings

In May, the DDA had told the Tribunal that remedial measures had improved the lake's water quality and that recent laboratory reports showed that prescribed standards were met.

In an affidavit submitted during the proceedings, it reported improvement in water quality based on samples collected between January and May last year.

Amid the proceedings, environmental activists Madhumita Singh and Anil Sood disputed the assessment, and cited photographs submitted by the authority, alleging that authority showed a nearby lake in Jheel Park rather than Kitchener Lake.

The NGT subsequently ordered the DPCC to independently collect and analyse a fresh sample from Kitchener Lake. The July 14 sample — on which the report was based — was collected in compliance with the direction.

The bottlenecks

In the Delhi Master Plan 2041, the DDA has underlined, "The water bodies in Delhi are an important part of the city's natural drainage system and perform several ecological functions. They help in groundwater recharge, flood moderation, biodiversity conservation and providing recreational opportunities. However, many of these water bodies have been encroached upon, polluted or otherwise degraded."

The Master Plan proposes their "protection, rejuvenation and integration with the city's green-blue infrastructure".

"The water bodies, along with the drains, wetlands, river and other natural features, should be conserved as an interconnected ecological network rather than treated as isolated sites," it says.

With reference to Kitchener Lake, its condition affects not only the lake's ability to support wildlife and fisheries, but also the health of the surrounding forest ecosystem.

While the DDA earlier proposed using treated water from the sewage treatment plant at the nearby RR Base Hospital as a longer-term source for the lake, the bottleneck was the need for construction activity inside the protected forest, which requires court approvals.

Meanwhile, the issue of pollution in Delhi's key lakes is not new. Earlier this year, after mass fish deaths were reported in Sanjay lake in May, Lieutenant Governor V K Saxena directed the DDA to revive 77 water bodies within 30 to 90 days as part of a phased mission for restoration.

Influencer Bhardwaj arrested, Delhi Police gets one-day custody

Pragynesh
New Delhi, September 5

SWATANTRA BHARADWAJ, a self-styled influencer who admitted to attacking the father of a student protester at Jantar Mantar in July, was arrested by Delhi Police on Saturday. A Delhi court remanded him in one-day police custody.

Police said Bhardwaj, who was picked up by Crime Branch officers from his house in Bulandshahr on Friday and brought to Delhi after securing a transit remand, was produced at the residence of a Karkardooma Court judge around 2 pm Saturday.

His lawyers, who had appeared through video conferencing, complained later that they had not been informed the proceedings would take place at the judge's residence.

Advocate Swati Khanna, representing the student protester and her family, said, "Police sought only one day's custody and were granted the same. But we have not been provided a copy of the FIR registered, the Daily Diary Report, or the details of the investigating officer."

Security was tightened outside Parliament Street police station on Saturday as supporters of Swatantra Bhardwaj (left) gathered to protest. ANI

On Friday, relevant sections pertaining to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 (SC/ST Act) were added to an earlier FIR registered against Bharadwaj over the alleged attack on the protester's father, amid a protest by supporters of Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and Indian Youth Congress, as well as Lok Sabha MPs Chandra Shekhar alias Azad and Rajesh Ranjan alias Pappu Yadav.

A senior officer said police will now question Bhardwaj over allegations that he violated the SC/ST Act, specifically, whether the 'intent' of the attack on the protester's father, a Dalit, contained an element of caste discrimination or prejudice.

On Friday evening, an FIR was also registered under sections of the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, 2012, and for criminal intimidation based on the protester's complaint alleging she had received rape threats from Bhardwaj's supporters. (The protester's name is being withheld because she is a minor, and a case has been registered under the POCSO Act.)

A senior officer said police would examine whether the charge of 'attempt to murder' could be added to the FIR, as demanded by CJP.

Bhardwaj purportedly claimed in a widely circulated video podcast that he had cracked the skull of a protester at Jantar Mantar. He was referring to a scuffle in which the girl's father, a resident of Ghaziabad, sustained a head injury.

Meanwhile, on Saturday, members of Hindu Raksha Dal protested outside the Parliament Street police station, demanding the release of Bharadwaj and an FIR against the student protester and her father.

They claimed that she had "posted against Hindu religion" and its deities on social media. They also submitted a complaint to the Delhi Police, alleging the student's account has not been taken down despite the "anti-Hindu posts". As of Saturday night, a case had not been registered on the basis of the complaint.

JAN SUNWAI ORGANISED BY CIVIL SOCIETY GROUPS

'Was marked dead': Mangolpuri residents flag deletions, missing names from SIR draft rolls

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, September 5

KANTA PRASAD (36) arrived at a Jan Sunwai in Mangolpuri's Block Y on Saturday carrying his Aadhaar and voter ID cards. He wanted to show that he was alive, living at the same address and eligible to vote.

Only recently, his name has been struck off the draft rolls of Delhi's Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process with the ASDD (Absent, Shifted, Dead, Duplicate) record listing 'Death' as the reason his enumeration form was not collected.

"I was marked dead," Kanta said. He added that he had never received the form, though his wife and daughter had filled theirs.

His request to correct his father's name in the voter records — Mukund Prasad had been wrongly entered as Komal Prasad — had also not been acted on.

Kanta was among several residents who came to the Jan Sunwai with similar complaints – names missing from the draft roll despite them continuing to live at their registered addresses, and in some cases, despite having submitted their SIR forms.

Neelam (45) — who said she has lived in Mangolpuri since 1980, owns her house and voted in the 2025 Delhi elections — arrived at the hearing with her filled enumeration form. Her name, however, was missing from the draft rolls.

The hearing was organised by Jan Sarokar, Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan (MKSS), National Federation of Indian Women, Voter Adhikar Manch Delhi and other groups as part of their "people's audit" of the SIR process.

Another resident, Rihanna, said she missed the booth level officer's (BLO) first visit when the enumeration form was handed over. She claimed she called the BLO several times and eventually managed to contact her.

The BLO, she said, told her it was "very late" to submit the form. She still went ahead and submitted her form. But before that, she took a photocopy of her filled form and got the BLO's signature as proof of submission.

She was still marked "Absent" in the draft rolls.

Carina of MKSS said a woman who had lived in Mangolpuri since birth was also found to have been excluded from the draft rolls.

"In majority of the cases, residents have been marked 'Shifted'," she said.

The hearing brought up cases where women were marked "Permanently Shifted" or "Untraceable/Absent", while their husbands, listed at the same address with matching names, remained on the draft rolls.

The organisers said they found 37 such instances across 36 households.

Laxmi Devi (49) was among them. While she and her husband Om Prakash (55) — who worked in the Delhi Fire Service — were neither in the draft rolls nor on ASDD list, her two sons were marked "Absent/Untraceable".

As per records presented at the hearing, only her youngest son and her in-laws have found a place on the draft rolls.

Two other residents, Shersingh and Neeraj, said they had approached their BLOs to remove duplicate voter entries caused by misspellings. Instead, both entries of each resident were dropped from the draft rolls.

The cases followed a three-week door-to-door verification carried out by the civil society groups in Block Y, covering booths 119 to 126. *(see box)*

The groups said the hearings were meant to help residents flag omissions and incorrect deletions before the rolls are finalised.

Citing that a August 2003 Election Commission order provides for public verification of electoral rolls through gram sabhas, ward committees and urban community forums — including public reading of rolls and scrutiny of additions, deletions and corrections — social activist and MKSS co-founder Nikhil Dey said such checks were not being followed on the ground during the current SIR, which he described as "heavily exclusionary" and "anti-people".

• AUDIT OF DELHI'S DRAFT ROLLS

BLOCK Y MANGOLPURI

10,065	Electors examined in booths 119–126	**5,769**	Appeared in draft rolls
9,385	Physically verified	**2,789**	On ASDD list for removal

1,507 APPEARED IN NEITHER THE DRAFT SIR NOR THE ASDD LIST

At the public hearing in Mangolpuri on Saturday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

WHY WERE VOTERS ON ASDD LIST?

Permanently Shifted	2,280
Death	229
Untraceable/Absent	201
Already Enrolled (Duplicate)	104

FLAGGED AT JAN SUNWAI

66	Alleged wrong ASDD markings
56	Did not receive or could not complete the enumeration process
3	Sought corrections in SIR records

DEMANDS OF GROUPS

- Restore all wrongly excluded voters.
- Fix wrongful deletions and hold officials accountable for errors in the electoral rolls.
- Use Form 8 for restoration, with voters' existing details retained, rather than treating them as new voters through Form 6.
- Follow the Election Commission's 2023 Manual on Electoral Rolls, including provisions for draft rolls to be publicly read out at Gram Sabha and Ward Committee meetings so omissions and errors can be identified and corrected.
- Hold public hearings, complete corrections within one month
- Accept Aadhaar, PAN cards and previous EPIC cards used in earlier elections as valid identification for voters seeking restoration.

• FESTIVAL 'CELEBRATING CULTURE AND COMPASSION' WAS HELD AT THE IIC

At 'Spirit of Tibet', keeping culture & history alive — one word, artwork at a time

Reva Thakkar
New Delhi, September 5

A MONK sits at a table writing names in Tibetan script. At a stall, a young woman in a traditional *chupa* asks visitors to write messages for Tibet. Nearby, a 72-year-old woman, who came to India as a refugee when she was three years old, knots threads into a carpet.

At the India International Centre's (IIC) Kamala Devi Centre, the three-day Spirit of Tibet festival, which ends on Saturday, is as much about preserving a culture and its history as it is about celebrating them.

At the inauguration, Sikyong Penpa Tsering, head of the Central Tibetan Administration, spoke about Tibet's cultural and spiritual ties with India and the need to preserve them. Referring to China's Law on Promoting Ethnic Unity and Progress, implemented on July 1, he said it was part of efforts to "eradicate the identity of the people".

A day later, Tibetan activist Lobga Rangzen (52) died after self-immolating outside the United Nations headquarters in New York in protest against the law. According to the International Campaign for Tibet, more than 170 Tibetans have self-immolated over the years, most of them dying.

At a stall run by the Voluntary Tibet Advocacy Group (V-TAG) at IIC — largely organised by the Tibetan youth — visitors can write a message for the world about Tibet. One wall carries the names of Tibetans who have self-immolated. Another has pictures of three Tibetans who, the group says, were silenced by the Chinese government.

"We don't want them forgotten," says 18-year-old Sonam, wearing the traditional *chupa*, who recently began volunteering with the group.

(Right) Lhazom works on a hand-woven carpet; Tenzing Kunga, a wood carver. EXPRESS

The festival is not only about the history and the politics. With the tagline 'Celebrating Culture and Compassion' — the festival's focus is also on the many ways in which Tibetan culture is being kept alive.

For Ven Karma Wangdak, a Tibetan monk demonstrating 119 Tibetan scripts at the festival, writing itself is an act of keeping the culture alive. "The words of Lord Buddha, from thousands of years ago, are preserved to this day in written form. The script is carrying forward our culture," he says.

Every piece of paper is treated with care here. Pages on which mistakes are made are kept aside and later burned rather than thrown away. "We never trash them because we hold the script in very high regard," Wangdak says.

Nearby, visitors sit beside the calligraphers and ask them to write their names in Tibetan. Wangdak knows six scripts, while another calligrapher, Ven Nyima Phuntso, knows eight. Phuntso shows visitors how the script was written before paper, using flour spread over a wooden board.

The room is part of an exhibition by Khadhok, a Tibetan artists' collective. The walls carry works ranging from oil paintings by Tenpa Darchuk to satirical artworks by Cactus Tserma. A digital game made by Singapore-based siblings Tsering Choden and Ngawang teaches visitors Tibetan words for food, clothes and various other items.

"We have been collaborating with a lot of young artists, who involve their everyday slang in the artworks as well," says Khadhok co-founder Lea Taake.

In the next room, graduates of the Norbulingka Institute work quietly on traditional crafts. Tenzing Kunga, a wood carver for more than six years, works on a wooden piece combining the eight auspicious symbols Tibetan Buddhism — symbols of good fortune — into one.

Across from him, painter Sonam Dorjee works on a detailed painting inspired by Buddhist teachings. "I use all-natural paint that I make on my own. Even the canvas is cotton, which I make," he says.

The Norbulingka Institute was founded in 1955 to preserve Tibetan identity in exile through classical arts, crafts and literature.

At another stall, the Tibetan Women's Centre in Rajgarh, Dehradun, displays hand-woven carpets carrying traditional Tibetan symbols. Each can take a month or more to make.

Lhazom (72) has been making them for 50 years. She came to India with her parents when she was three. Sitting outside the multi-purpose hall, she continues knotting a red, yellow and beige carpet. "We call it *rumdhe* in our language," she says.

THE EVENTFUL city

BJP: Why Cong silent on Jharkhand 'paper loot'?

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 5

THE BJP on Saturday attacked the Opposition over an alleged break-in at a strongroom, where the question papers of a recruitment exam conducted by the Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC) were kept, terming the incident a "paper loot".

BJP spokesperson Sudhanshu Trivedi accused the Congress-led "INDI alliance" of remaining silent about the interests of students in this regard. He also questioned the presence of only three women ministers across the four Congress-ruled states in the country. The Congress is part of the Jharkhand Mukti Morcha-led government in the state.

Trivedi said the facts that had emerged during the investigation into the JPSC "irregularities" are "extremely shocking and reveal the true reality of the Congress-led INDI alliance's concern for the interests of students". "In the examination for the Assistant Conservator of Forest and Forest Range Officer posts, the strongroom was broken into, the question papers were taken out and changes were made to them. In other words, what happened in Jharkhand was not a paper leak, but a paper loot," he alleged.

"This has proved how weak the security of the strongroom was. It has also made it clear how weak the so-called strength of the Congress's claims regarding protecting students' interests and ensuring a smooth examination process is," he said.

Trivedi said all those political parties that were "roaring and raising a hue and cry in Delhi over the issue of examinations" are silent on the Jharkhand issue. Questioning why there were only three women ministers in four Congress-led state governments in the country, Trivedi said the "silence" of LoP Rahul Gandhi and party president Mallikarjun Kharge on the matter was "unfortunate".

"...On the issue of women's interests, while Prime Minister Narendra Modi is a symbol of the authenticity of credibility, Rahul Gandhi, on the other hand, is a symbol of a crisis of credibility," he said.

Census in four poll-bound states to begin on Dec 1

Registrar General of India announces the exercise in Goa, UP, Punjab & parts of Uttarakhand from Dec 1 to Jan 4

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 5

POPULATION ENUMERATION for Census 2027 will take place in Goa, Uttar Pradesh, Punjab and parts of Uttarakhand from December 1, 2026, to January 4, 2027, the Registrar General of India (RGI) said on Saturday, advancing the exercise in the states scheduled to go to polls early next year.

In a gazette notification, the RGI and Census Commissioner of India Mrityunjay Kumar Narayan said the citizens in these areas can avail the option for self-enumeration from November 16 to November 30, 2026.

"The conduct of the Census of the population shall be undertaken in the States of Goa, Uttar Pradesh, Punjab and areas other than snow-bound areas of the State of Uttarakhand, from 1st December, 2026 to 4th January, 2027 with a revisional round from 5th January, 2027 to 9th January, 2027," the notification said.

"For the Union territory of Ladakh and snow-bound non-synchronous areas of the Union territory of Jammu and Kashmir and the snow-bound non-synchronous areas of the States of Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand, the reference date shall be 00:00 hours of the 1st day of October, 2026," it said.

According to a gazette notification issued last month, the population enumeration in Ladakh and snow-bound non-synchronous areas of Jammu and Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh, and Uttarakhand would take place from September 1 to 30. The self-enumeration window was opened for these regions from August 17 to 31.

A woman officer carries out door-to-door house survey under the Census exercise in Guwahati. FILE

In June last year, the government had announced the Census reference date for the country, except for Ladakh and snow-bound non-synchronous areas of the Union territory of Jammu and Kashmir and the snow-bound non-synchronous areas of the states of Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand, to be 00.00 hours of March 1, 2027.

The population enumeration for the remaining country is likely to begin in February next year, barring snow-bound regions, during which data on various demographic, socio-cultural and economic parameters, along with migration and fertility characteristics of individuals from each household, will be collected.

The terms of the state assemblies of Goa, Manipur, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand will end by May 2027, and they are likely to go to polls early next year. The Central government has also deferred the house-listing operations for Census 2027 for Manipur, another notification issued by the RGI on Saturday said.

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar visits the 'Dobry Maharaja' memorial in Warsaw, Poland, on Saturday. PTI

Jaishankar pays tribute to Indian rulers who sheltered Polish refugees during WWII

Press Trust of India
Warsaw, September 5

EXTERNAL AFFAIRS Minister S Jaishankar on Saturday visited two memorials in Warsaw that commemorate India's humanitarian role in providing shelter to Polish refugees during World War II, recalling a little-known chapter that continues to shape the close ties between the two countries.

Jaishankar's visit to the memorials came a day after he held wide-ranging talks with Polish Deputy Prime Minister and Foreign Minister Radoslaw Sikorski on Friday, covering trade and investment, defence, space, artificial intelligence, semiconductors, energy and supply-chain resilience.

Jaishankar is on a two-nation visit to Ukraine and Poland from September 3-5. He visited Kyiv on Thursday, where he held talks with top Ukrainian leadership. At the memorial of Maharaja Digvijaysinhji Ranjitsinhji Jadeja of Nawanagar, Jaishankar recalled the words with which the Indian ruler welcomed Polish children who had fled the devastation of the war, "I am Bapu, the father of all Nawanagaris, including yourselves."

In a post on X, Jaishankar on Saturday said Jadeja was "fondly remembered for looking after 1,000 Polish children during World War II" and that his "warmth & compassion remain an abiding bridge" between India and Poland.

Jadeja, the ruler of the erstwhile princely state of Nawanagar, now part of Gujarat's Jamnagar, provided shelter and care to the children at a settlement in Balachadi. The children were provided accommodation, food, education and medical care, and came to remember him as their "Bapu", or father. Jadeja, also referred to as Jam Saheb, is popularly remembered in Poland as the "Dobry Maharaja (Good King)".

His memorial is situated in Warsaw's Ochota district and is known as the Square of the Good Maharaja. Jaishankar visited the memorial on Saturday along with Polish MP Kinga Gajewska and Ochota Mayor Piotr Krasnodebski.

The external affairs minister later paid his respects at the Kolhapur Memorial in Warsaw, which commemorates another chapter of India's wartime assistance to Poland. The memorial recalls the refuge provided by the princely state of Kolhapur to around 5,000 Polish refugees, including women and children, who were sheltered at Valivade near Kolhapur in Maharashtra during World War II. "This act of generosity is still fresh in the memory of the Polish people," Jaishankar said in another post on X, recalling the refuge provided to the Polish refugees.

The two memorials are part of a wider historical connection that has gained renewed attention in India-Poland relations in recent years. Prime Minister Narendra Modi had visited both memorials during his Poland visit in August 2024, highlighting the wartime stories as an important link between the two countries.

EXPRESS special

Why Siddaramaiah is back to rallying Karnataka's AHINDA base

Johnson T A
Bengaluru, September 5

WITH THE Congress government in Karnataka headed by D K Shivakumar shifting to governance focused on infrastructure and less on issues of its core base of backward class, minority, and Dalit voters — known by the Kannada acronym AHINDA — former Chief Minister Siddaramaiah is once again at the centre stage of rallying AHINDA base.

Over the last few weeks, the former CM Siddaramaiah has participated in multiple events organised by Dalit and backward caste groups where he has called for the unity of the Other Backward Classes (OBC) and Dalits to ensure social justice for the depressed classes.

On Sunday, Siddaramaiah is set to be the main speaker at a rally to mark 25 years of the Karnataka Other Backward Castes Federation. The event will also feature Deputy CM G Parameshwara, a Dalit whose candidature for the post was canvassed by Siddaramaiah and state Congress president B K Hariprasad, who is from an OBC community.

The event is seen as part of efforts to revive the Congress's social justice agenda, and although Siddaramaiah is headlining the event, it is not the former CM's attempt at individual assertion of power, said Congress sources familiar with Sunday's programme. Siddaramaiah stepped away from the public eye after handing over the CM's mantle to Shivakumar on June 3.

"There is a need to provide leadership to the AHINDA constituency once again. The states in the country where there have been strong social justice movements are the states that have resisted the right-wing political agenda," said one of the Congress organisers involved with the Sunday event, titled "A Resolution for Equality".

One of the possible intents of the event and Siddaramaiah's recent reassertions of his core political ideology of social justice is also seen as an indirect push for implementation of a state caste survey report that he accepted in his last week as CM. Shivakumar, his successor, belongs to the dominant Vokkaliga community and had previously opposed the state caste survey report. But he recently changed his stand and backed the survey.

"Our government conducted a socio-economic survey and we are committed to implementing it to deliver social justice," Shivakumar said on August 7 at a meeting of the Congress's national OBC panel in Bengaluru.

There has been speculation that Siddaramaiah was not happy with developments in the Congress, including the shifting of allegiance of several of his close associates such as Satish Jarkiholi, a Scheduled Tribe (ST) leader, and Zameer Ahmed Khan to Shivakumar. The Congress leadership, however, persuaded the 78-year-old former CM with Cabinet positions for his son Yathindra Siddaramaiah and several of his supporters, leaving little room for rebellion.

Senior Karnataka Congress leaders protest an FIR against Rahul Gandhi in Uttarakhand over his 'purification' comment. FILE

"There has been estrangement between Siddaramaiah and several of his close associates who left the JD(S) with him to join Congress, such as Jarkiholi and Ahmed. He feels he was backstabbed by them when he was CM. They feel he put interest of his son and community above them," said a Congress source.

Among former CM's close associates at present is Parameshwara. At a symposium on internal reservations for Dalits, organised by Dalit groups August 25, Siddaramaiah was questioned why he had not facilitated the appointment of a Dalit CM.

"Do you know who made Parameshwara the Deputy Chief Minister in the current government? They were thinking that four or five people should be made Deputy Chief Ministers," Siddaramaiah said. Parameshwara later confirmed it was Siddaramaiah's push that landed him the post for the second time.

At two separate meetings that Dalit groups organised in recent weeks, Siddaramaiah emphasised the need for equality and social justice in society and called for all depressed classes to unite. "I do not have any power. But I am someone who is in favour of internal reservation, in favour of the reservation system, and in favour of social justice. There has been no compromise in the past, and there will be no compromise in the future," Siddaramaiah said at the meeting.

"Those who have been exploited and deprived of opportunities due to caste system should get reservation. We are not stupid; we are deprived of opportunities. We did not get a chance to showcase our intelligence. The reservation system gives us opportunity," he said.

The next day, at the inauguration of a Shudra Seva Sangha in Bengaluru, he said: "For caste system to go, an egalitarian society must be created. The Shudra class was deprived of literacy and opportunities for many years. It is impossible for Shudra class to compete with upper castes. It is common for the illiterate to lose to the literate. If casteism is to go away, educated people must learn to think scientifically."

Siddaramaiah also participated in a protest over Uttarakhand Police's registration of an FIR against LoP Rahul Gandhi's demand for answers from BJP leadership over Haldwani "purification" episode after an event attended by Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge.

Among the speculation surrounding Sunday event is that it could be a forum to help Siddaramaiah's son Yathindra take up the mantle of an OBC and Ahinda leader from his father.

CJI: BRICS forum is a modern fabric woven with traditional threads

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 5

CHIEF JUSTICE of India (CJI) Surya Kant on Saturday described the Supreme Court-hosted BRICS Chief Justices' Forum as a modern fabric woven with traditional threads, with a shared quest to seek solutions that serve humanity and envision a world where law can guide the river of development towards the ocean of shared prosperity.

Delivering the welcome address on Day 2 of the Forum, attended by chief justices, presidents of supreme courts and senior judicial leaders from the BRICS member states and partner countries, CJI Kant said, "We are not merely a collection of jurisdictions, we are a fellowship of judicial minds, bound together by the shared belief that the enduring values of justice can meet the dynamic challenges of our time."

Addressing the delegates, he said as guardians of constitutional principles and interpreters of their countries' highest ideals, they have gathered here to inscribe a new chapter in the chronicles of international legal cooperation — one where the legacy of hallowed wisdom will meet the promise of modern law.

"The BRICS Chief Justices' Forum, in its essence, is a modern fabric woven with traditional threads...," according to CJI Kant.

(PUBLIC NOTICE / FINAL NOTICE)

It Is Hereby Brought To The Notice Of All Concerned That A Departmental Enquiry Has Been Instituted Against Sh. Ravi Dagar, Assistant Commandant (IRLA No. 10662), 185 Bn CRPF, Who Has Been Willfully Absent From Duty With Effect From 04/09/2024. Several Notices Have Reportedly Been Sent To His Last Known Address; However, No Response Or Communication Has Been Received From Him.Now, Therefore, Through This Public Notice, Sh. Ravi Dagar, Assistant Commandant (IRLA No. 10662) Is Hereby Given A Final Opportunity To Appear Before The Undersigned On Or Before 23/09/2026, Along With All Relevant Documents/Evidence In His Defence.

Take Further Notice That, In The Event Of His Failure To Appear Before The Undersigned On Or Before The Stipulated Date, The Ongoing Departmental Enquiry Shall Be Proceeded With Ex-Parte, In Accordance With The Applicable Rules/Procedure, Without Any Further Notice.

(B.R. Meena)
Inquiry Officer-Cum-Commandant
110 Bn, CRPF, Lethpora, Pulwama, J&K

Intellectual freedom gaining strength, says Sitharaman

New Delhi: With intellectual freedom gaining strength, India is today "self-assured and quite unapologetic" and has stopped waiting for anyone else's permission to study its own heritage, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said on Saturday.

"In 1991, we had our economic independence; it is only now that intellectual freedom is gaining strength...intellectual freedom has to give us the right to know ourselves," she said while addressing the annual history prize awards ceremony organised by the Foundation for Indian Historical and Cultural Research here.

She pitched for inclusion of thinkers from all perspectives to engage in debate, allowing a clash of ideas before a discerning public that is trusted to weigh the evidence for themselves.

"India today is self-assured and quite unapologetic about it, we have stopped waiting for anybody else's permission to study our own heritage," she said.

"We are reading our inscriptions again, working out our maritime trade, going back to our mathematics and telling these stories with real pleasure, as well as real precision. This, I think, is what decolonisation ought to mean. It cannot simply be a matter of swapping one prescribed textbook for another," she said. PTI

'Incompetent, lazy': Kangana tears into officials over stalled projects in Mandi

Saurabh Parashar
Shimla, September 5

BJP'S MEMBER of Parliament from Mandi and actor Kangana Ranaut on Saturday lambasted district administration officials for allegedly failing to expedite development works using Rs 11 crore she had provided from her MPLADS funds.

"What will I reply to the national media?" Ranaut said. "People sitting here do better acting than me. They are all incompetent and frauds."

"I had given Rs 11 crore to expedite development works, but not a single piece of work has been completed. How idle and inefficient you people are. What am I supposed to say before the national media? That you come here only to draw your salaries? What can I say about the people working in this state? They are extremely lazy and utterly careless in their approach," Ranaut said, chairing a meeting of the District Development Coordination and Monitoring Committee (DISHA) in Mandi, the first of three meetings scheduled in the district.

"What is this behaviour? Why are you people putting up this pretence? Why are you holding these meetings when you have no intention of getting any work done? It's a bloody joke. I cannot even say anything about you in the national media. What am I supposed to tell them about your work ethic? So, we remain silent and swallow the bitter pill. But do you people have no shame? Even now, out of the Rs 11 crore, half the amount — around Rs 5.50 crore — has not been utilised. And some people even walked away with half of that amount (half of Rs 5.50 crore). You should put pressure on them and recover the money. Is that my scope of work? Aren't you people ashamed? So much negative publicity is happening. So many people are making reels about this. And despite all this, you sit in your offices and laugh?" she said, mimicking how officials laugh. "You don't even listen to anything I say in my office."

Mandi MP Kangana Ranaut during a meeting with district officials on Saturday. EXPRESS

"Barely Rs 1 crore was spent on developmental works by March-April, out of nearly Rs 11 crore released over two years. We also sent repeated correspondence to the ministry to seek progress on the utilisation of funds. Some people have taken the money, while others have it but haven't started the work. Signatures have also been obtained on false NOCs," she said. She also asked all officials responsible for the delayed works to stand up. "People sitting here act better than me," she said sarcastically, expressing her frustration over the explanations being offered during the meeting.

"How many of you are there? If you give me your offices for just one day each, I will show you how to get work done in a single day. What kind of people are you? Does the Centre really need to send letters to your offices to make you work out of fear?" Kangana added.

The DISHA meeting was attended by Mandi Deputy Commissioner Apoorv Devgan, BJP MLAs representing assemblies under Mandi district and senior officials from various departments, including Public Works Department (PWD), Jal Shakti, electricity, rural development and other agencies. Around 14 Block Development Officers (BDOs), besides executive engineers and other departmental officials, were also present.

Expressing her strong displeasure at the slow pace of development, Ranaut said officials appeared to be treating meetings as a mere formality. "Similar issues had been discussed in previous meetings, yet little progress was made on the ground. Why are we wasting everyone's time by holding meetings again and again when the same suggestions keep coming, and there is no action on them? You seem unaffected by all these," Ranaut said.

The MP directed officials to prepare separate lists of projects by stage of progress and to prepare a time-bound action plan for every pending case. "The status of each project should clearly indicate where it got stuck and which department or authority was responsible for the delay."

रजिस्ट्री सं. डी.एल.-33004/99 REGD. No. D. L.-33004/99

भारत का राजपत्र
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MINISTRY OF ROAD TRANSPORT AND HIGHWAYS

NOTIFICATION

New Delhi, the 1st September, 2026

S.O. 4836(E).- Whereas by the notification of the Government of India in the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways, **2368(E) Dated:08/05/2026**, published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part II, Section 3, Sub-section (ii) issued under sub-section (1) of section 3A of the National Highway Act, 1956 (48 of 1956) (hereinafter referred to as the said Act), the Central Government declared its intension to acquire the land specified in the Schedule annexed to the said notification for building (widening/four-laning, etc.), maintenance, management and operation of NH709B in the stretch of land from Km. 14.75 to Km. 26.15 (Delhi Saharanpur Highway from Delhi/UP Border to EPE junction) in the district of GHAZIABAD in the state of UTTAR PRADESH

And whereas the substance of the said notification has been published in **"The Indian Express"** dated 14/05/2026, **"Amar Ujala"** dated 14/05/2026; under sub-section (3) of section 3A of the said Act;

And whereas the Competent Authority has received objections filed under Section 3-C, considered and settled the same appropriately;

And whereas, in pursuance of sub-section (1) of section 3D of the said Act, the competent authority has submitted its report to the Central Government;

Now, therefore, upon receipt of the said report of the competent authority and in exercise of the powers conferred by the sub-section (1) of section 3D of the said Act, the Central Government hereby declares that the land specified in the said Schedule should be acquired for the aforesaid purpose;

And further, in pursuance of sub-section (2) of section 3D of the said Act, the Central Government hereby declares that on publication of this notification in the Official Gazette, the land specified in the said Schedule shall vest absolutely in the Central Government, free from all encumbrances.

6714 GI/2026

SCHEDULE

Brief description of the land to be acquired, with or without structure, falling within the NH709B inthe stretch of land from Km. 14.75 to Km. 26.15 in the district of GHAZIABAD (Delhi Saharanpur Highway from Delhi/UP Border to EPE junction) in the district of GHAZIABAD in the state of UTTAR PRADESH

District: Ghaziabad
https://egazette.gov.in
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[F. No. NHAI/PIU-Gzb/709B/12011/LA/3A/3D]
SHAIKH AMINKHAN, Director

MURMU SAYS 'EDUCATION FOR ALL', MODI EMPHASISES OUT-OF-CLASSROOM LEARNING

'Little reporters' to QR-coded trees: 82 teachers felicitated with national award

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 5

HOME-READING CAMPAIGNS that take books beyond the classroom, initiatives that turn students into "little reporters", and digital mapping of campus trees using QR codes covering 102 species and a knowledge park built from recycled materials are among the innovations for which 82 teachers have been selected for this year's National Teachers' Awards.

President Droupadi Murmu felicitated the awardees from three departments on the occasion of Teachers Day on Saturday. Among them, 48 from the Department of School Education and Literacy, 21 from higher educational institutions and polytechnics and 13 skill trainers from the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship.

Speaking on the occasion, the President said education is the most effective means of realising the ideal of equality of opportunity enshrined in the Constitution and that the "achievement of negligible primary school dropout rate had been made possible through the teachers' efforts."

President Droupadi Murmu felicitates a teacher at the National Teachers Awards event in New Delhi on Saturday. ANI

"Our teachers breathe life into the education system. We must strive to ensure that not even a single student in our country is deprived of opportunities for quality education," she said, adding that teachers should instill knowledge, inspiration, morality and sensitivity in students through their affection and dedication.

She also noted that school education forms the foundation of the system, and that while knowledge and skills can be acquired at any time, imparting lessons in good conduct during childhood is far more effective. On skill development, she said, "Establishing India as the skill capital of the world and transforming it into a knowledge superpower, is among our national priorities." The function was attended by Union Education Minister Pralhad Joshi, Ministers of state Sukanta Majumdar and Jayant Chaudhary.

The Awardees

Dr Archana Shukla of Government Mahatma Gandhi Sandipani Higher Secondary School, Madhya Pradesh's Bhopal, was awarded for project-based learning, ecological stewardship and low-cost student initiatives — including installing over 1,000 sparrow houses and digitally mapping campus trees using QR codes for 102 species.

Sunita Yadav from Government Middle School, Chhattisgarh's Khichdi was awarded for her community initiative Nyota Bhojan, now expanded statewide, and a home reading campaign, Ghar Ghar Pustak Vachan. Serving since 2008, Yadav's pedagogy enables rural students to act as "Little Reporters" interviewing officials, producing educational reels, audiobooks, and short films.

Divyendu Sen of Mahatma Gandhi Government School, Jhalawar, Rajasthan, was chosen for pioneering the Virtual Biology Laboratory, AI-enabled biology education and the "Tree Talk" QR-code-based botanical learning system, making high-level STEM education accessible in government schools.

The awardees further included Dr Renu Tripathi of Balika Inter College, Ghaziabad, UP, who was honoured for holistic development of girls through tech enabled and inclusive learning; Ravi Jaiswal of Government Model High School, Chandigarh, who has been awarded for creating low-cost and scalable solutions; and Kunda Jayawant Bachhav of Nashik, Maharashtra, who received the award for her "Educational Parenting" initiative.

Devise ways to keep children off screens, PM tells teachers

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 5

CONCERNED OVER the impact of excessive screen time on students, Prime Minister Narendra Modi has urged teachers to speak to parents about how much time their children spend on screens and whether they continue using cellphones late at night.

Interacting with the winners of the National Teachers Awards at his official residence on the eve of Teachers' Day, the PM on Friday highlighted the issue of "excessive screen time" and said that "it had become a major concern". As per a government statement released on Saturday, Modi suggested that children could gradually be weaned off electronic screens by developing their interest in sports, physical games and creative activities.

Referring to the National Education Policy, Modi stressed the importance of taking children outside the classroom and connecting them with real-world skills and forms of work. He emphasised that teachers need to look beyond children's academic performance and pay attention to their behaviour and daily lives.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi interacts with the winners of the National Teachers Awards in New Delhi on Saturday. PTI

The PM also talked about drug addiction and called upon teachers to remain alert to changes in children, identify the cause and help them overcome the habit. "The PM said preserving the innocence of childhood is an important role that a teacher can play... children have the same basic nature and curiosity and if teachers nurture and appropriately channelise this curiosity, they can make a significant contribution to their development," the release read.

This year, 82 teachers and educators were selected for the National Teachers Awards. Of them, 48 teachers are from the Department of School Education and Literacy, 21 teachers/ faculty members from higher educational institutions and polytechnics, and 13 are skill trainers from the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship.

Cong's Dalit MPs to discuss Uttarakhand 'purification' ritual tomorrow

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 5

DALIT MPS of the Congress will meet in Delhi on September 7 to discuss the alleged "purification" done in Haldwani after a rally addressed by Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge on August 8.

Sources in the party told *The Indian Express* that Congress MP Mallu Ravi has taken the initiative to conduct a meeting to denounce the "purification" in Haldwani and discuss a strategy to take the issue forward.

"We have informed all Dalit and Scheduled Tribes MPs to attend the meeting at Indira Bhawan. We plan to discuss the future strategy on how to ensure that the incident is not forgotten," according to a senior Dalit MP.

Last week, an FIR was registered against Leader of Opposition (LoP) in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi in Uttarakhand's Haldwani town under sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) and the SC/ST Act.

The FIR was registered a day after Gandhi, during a press conference in New Delhi, urged Prime Minister Narendra Modi to order an FIR over a "*shuddhikaran havan*" (purification ritual) carried out at Ramlila Maidan in Haldwani, days after a rally there by Congress president and Dalit leader Mallikarjun Kharge.

EXPRESS special

'Struggling to set house in order': BSP cadre left anxious over frequent changes at the top

Lalmani Verma
Lucknow, September 5

THE BAHUJAN Samaj Party (BSP) — the only national party whose core electoral base is Dalits — is facing growing anxiety among its cadre over frequent changes in its senior leadership, even as the party struggles to recover from consecutive defeats in the Assembly and Lok Sabha elections.

Over the past two years, the BSP has been marked by organisational turmoil, with party supremo Mayawati repeatedly removing senior leaders, reinducting them and, in some cases, expelling them again. Mayawati earlier this week sidelined her nephew Akash Anand, who was considered the party's "No 2" and its national convenor, saying he needed to "become more mature".

In his place, Mayawati brought Akash's younger brother, Ishaan, into a meeting of office-bearers in Lucknow on Thursday. The latest move has once again raised questions within the party about its leadership structure and the absence of a stable second rung, particularly with the Uttar Pradesh Assembly polls due in early 2027. While the party's electoral performance has steadily declined, the BSP in recent years has been in the news largely for disciplinary action against senior leaders.

Projected as her political heir ahead of the 2024 Lok Sabha polls, Akash launched the BSP's campaign in UP. However, in May 2024, after he was booked for allegedly promoting enmity during a public rally in Sitapur, Mayawati removed him as the BSP's national coordinator and withdrew her earlier declaration naming him as her political heir, saying he would have to wait "until he attains maturity".

After 47 days, Mayawati gave him a second chance. In June 2024, she reinstated Akash as national coordinator and again named him her successor. In March 2025, however, Akash was removed as national coordinator for the second time and expelled from the party. Two months later, the decision was reversed. The party appointed him chief national coordinator and, in August 2025, elevated him as its national convenor.

A few days later, she revoked the expulsion of Akash's father-in-law and former Rajya Sabha MP Ashok Siddharth and reinducted him into the party after he publicly apologised for his "mistakes". He was appointed a central coordinator. Siddharth had been expelled from the party in February 2025 on charges of anti-party activities. Last month, she again expelled Siddharth, this time over reports of alleged indiscipline. On the same day, she expelled national coordinator Randhir Singh Beniwal from the party for alleged indiscipline. Party sources said Mayawati has subsequently revoked Beniwal's expulsion.

Earlier this week, Mayawati sidelined her nephew Akash Anand, considered the party's 'No 2', saying he needed to 'become more mature'

There was a similar episode involving former BSP vice-president Jai Prakash Singh. In October 2025, Mayawati reinducted Singh into the party, seven years after he was expelled in 2018, apparently over his remarks that Congress leader Rahul Gandhi could never aspire to become Prime Minister because of his mother's foreign origin.

After his reinduction, Singh was appointed a central coordinator and given charge of Odisha, West Bengal and Kerala. But in April this year, he was expelled again, along with another central coordinator Dharamveer Ashok, allegedly for visiting Punjab without obtaining permission from the party. While Singh remains expelled, the BSP later revoked Ashok's expulsion and appointed him in-charge of Jharkhand, as per party sources.

On August 13, Mayawati expelled former health minister Anant Kumar Mishra from the party on charges of anti-party activities. Mishra served in the BSP government in UP from 2007-2012. The repeated actions against senior leaders, particularly Akash, have begun to raise questions among party workers, according to BSP functionaries, including coordinators and district presidents.

"The BSP is a cadre-based party. But now the same cadre is questioning the leadership's decisions over frequent changes at the top — especially expulsions and reinductions. They are feeling that the BSP's house is still not in order when the Assembly polls are only a few months away," said a senior party leader. The concern is particularly significant because the BSP's organisational strength has traditionally rested on a disciplined cadre and a clearly defined leadership hierarchy centred on Mayawati. With the party having failed to win a single Lok Sabha seat from UP in the 2024 Lok Sabha polls, the pressure to rebuild that organisation ahead of the Assembly polls has grown.

The leader said: "I urge them (workers) to maintain faith in decisions and the leadership of Behanji (Mayawati). She is monitoring the poll preparations and organisational activities. Action against Akash shows that the party and its movement are paramount for Behanji. She is finalising the candidates and their announcements have started in the constituencies. The cadre is ready for elections. Meetings in villages with Dalits, Muslims, OBCs and Brahmins are continuing on the ground."

Another leader said while Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath and Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav are travelling across the state, meeting leaders and trying to woo Gen-Z voters, the BSP is still struggling to "set its house in order" and lacks a stable youth face. "The ultimate message we see behind these actions is that Behanji is the only authority in the party and all decisions will be taken single-handedly by her," the leader said.

According to the leader, information circulating within the party is that action was taken against Akash because, during his recent speeches in Hathras and Jewar last month, he made statements that were not part of Mayawati's official message for the gatherings. "He was supposed to only communicate the message of Behanji but he added some statements on his own," the leader said, referring to Akash's remarks in which he referred to Gandhi and Yadav as "uncle".

Another leader said Akash had been planning to address more workers' meetings and announce Assembly candidates across UP in October-November to mobilise the party cadre ahead of the polls. With his removal, however, local party coordinators and district presidents are expected to take up the task of addressing the meetings.

CM D K Shivakumar interacts with officials during the inauguration of Praja Seva Department campaign in Vijayanagara, Saturday. ANI

Karnataka teachers can now use 'Tr' prefix: CM

Press Trust of India
Bengaluru, September 5

KARNATAKA CHIEF Minister D K Shivakumar on Saturday said teachers in the state can use the prefix 'Tr' before their names as a mark of respect for their contribution to society.

The announcement was made on the occasion of Teachers' Day. The prefix is akin to professional titles such as 'Dr' for medical doctors, 'Er' for engineers and 'Prof' for professors. "A teacher builds every person who goes on to build the nation. India's over 1 crore teachers, including nearly 4.5 lakh teachers in Karnataka, are shaping the minds, character and future of our children every single day," Shivakumar wrote on X.

The CM said that every doctor, engineer, farmer, officer, entrepreneur and leader had a teacher behind them who first recognised their potential and showed them what was possible. "This Teachers' Day, the Government of Karnataka has decided to honour this invaluable contribution with a distinct mark of respect. From today, teachers of Karnataka can proudly use the prefix 'Tr' before their names."

Calling the two-letter prefix a symbol of a lifetime of service, Shivakumar said 'Tr' was more than a title — it represented society's recognition of teachers who had dedicated their lives to shaping others. "A society that honours its teachers honours its own future," he said, thanking teachers for guiding, correcting and encouraging students to believe in themselves. He said the 'Tr' prefix was a recognition teachers had truly earned.

Speaking after launching the 'Praja Seva Abhiyan' in Kudligi of Vijayanagara district, the CM said, "Today, we are celebrating Teachers' Day to mark the birth anniversary of Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan... Professionals in other fields receive recognition based on their profession. Similarly, the government has decided to accord professional recognition to teachers."

● DIMPLE YADAV'S IMPORTANCE GOES BEYOND THE GREEN-LIGHTING PARTY'S SOPS FOR MAHILA VOTERS. SHE'S AN IMAGE-SOFTENER FOR A PARTY ACCUSED OF BEING 'AGGRESSIVE & ROUGH' WHEN IN POWER

SP makeover to 'M' factor: Why Akhilesh is leaning on Dimple for UP elections

THE NEERJA CHOWDHURY COLUMN

WEEKLY INSIGHT INTO WHAT'S CHANGING IN NATIONAL POLITICS – AND WHY

THE CAMERAS always catch Dimple Yadav whenever Samajwadi Party (SP) president Akhilesh Yadav speaks in the Lok Sabha. For Dimple, SP MP and Akhilesh's wife, sits right behind him in the House. But her expressions give little away.

As an MP for 14 years (across four terms since 2012), she kept a low profile until recently, and was seen as the eyes and ears of her husband. Whenever one met her, she would always ask for feedback on what was happening in New Delhi, and listen intently to what you had to say. Smart leaders rely on their informal modes of information to augment what they hear through their official channels.

Now, the low-key Dimple seems to have suddenly decided to shed her reticence. It was she, not Akhilesh, who went to Jantar Mantar to meet the CJP protesters and the fasting Ladakh leader Sonam Wangchuk to express solidarity with them. You see reels on Instagram and Facebook of Dimple outside Parliament's Makar Dwar engaging with media persons.

The 48-year-old has spoken persuasively inside the Lok Sabha on behalf of her party on different subjects — ranging from alleged "*chanda chori*" at the Ayodhya Ram Temple to Gen Z protests over exam paper leaks. She sits next to Akhilesh at press conferences in Lucknow when he makes key announcements — as she did recently when he proposed the Stree Samman Samriddhi Yojana, pledging Rs 40,000 a year to every eligible woman in the event of the SP's win in the 2027 UP elections.

Every party has caught on to the "M" (Mahila) mantra for winning polls. It is not surprising that Dimple would greenlight the SP's sops for Mahila voters. But her importance goes beyond that — she is an image-softener for a party accused of being "aggressive and rough" when in power. The BJP has consistently accused the previous SP regime of "lawlessness and hooliganism". The Dimple touch and her calm approach seem to be part of the image makeover that Akhilesh is trying for his party. The Mainpuri MP is doing it steadily as she comes into her own and gets the spotlight.

Battle for UP

It goes without saying that the UP polls, slated for February 2027, are critical for the BJP and RSS as well as Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Home Minister Amit Shah and UP Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath. The cloud of "*chanda chori*" allegations has dented the Sangh Parivar's image as a few things have done in recent years. It is another matter that the Jantar Mantar protest and its aftermath sent these allegations into the background.

UP is also the Nehru-Gandhi family's traditional turf as well as the adopted *karmabhoomi* of Modi, who chose to retain Varanasi even though he had also won from Vadodara in 2014. The stakes are equally high for Akhilesh, 53. If he loses the 2027 polls, he will be staring at another stint in the Opposition. Being out of power for 15 years could be debilitating for any leader, even though Akhilesh is still a relatively young leader.

As an MP, Dimple Yadav kept a low profile until recently and was seen as the eyes and ears of her husband and Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav. EXPRESS FILE

For some time, Akhilesh has been trying to expand the SP's base beyond its MY (Muslim-Yadav) moorings. His "PDA" (Pichda, Dalit and Alpasankhyak) strategy paid the party rich dividends in the 2024 Lok Sabha polls, as he fielded only five Yadavs (all members of the SP first family), giving most of the tickets to candidates from non-Yadav OBCs. Dalits also bought into the Opposition's narrative then that the BJP might change the Constitution and dispense with the reservation regime if it gets "*400 paar*" seats.

Akhilesh is aware of the space that could open up for the party in the 2027 polls, with Mayawati's BSP on the wane and discontent brewing among a chunk of Dalit voters. A section of Jatavs had also voted for the SP in 2024.

Akhilesh's game plan

As part of his new strategy, Akhilesh has added another "P" to his PDA, stating that it also refers to Pandits (Brahmins) besides Pichda. He announced this at the birth anniversary of the late socialist leader Janeshwar Mishra in Lucknow in early August. A trishul-carrying Akhilesh remembered "*Chote Lohia*", as Janeshwar was called, amid the recitation of Shiv Tandav Stotram — signalling his efforts to reach out to Brahmins and create a new rainbow coalition.

Brahmins account for about 10% of UP's population. In power or out of it, they have always wielded influence far beyond their numbers. When Akhilesh first came to power in 2012, as the cycle-riding, red-capped, new SP leader, the party had won in over 50 of around 100 seats in the state, where the Brahmin community plays a significant role in the polls. Five years earlier, in 2007, when Mayawati formed the government in UP on her own, she had successfully created a Dalit-Brahmin axis, with a large number of Brahmins voting for her. But after Modi's rise, Brahmins rallied behind the BJP.

However, of late, there have been signs of dissatisfaction among sections of the upper castes with the BJP — be it over the UGC norms or the caste census, both seen as pro-OBC moves, or the NEET paper leak and the consequent anti-quota debate hotting up in the country.

The Congress could have been a natural claimant to the Brahmin vote in UP, if it had a robust organisation. After all, it was Indira Gandhi who had effectively crafted the Brahmin-Dalit-Muslim coalition to the party's advantage. But Rahul Gandhi is chasing a different dream, pursuing the support of the OBCs-Dalits-minorities in the Hindi heartland.

Unlike his father and SP founder Mulayam Singh, Akhilesh is not shy of adopting Hindu symbols. He has spoken of Sanatan Dharma as "uniting people", publicly recited "Hanuman Chalisa" (like AAP chief Arvind Kejriwal), and organised the Brahmin sammelans. An Akhilesh-headed trust is building the Kedareshwar Mahadev temple in Etawah, the home turf of the Mulayam family, which is expected to be completed before the 2027 elections.

Accused of "minority appeasement", Akhilesh has tried to steer his party away from the "anti-Hindu" and "pro-Muslim" image that the BJP would project. His strategy for the 2027 polls is to mainstream the party along with Dimple, expand PDA to include Brahmins, identify with Hindu interests while upholding minority rights, and pursue the social justice objectives.

This is a tall order. The success of Akhilesh's plans will depend not just on what he does but also on what his allies, like Rahul, would do. For it may not help Akhilesh if he woos the upper castes and Rahul tears into Manusmriti, which could lead to their consolidation for the BJP.

Neerja Chowdhury, Contributing Editor, The Indian Express, has covered the last 11 Lok Sabha elections. She is the author of How Prime Ministers Decide

Eight high court chief justices appointed

EIGHT HIGH court chief justices were appointed on Saturday, days after their names were recommended by the SC Collegium. In a post on X, Law Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal said Justice Valluri Kameswar Rao, a judge of the Delhi HC, has been appointed Chief Justice of the Patna HC. Justice Ravindra V Ghuge of the Bombay HC will head the Calcutta HC.

Justice Sanjay Kumar Agrawal of the Chhattisgarh HC will head Rajasthan HC, while Justice Mahesh Chandra Tripathi of the Allahabad HC has been appointed Chief Justice of the Bombay HC. Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra of the Punjab and Haryana HC has been appointed Chief Justice of the court. Justice Krushna Ram Mohapatra of the Orissa High Court will head the Chhattisgarh HC. Justice Alpesh Yeshwant Kogje of the Gujarat HC will head the Madhya Pradesh HC. Justice Pushpendra Singh Bhati of the Rajasthan HC has been will head the Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh HC. PTI

Bihar makes consent mandatory for CBI to probe public servants

Santosh Singh
Patna, September 5

THE BIHAR government's Home Department under Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary has issued a notification expanding the CBI's standing consent to investigate a broader set of offences involving Central government employees, Central PSUs and private persons, while requiring prior state permission for probes involving Bihar government employees and state-controlled or aided bodies.

Under Section 6 of the Delhi Special Police Establishment (DSPE) Act, 1946, the CBI cannot ordinarily exercise its powers and jurisdiction in a state without the state government's consent. That consent can be general, allowing the agency to investigate specified offences or categories of cases without seeking permission each time, or specific to an individual case.

The order creates a two-tier consent regime. The CBI retains automatic authority to investigate cases involving employees of the Government of India, Central Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs) and private individuals implicated alongside them in Bihar. However, a proviso removes this automatic authority over public servants appointed by or working for the Bihar government, state-owned corporations, companies, state-aided banks and institutions receiving financial assistance from the state.

The Home Department notification, issued by Principal Secretary Pankaj Kumar on September 3, reads: "The Governor of Bihar, in exercise of the powers conferred under Section 6 of the Delhi Special Police Establishment Act, 1946, and in supersession of all previous notifications on this subject, hereby accords consent for the extension of powers and jurisdiction of the members of the Delhi Special Police Establishment for cases involving offences under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023, Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, 2023, offences under the Information Technology Act, 2000, cybercrime, and the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988 (as amended), notified under Section 3 of the Act as amended from time to time, allegedly committed by employees of the Government of India or Public Sector Undertakings under the Government of India, and private persons".

The notification regulates the CBI's jurisdiction in Bihar under Section 6 of the Delhi Special Police Establishment (DSPE) Act, 1946, while expanding the range of offences covered by its standing consent.

The order further stated: "Provided that when the offence related to the above pertains to public servants appointed in connection with the affairs of the State Government of Bihar, or persons appointed in connection with the affairs of any corporation, company, bank owned by, controlled by, or receiving financial assistance from the Bihar Government, it shall be mandatory to obtain the prior consent of the State Government of Bihar for the investigation of any such offence by the Delhi Special Police Establishment. Additionally, upon receiving a proposal from the Delhi Special Police Establishment, the State Government will consider and take a decision on granting powers of investigation on a case-by-case basis."

It is a two-pronged order, an officer in the police headquarters told *The Indian Express*. "The first part of it allows the CBI to investigate cases which were the prerogative of the state. The second part of the order tries to balance it out by saying that the state's permission would be required," the officer said.

A CBI officer added: "Bihar might well have set a precedent for other states to follow and allow CBI a bigger scope of Investigation. The order, if read between the lines, would tell that it is more about giving CBI more powers and less about restricting them."

A Patna High Court advocate added that the requirement of state consent applies only to executive actions by the CBI.

"It does not restrict the high courts or the Supreme Court from ordering a CBI investigation within a state without state government consent," the advocate said.

• BRIEFLY

Damaged vehicles after a section of the wall of Arya Putri School collapsed due to heavy rain in Ajmer, Rajasthan, on Saturday. PTI

Heavy showers hit east Rajasthan; Sepau logs 107 mm of rain

HEAVY RAIN lashed parts of eastern Rajasthan, with Sepau in Dholpur district recording the highest rainfall of 107 mm, the weather department said on Saturday. Heavy rain over 24 hours since Friday morning was recorded at isolated places in Dausa, Dholpur, Karauli, Sawai Madhopur, Baran and Jhalawar districts, the department said. Light to moderate rain was recorded at some places in the Jaipur, Bharatpur, Ajmer, Kota and Udaipur divisions, with isolated places receiving moderate to heavy showers. Sepau in Dholpur recorded 107 mm of rain during the period, the highest in the state. In western Rajasthan, parts of Sri Ganganagar, Churu, Didwana-Kuchaman and Nagaur districts received light to moderate rainfall, it said. PTI

Gujarat: 3 factory workers die of electrocution

THREE WORKERS were electrocuted to death while working in factories in separate incidents in the city, police said on Saturday. Dheeraj Paswan (33) was electrocuted while working in a dyeing unit in Sachin GIDC area at around 5 pm on Friday, said a local police official. Valmiki Sharma (21) died at Sahaj Mill in Pandesara locality while working on a sewing machine in night shift. Kisan Ram (20) died of electrocution at a textile unit in Limbayat area, officials said. Accidental death cases have been registered, they added. PTI

Three die as bike skids due to rain in Kangra

THREE YOUTHS were killed when their bike skidded off the road and plunged into a deep gorge in the Bhaled area of Kangra district late Friday night amid heavy rain. Police said that the incident occurred at night, apparently making it difficult for anyone to take notice of the mishap immediately. The bodies were discovered on Saturday morning after villagers spotted broken branches along the roadside and the motorcycle lying on the hillside. The deceased are Amit Kumar, 26, Rohit Sharma, 24, and Pankaj Kumar, 22, of Chenna village. ENS

Video shows Gujarat cops flogging murder accused in public; SHO defends action

Express News Service
Ahmedabad, September 5

Incident comes a week after two accused in a separate case were paraded by the police

A 20-YEAR-OLD man accused of murdering his woman partner in Gujarat's Bhavnagar was on Saturday allegedly flogged by police, hours after his arrest in the case.

Videos of the purported incident, which went viral on social media platforms, show police taking the accused Faizal alias Khatki Rafiq Lakhani, who was tied with ropes, around the GSRTC bus stand in Bhavnagar and holding him against their patrol vehicle, pillars and walls on the premises and hitting him with their batons during the reconstruction of the crime scene.

Lakhani was arrested on September 4 by the Bhavnagar police for allegedly murdering 40-year-old Kajal, with whom he lived on the street outside the bus stand.

On September 3, Lakhani had allegedly accosted Kajal and a mutual friend, Ravi alias Boda Rajendra Gohel, at the bus stand and started beating them, accusing them of having an affair while he was in prison. The assault was recorded in the CCTV cameras. Kajal was declared dead the same night.

When asked about the videos of him and his team allegedly thrashing Faizal Lakhani in public, Police Inspector D P Unadkat, the SHO of Nilambaug police station, said that the incident occured during reconstruction of the crime scene on Saturday (September 5). "We did it because this is a rare case," he said.

"When they do smaller crimes, they are arrested and then released on bail...When we do this, they fear the police," Unadkat said.

The Indian Express attempted to reach out to Unadkat's superior officers, DySP RR Singhal of the City Division, as well as Bhavnagar SP Nitesh Pandey. However, both remained unavailable for comment. Speaking about Lakhani's criminal antecedents, Unadkat said, "This is the first murder case against him. He has been booked in six earlier cases..."

The flogging incident came a week after the Porbandar Police, on August 29, paraded two men through Visavada village and made them apologise to the residents. The two men, Khoda Sajan Keshwala and Nagajan Kala Odedara, were arrested for attempting to murder an elderly musician who had been invited to perform at an interfaith function in the village. DGP KLN Rao, in a letter dated May 12, pointed out the law related to handcuffing of arrested persons, tying them with ropes, and parading them "are not as per established processes and ordered they they must be stopped forthwith".

The Gujarat High Court on August 14 orally told the government to transfer IPS officer Rajdeepsinh Nakum, Deputy Commissioner of Police (DCP), Surat, saying his continued presence in the city could undermine an inquiry into allegations that he publicly beat and humiliated accused persons.

In the first week of May 2026, five persons moved the Gujarat High Court seeking action against nine police officers in Vadodara over alleged custodial torture, parading them in public and thereby committing contempt of court by violating the Supreme Court's order.

Cadets on cloud nine

Officer cadets during the Passing Out Parade at the Officers Training Academy (OTA) in Chennai. PTI

Human element decisive in modern war, says Navy chief

CHIEF OF NAVAL Staff Admiral Krishna Swaminathan on Saturday called upon 365 graduating cadets from the OTA as the human element remains the decisive factor in the modern battlefield.

"That the character of warfare may have changed in many ways, but fundamentally, war still remains a profoundly human endeavour. Combat operations may see new weapons being used across new domains, but their outcomes shall continue to be determined by the men and women who fight, lead, inspire, persist and persevere," the naval chief said. PTI

EXPRESS special

Spotted on Insta reel, Jharkhand man returns home from Keralam after 9 yrs

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, September 5

A screen grab of the viral video showing the 35-year-old man

IT WAS a regular 10-second Instagram video, amid a sea of countless others, put out on Independence Day. But an innocuous, gap-toothed smile captured in this reel shot in a Keralam village triggered an unusual chain of events, bringing to end almost a decade-long search of a Jharkhand family for its missing son.

Among its 1 million viewers was a family member of a differently-abled man captured in the reel. He had grown older — from 26 when he went missing to 35 now — but that smile was unmistakable. In Keralam, the man was called 'Rasheed'. But for the Sheikh family in Jharkhand, he was their Yasin. On Thursday, Yasin began an almost 2,500-km-long journey to reunite with his family that lives in Sahibganj district in Jharkhand.

It was sometime in 2017, when Yasin had stepped out of his home in Narayanpur to play with his friends in the village. When he did not come back home, his family filed a missing person complaint and began looking for him.

The same year, local residents in Cheruvadi village in Keralam's Kozhikode spotted a youth wandering in the area. They alerted police who produced him before the district child welfare committee as he looked much younger than his years. The panel lodged him at a welfare and care centre, managed with the assistance of the state Social Justice Department. As that care home was designated only for children below the age of 18, in 2023, the authorities shifted the youth to Karunyatheeram — a campus for differently-abled people run by an NGO, Health Care Foundation, at Kozhikode's Kattippara.

"His speech was often indistinct, making it difficult to understand what he says. He could not articulate his name. We named him 'Rasheed' as there were no official records to show his real name," said Karunyatheeram's chief operating officer P I Navas. At Karunyatheeram, "Yasin had been active in all celebrations and was keen to stand before the camera. He also appeared in a short film titled 'One Smile', which bagged state-level second prize in a contest by the Social Welfare Department."

Even as he settled into his life in Keralam, Yasin would often speak about his mother and his village, expressing his desire to return home. But no one knew where that elusive "home" was, the way no one knew how he ended up in Keralam. On Independence Day, social media influencer Pevundara Yasir came to Karunyatheeram campus. He captured a short video showing Yasin and his friends walking, a proud smile plastered on his face, with the national flag in hand. Yasir shared the video on his Instagram handle "*belikeyassir*". The video went viral, clocking more than 10 lakh viewers.

Among the viewers was Yasin's cousin. The family reached out to Karunyatheeram and spoke to him on call. There was no mistaking — this was, indeed, their Yasin. They shared his Aadhaar card and other details. The local authorities then confirmed that 'Rasheed', living in Keralam since 2017, was Yasin Sheikh of Jharkhand. "After watching the viral video, his cousin suspected that he saw Yasin and commented accordingly on Instagram. We shared the contact address, which helped them reach him. After his identity was confirmed, Yasin spoke to his father, Sohrab Sheikh, and his siblings through a video call. We have also got in touch with police in Keralam and Jharkhand, as per the official procedure. He is now 35, as per records," said Navas.

His younger brother Ajul Sheikh reached Keralam to take Yasin home. But the joyful reunion also brought in painful news for Yasin. "The mother he used to talk about so fondly had died in 2023, waiting for her missing son," said Navas.

Lohagad Fort murder: Accused Chetan's friend held for role in conspiracy

Express News Service
Pune, September 5

PUNE RURAL police on Saturday arrested a friend of Chetan Chaudhary — an accused in the alleged murder of Ketal Agarawal — Ritesh Hange, for his role in the conspiracy. Ketan Agarwal died on June 18 after he was allegedly pushed off a cliff at Pune's Lohagad Fort.

Police said that while retrieving deleted chats of Chetan, Hange's role in the case came to light.

Hange has been a friend of Chetan since the latter's junior college days, said an officer. "We have arrested Chatan's friend for his role in the conspiracy to murder Ketan Agarwal," said Pune Rural Superintendent of Police, Sandeep Singh Gill.

Hange was produced before a court in Vadgaon Maval on Saturday and remanded to police custody till September 12.

"Hange is a very good friend of Chetan. Probe suggests that Chetan used to share a lot of things with him. Hange was aware of the conspiracy to eliminate Ketan. He knew how it was going to happen and when. On the day following the murder — when the police probe was yet to establish that it was a murder — Chetan and Siya told Hange about what had happened. There have been WhatsApp chats between Hange and Chetan. These communications were deleted by Chetan. But after the forensic examination recovered the deleted data, Hange's role came to light," said an officer from Pune Rural police. Hange has been booked in the case under section 61 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita which pertains to criminal conspiracy.

Investigators alleged that 26-year-old Ketan was pushed off a cliff at Lohagad fort on June 18 as part of a conspiracy allegedly orchestrated by his fiancée Siya and her boyfriend Chetan, who were arrested on June 23. Police said Siya and Ketan got engaged on February 19 and were to marry later this year. However, investigators claim Siya had been in a relationship with Chetan since October last year and was unwilling to go ahead with the marriage.

Both Siya and Chetan are currently in judicial custody.

• THE LONG-PENDING MATTER CAME TO A HEAD ON JULY 18, WHEN MULTI-STOREY BLOCKS WERE RAZED; RESIDENTS DECRIED THE MOVE AS 'ILLEGAL'; NEXT HEARING TOMORROW

50-year-old legacy of land dispute that involves Vadodara's royal family

Dispute revolves around two parcels of land that the royal family says is part of the palace estate and not the temple trust

Aditi Raja
Vadodara, September 5

A PRIME piece of land that was part of the grand Lukshmi Vilas Palace estate in Vadodara till the 1950s has gone to a temple trust following a five-decade dispute. A Gujarat High Court verdict in June went against the titular Maharaja and occupants who had bought it from the erstwhile royal family decades ago.

On July 18, heavy machinery pulled down multi-storey blocks where people had been residing for at least six decades, while sparing the temple of the Yavteshwar Mahadev trust that has staked claim to the entire land.

The Vadodara District Collector, who is also an ex-officio trustee of the temple, had given the occupants a day to vacate.

The royal scion, Samarjitsinh Gaekwad, challenged the Collector's orders on two grounds — the "wrong" law invoked for the demolition process and the allegedly excessive amount of land taken by the temple. Collector Anil Dhameliya was unavailable for comment.

The dispute revolves around land (Survey Numbers 9 and 10) that the royal family said was part of the palace estate.

In 1971, the then Collector, acting as administrator of the Shri Yavteshwar Mahadev Trust, approached the Assistant Charity Commissioner claiming that this land belonged to the Trust.

Lukshmi Vilas Palace estate in Vadodara

In 1979, the Assistant Charity Commissioner held that approximately three bighas in Survey No. 10 and another 29 bighas in Survey No. 9, known as Sitaram Bapu Garden, belonged to the Trust.

In 1985, the Joint Charity Commissioner upheld that finding and directed the Collector to mutate the Trust's name and obtain possession by following "necessary proper and legal steps". Mutation refers to the process of updating ownership details in official records.

The dispute subsequently went to the district court and then the High Court (in 1991).

In the 1991 appeal adjudicated on June 17 this year, Justice J C Doshi upheld the Assistant Charity Commissioner's 1979 order, awarding around 32 bighas (around 51,800 sq metres) to the temple trust.

Following the High Court's decision, Dhameliya issued a notice on July 17, which confers on the collector the power to summarily evict any person found in "wrongful possession" of land. The demolitions took place the very next day, July 18.

The royal family, along with one of the residents, has filed petitions in the High Court against the Collector's eviction order and the demolition. Both petitions argue that possession of the disputed land could only be recovered under the Gujarat Public Trust Act, not the Gujarat Land Revenue Code.

The petition filed by the resident, Khevina Patel, called the July 18 demolitions "illegal" and "conducted without due process".

Gaekwad's petition says structures were pulled down "without giving due notice and following legal procedure". It also claims that the plots covered by the collector's July 17 eviction notice are in possession of the Gujarat HC itself.

The Gujarat High Court stayed the district collector's July order until the next hearing on September 7.

Pak will remain major security threat for times to come: Ex-CDS

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, September 5

PAKISTAN WILL remain a significant security concern and a potential threat in the foreseeable future, former Chief of Defence Staff Gen Anil Chauhan (retd) said on Saturday. He said Pakistan's defence pacts with other countries could foster overconfidence and prompt Islamabad to make miscalculations again.

He also emphasised that India's relationship with China cannot be held hostage to only boundary issues, without referring to any specific issue.

Delivering the GB Pant memorial lecture on 'Threats and Challenges to India's Security', he said Operation Sindoor, holding the Indus Waters Treaty in abeyance and some practical measures may hopefully change or induce behavioural change in Pakistan.

"We've also seen some kind of agreements and accords that they have recently signed. This sometimes, I feel, may induce some kind of overconfidence in Pakistan, and they may make some kind of a miscalculation again. We've got to be careful about that."

Gen Chauhan was referring to Pakistan, Saudi Arabia and Turkiye signing the 'Makkah Joint Defence Agreement' under which an attack against one of them will be treated as an attack against all of them.

"Let me talk about our western neighbour. Pakistan will remain, I think, a major security concern and a threat for times to come," he said.

The former CDS also said the existence of nuclear weapons has created a degree of static stability at the apex level. "And this is what has induced instability at the lowest level. It's classically known as a stability-instability paradox."

He said Pakistan has been trying to reduce space for conventional operations and expand the space for sub-conventional operations, that is, terrorism and cross-border activities, adding that terrorism and proxy war have been central to this approach and strategy.

So, India must go by this premise that terrorism and proxy war will remain a "major challenge" for it, he said, adding that the only way you can defeat it is by creating credible deterrence. "And that's what we demonstrated in three cross-border operations — Uri, then Balakot, and then Operation Sindoor. So, deterrence must operate across the spectrum. India must be able to raise the cost of proxy war and terrorism for Pakistan, so that it stops using this as an instrument of state policy," Gen Chauhan said.

Referring to *The Indian Express* report on Saturday on the scheduled Corps Commander-level talks in the Northeast and the establishment of additional hotlines, Gen Chauhan said it is a welcome development, but India-China relations cannot be held hostage to boundary issues only.

India and China are two major Asian powers, large economies and civilisational states which cooperate in some areas and compete in others.

"That's what we're doing as part of SCO and now as part of BRICS," he said, adding that the future of Asia will depend substantially on how India and China manage this simultaneous rise.

He said the boundary issue (LAC) remains unsettled, and differing perceptions of the boundary, infrastructure construction and force multipliers create "the possibility of friction and escalation".

60 lakh hit by floods in Bihar

People arrive from a flooded area following rise in the water level of Ganga river, in Patna on Saturday. Bihar has so far received 60.8 mm of rain in September, which is 69% above normal. Water level of rivers is rising in different cities following heavy rainfall in the state and neighbouring Nepal. Over 16 lakh people across 11 districts have been affected by the floods, while a large part of the state capital is inundated by swollen rivers. PTI

Family seeks FIR after 7-year-old dies during Dahi Handi event in Mumbai

Express News Service
Mumbai, September 5

A SEVEN-YEAR-OLD boy, Rudra Kadam, was killed while celebrating Dahi Handi in Mumbai's Malvani area after a brick column of a single-storey structure collapsed on Saturday afternoon. His parents have demanded that an FIR be registered against the organisers and that those responsible face legal action.

The festivities saw at least 118 people getting injured in the city, until Saturday evening.

The incident in Malad was reported at 3.01 pm at Ekta Welfare Society in Malvani's Chikuwadi area. A group of children was forming a human pyramid as part of the Dahi Handi celebrations held on Janmashtami when the incident occurred.

A BMC official said the children had been celebrating the festival on their own with a rope carrying the Dahi Handi pot tied between a tree and a brick column of a house. When the children attempted to break the handi, the pressure caused the brick column to give way and collapse.

The falling portion of the brick structure struck Rudra, who was part of the group, on his head, leaving him critically injured. He was rushed to Malvani General Hospital, where doctors declared him dead.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Rudra's mother, Manisha Kadam said he studied in first standard and had gone out to play with his friends when the tragedy struck. "He was celebrating the Dahi Handi festivities close to our home itself. We kept going out at regular intervals to call him and ask him to come back home. By afternoon, some of the people in the area came rushing to us and said that a wall had collapsed. When we rushed there, we saw that Rudra was entirely crushed under the weight of the wall," Rudra's mother said.

The family has demanded that an FIR be registered and that those responsible face legal action.

Yash Kadam, a relative of the deceased boy, alleged that negligence on the part of those conducting the event led to Rudra's death.

"My brother's son has died due to the negligence of the organisers. We demand that an FIR should be registered against the organisers and legal action should be initiated against the accused. We demand justice," Kadam said.

Drug regulator tells states to watch out for 'counterfeit' batch of anti-rabies vaccine

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, September 5

THE COUNTRY'S apex drug regulator has asked all states to keep an eye out for a specific batch of the commonly used anti-rabies vaccine Abhayrab, after samples collected by it from Delhi earlier this year were found to be not potent and misbranded.

There were several errors in the vaccine's packaging text, such as the use of an apostrophe instead of a comma or 'L Pasteur' being spelled as 'L Posteur', changes in the font and text spacing, difference in the company's logo, suggesting that it wasn't a genuine product manufactured by Indian Immunologicals.

"Through a communication dated 27 August 2026, the DCGI (Drugs Controller General of India) requested all State Drugs Controllers to alert their inspectorate staff and maintain strict vigilance over the movement, distribution and availability of the abovementioned batch of the drug. The State Drug Control authorities were also requested to take appropriate regulatory action," said a public notice by the Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO).

The drug regulator also confirmed that the batch in question was never exported out of India.

Last year, the same vaccine came under scrutiny by several international drug regulators, including those from the UK, US, and Australia, over concerns of such counterfeit batches. With rabies being an almost 100% fatal infection, some of the countries also asked people who had received Abhayrab to get another shot as a precaution. This was also similarly recognised during market surveillance.

"In connection with the case, a total of four persons have been arrested by the Delhi Police. Further investigation and appropriate legal action are being undertaken by the competent authorities," said the CDSCO.

While there are several brands of rabies vaccines in India, manufactured by both national and international companies, Abhayrab is one of the most commonly available. The vaccine holds nearly 40% of the market share in the country.

Uttarakhand: Action against 5 more madrasas as new education regime takes form

Express News Service
Dehradun, September 5

NEARLY TWO months after Uttarakhand abolished its statutory Madrasa Board and replaced it with a new authority governing minority educational institutions, the state government said Saturday that action against unrecognised madrasas continues, with five more institutions in Dehradun and Haldwani sealed or shut down.

The latest action takes the number of madrasas shut down across the state to 20, the government said. Of these, 17 have been sealed, while the managements of three have submitted written confirmations that they have stopped operations.

"The state government's action against madrasas not complying with prescribed recognition requirements and educational standards is continuing," Minority Affairs Secretary Dr Parag Madhukar Dhakate said in a statement. "No educational institution in the state will be allowed to operate without complying with prescribed rules and recognition requirements," Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami said.

The action comes against the backdrop of a broader overhaul of the state's minority education system.

EXPRESS special

Inheritance to halala: Uttarakhand Waqf Board's bid to recast *nikahnama*

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
New Delhi, September 5

THE UTTARAKHAND Waqf Board is preparing a revised *nikahnama* to align with the provisions of the Uniform Civil Code (UCC), with a key proposal that daughters should have an equal share in their father's property even after marriage, Board chairman Shadab Shams said.

Contrary to Sharia law, under which a daughter is legally entitled to a fixed share of her parent's inheritance — generally half of a son's share when they inherit together — Shams said the provision would state that a daughter would remain an equal stakeholder in her father's property after marriage.

The move comes around one-and-a-half years after the UCC was introduced in Uttarakhand. Shams said the existing nikahnama contains columns for first, second and third marriages, and the revised document would remove the need for such columns since, under the UCC, a Muslim man cannot have more than one marriage.

The proposed nikahnama will also state that a Muslim woman cannot be given triple talaq.

Another provision will deal with halala, which Shams referred to in the context of cases where women are allegedly forced into the practice. It is a practice in which a woman, after receiving an irrevocable final divorce from her husband, marries another man, consummates that marriage, and then divorces or is widowed, allowing her to remarry her former husband.

> Contrary to Sharia law, new provision would state that a daughter would remain an equal stakeholder in her father's property after marriage

The UCC does not allow a woman to be forcibly made to undergo halala and states that those involved could face criminal action.

The Board plans to put this message in the nikahnama so that women are aware of their rights, Shams said, adding that it also plans to include a toll-free number where women can report problems.

The proposed document will also address iddat, the period of mourning observed by a Muslim woman after her husband's death.

The traditional period after a husband's death is four months and 10 days, but the proposed provision would state that a woman should be free to decide how long she wants to observe it.

The Board also plans to address cases involving religious conversion for marriage. Shams said a woman from another religion should not be married through conversion for the purpose of conducting a nikah. If she wants to marry someone from another religion, he said, the couple should use the Special Marriage Act through the court.

The Board proposes IDs for all qazis conducting nikahs, with only those carrying Board-issued identification allowed to solemnise marriages.

Shams said the process would also require the couple to be adults, with proper identity documents, the woman at least 18 and the man at least 21. Witnesses from both sides would also be required to have Aadhaar cards.

This system, it is learnt, was intended to prevent disputes and police cases arising from unauthorised marriages and allegations of forced conversion. He said it would also help protect qazis from being pressured into conducting marriages.

The draft is still under preparation. The Board had held discussions with UCC draft committee members, former Uttarakhand chief secretary Shatrughan Singh, Doon University Vice-Chancellor Surekha Dangwal and social activist Manu Gaur Singh, as well as Uttarakhand Minority Welfare Minister Khajan Das.

The Board will next consult Muslim ulema and religious leaders, as well as Muslim lawyers and legal experts.

Shams said the aim was not to create a clash with anyone but to make the Muslim community aware of the law and bring about reforms while taking the community along.

The Board is also seeking a common approach across Shia and Sunni groups and different schools of thought.

A Board proposal for the revised nikahnama had already been passed by the Uttarakhand Waqf Board earlier this year, and another discussion was scheduled for September 9 before the document is finalised.

Gujarat couple in their 50s, who lost their doctor son to suicide, win IVF legal battle

Aditi Raja
Vadodara, September 5

AFTER LOSING their 25-year-old son–a doctor pursuing postgraduate medical studies–to suicide in his Jaipur medical college hostel room four years ago, a Gujarat couple in their 50s decided to attempt to rebuild their family through IVF. However, their hope ran into an unexpected barrier: the mother had crossed the statutory age limit for assisted reproduction, even though the father remained within the age limit prescribed under the law.

The High Court has now removed that legal obstacle, allowing the couple to seek assisted reproductive technology services after finding that their case was covered by a series of HC precedents on how the age limits under the Assisted Reproductive Technology (Regulation) Act, 2021, apply to married couples.

The ruling, however, does not itself guarantee that the couple will undergo a particular IVF procedure. Their medical suitability and the manner in which treatment may be carried out will remain matters for an appropriate assisted reproductive technology clinic and treating doctors

In a 17-page judgment dated September 2, Justice Nirzar S Desai allowed the couple's petition and set aside the rejection of their request to undergo IVF treatment. The court said the petition was required to be allowed after noting that the respondents had not placed before it any judgment taking a contrary view.

The identities of the couple are being withheld due to a specific clause of the ART Act, cited in the Gujarat HC judgment. According to the HC judgment, the couple had a son and a daughter. Their son, 25, died by suicide in May 2022.

The couple's attempt to undergo IVF began at a clinic in Mehsana but was stopped at the threshold because of the age limits laid down in the 2021 law. The couple's advocate Mohit Banker challenged that decision, relying on the Act's definition of a "commissioning couple", which refers to an infertile married couple approaching an authorised assisted reproductive technology clinic or bank for treatment.

Their counsel told the court that "the fertility of the couple is required to be considered and not that of an individual partner".

Declared 'illegal', mosque at Saharanpur collectorate razed, Opp calls it 'black day'

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, September 5

TWO MONTHS after it was declared "illegal", a mosque in the collectorate complex in Uttar Pradesh's Saharanpur was demolished early Saturday morning amid heavy police deployment, with the mosque management committee alleging that the action was carried out without following due process.

The move follows a September 2 ruling by a local court which dismissed an appeal by the mosque management against the city magistrate's July order declaring the structure "unauthorised" and ordering its eviction.

Justifying the action, Saharanpur City Magistrate Kuldeep Singh told *The Indian Express* the mosque was demolished since an appeal against his July eviction order was dismissed by the higher court, and that the demolition was initiated at around 6:45 am so that it could be completed early.

Saharanpur Range Deputy Inspector General (DIG) Abhishek Singh said, "We followed all legal procedures while taking action and took all preventive steps to maintain law and order.

The court of the city magistrate had found the mosque at the collectorate to be illegally constructed on government land. Also, the appeal of the mosque committee was rejected."

Tanveer Ahmed, the mutawalli (custodian) of the mosque, alleged the action was carried out without any demolition order and that due process was not followed.

Claiming that the mosque was nearly 150 years old, Ahmed said, "The city magistrate passed an eviction (*bedakhli*) order in July, directing that the premises be vacated within 30 days. We challenged the order before the court of the district judge, which dismissed our petition on September 2. There was no order for demolition but the structure was demolished today."

Slamming the move, the Opposition parties hit out at the Yogi Adityanath-led BJP government in the state, alleging it was an attack on the country's Constitution.

Talking to mediapersons, Congress MP from Saharanpur Imran Masood called it "a black day for the people of Saharanpur". "It is an attack on the country's Constitution. We will fight this battle..."

Yerawada prison's women's team qualifies for global chess championship

Sushant Kulkarni
Pune, September 5

"CHESS TEACHES us to think several moves ahead. If I had done that before making the mistakes in my life, I would not have been here," an inmate in her 40s at Yerawada Women's Prison told her coach, Pradnya Khaire, during an endgame lesson a few weeks ago. As Khaire explained how a single move can decide a game, the lesson seemed to reach beyond the board.

"We learnt that every move has consequences and invites a response from the opponent. In life, too, every decision sets something in motion," said another team member to Khaire during a recent practice session.

For the six women on Yerawada's team, chess has become an exercise in patience, strategy and consequences. The team has now, for the first time, qualified for the FIDE Intercontinental Chess Championship for Prisoners. The championship will bring together correctional institutions from across world.

"For these female inmates, it is not just an international competition, but an opportunity to put into practice a lesson they have learned one move at a time: think ahead," said Sunil Dhamal, Superintendent of Yerawada Central Prison.

One of the oldest prisons in India, established in 1871, Yerawada Central Prisons Women's wing was established in 1927. It houses around 250 inmates.

The biggest-ever chess event among correctional facilities, the FIDE Intercontinental Chess Championship for Prisoners, organised by International Chess Federation (Fédération Internationale des Échecs) or FIDE and the Chicago Cook County Sheriff's Office, is part of the Chess for Freedom programme and a continuation of the international championship first held in 2019.

The sixth edition of the championship will be held online from October 15 to 17. "The six-member team has four main players and two reserves, selected from 20 inmates who play chess," said Khaire. The players, aged from their early 20s to early 50s, are either convicted or awaiting trial for serious offences, including murder, kidnapping and assault.

The foundation for Yerawada Central Prison's chess programme was laid in 2021 as part of Indian Oil Corporation's (IOC) nationwide initiative, Parivartan: Prison to Pride.

Conceived under the leadership of then-chairman Shrikant Madhav Vaidya, the programme sought to bring chess into prisons across the country.

The four members of the team during the Asia qualifiers. EXPRESS

Indian Chess Grandmaster Abhijit Kunte is the mentor for the programme. In 2024, Pradnya Khaire was roped in as trainer for the women's team. Her husband, Ketan Khaire has been coaching the men's team.

The men's team won bronze in 2022, gold in 2023, finished fourth in 2024 and won gold again in 2025.

"In 2024, we began basic training with a group of inmates. The women's team entered the Asian continental qualifiers in 2025 but did not advance. This year, after intensive training, they cleared the Asia round in May and qualified for the Intercontinental Championship in October. They train on computers and physical boards inside the prison, with a dedicated laptop coming soon. Some practice sessions stretch late into the night, often drawing fellow inmates to watch. For those hours, chess offers a way beyond the confines of prison life. Among those gathered around boards, today's spectators can become tomorrow's players," said.

Currently the team is taking lessons on specific openings and endgames and is working on its time management.

The intercontinental event will take place on Chess.com using a 10-minute time control with a five-second increment per move. On October 15, teams will compete in round-robin groups of up to eight, grouped by time zone for fair play. No two teams from the same country will be placed in the same group.

From India, in the women's category, teams from Yerawada and Bhopal prison have qualified. For their training, Khaire is accompanied by assistant coach Arya Pise and the programme receives guidance from Additional Director General (Prisons) Suhas Warke and Special Inspector General Yogesh Desai.

They began with the fundamentals — castling, en passant, pawn promotion, piece development, basic tactics, checkmate patterns and simple endgames — before progressing to pawn structures, piece coordination, tactical combinations, candidate moves, calculation, opening plans and advanced endgame concepts

"Chess demands focus and foresight and is widely used as a constructive correctional activity. Beyond providing a positive distraction, it builds patience, strategic thinking, decision-making and ability to consider consequences before acting. We are seeing positive change in inmates who participate," said a prison department officer.

"The prison department is proud of the inmates for qualifying for the intercontinentals for the first time. We wish them success and hope they bring home medals," said Superintendent Dhamal.

"One key lesson is that every move changes the board. You must visualise the position and anticipate your opponent's response before moving. It's a lesson that applies far beyond the 64 squares," coach Khaire said.

The economy, its math and politics

OFF THE RECORD
BY P VAIDYANATHAN IYER

THE GOVERNMENT machinery was on an overdrive the last few days responding to one former bureaucrat who wrongly debunked the robust growth estimates for April-June 2026. The bureaucrat, Subhash Chandra Garg, was the Economic Affairs Secretary in the Ministry of Finance for over two years from June 2017 to July 2019, and was designated the Finance Secretary in his last four months in the ministry. The Finance Secretary is the 'first among equals' in the Ministry which has six secretaries now, each heading one of the six departments — Expenditure, Revenue, Economic affairs, Financial Services, Investment and Public Asset Management, and Public Enterprises.

The government was spooked after Garg claimed in an interview to a television channel (NDTV) and later wrote in a piece for an online site (thequint.com) that the nominal GDP (Gross Domestic Product) growth rate in the first quarter of 2026-27 was a 'lowly' 2.6 per cent, and not 10.3 per cent as estimated by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation. Adjusted for 2-2.5 per cent inflation, he claimed the real growth rate will be zero and not the 'designer number' 7.8 per cent estimated by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI).

In doing so, Garg did something egregious. He definitely knows better than this, having played a key role in pushing through some of the most controversial agendas in the first term of the Narendra Modi government such as electoral bonds for political funding, and higher surplus transfers from RBI to the Centre. He elaborates on both these issues in his book *We Also Make Policy*.

Everybody got Garg's wrong maths, but what also matters in the street is perception. Garg's claims, though misleading, resonated with some coming as they did in the backdrop of the Jantar Mantar protests, an education system that admittedly does not leave its graduates 'job ready', and a demography which pushes more than a crore youth into the job market every year.

Not surprising then, the Congress and some of its leaders pounced on this and amplified it. But what is surprising is that Rahul Gandhi, who is a strong critic of the economic policies of the Narendra Modi government, chose prudently not to comment on Garg's claims. His silence was loud and meant wrong maths can't be defended.

> What is surprising is that Rahul Gandhi, who is a strong critic of the economic policies of the Narendra Modi government, chose prudently not to comment on Garg's claims. His silence was loud and meant wrong maths can't be defended

Rajya Sabha member Praveen Chakravarty, hit out at the government's economic management, but said in a piece for *The New Indian Express* that "there is a lot that is wrong with India's economy... but the sheer math behind the 7.8 per cent real GDP growth is not one of them, contrary to what a former government bureaucrat has claimed".

But Subhash Garg did leave the government firefighting much of the week after the GDP estimates were released. To reject what he said, it is key to understand two concepts: i) why is a base year needed while calculating GDP growth rate, and ii) why is the base year changed once in every 5-6 years, and when this is done, how is GDP calculated.

CONCEPT 1: Need for a base year. Simply put, a base year is needed to understand if the economy or the GDP has indeed grown, adjusting for the impact of price rise. For example, let's assume Country X produces only crude oil, so the market value of its crude oil becomes its GDP. Say, in year 1, it produces 10 million barrels of crude oil and sells it for $10 a barrel; its GDP will be $100 million (10 million barrels X 10/ barrel). In year 2, it produces only 5 million barrels, and oil prices have risen to $30 a barrel. So, its GDP will be $150 million (5 million barrels X 30/ barrel). So, even though the country has produced less oil, its GDP has risen 50 per cent from $100 million to $150 million. A base year helps tell the real GDP growth by removing the impact of prices. If year 1 is taken as the base year, the oil price of that year becomes the reference for the following years. So, the real GDP of year 2 will be $50 million (5 million barrels x $10 a barrel, which is the price of crude oil per barrel in the base year). So, in this example, the GDP has shrunk by 50% to $50 million from $100 million.

CONCEPT 2: Why the base year is changed. Products and services on which people spend money today, be it food and clothes or travel and entertainment, has changed significantly from a decade ago. As years roll by, the market value of products and services change. So does technology and methodology, that enable a more precise and fast capture of output and prices. The base year is changed to account for all these. And when the base year changes, the GDP values naturally change, and growth is calculated by considering the new GDP values of two comparable periods.

When MoSPI changed the base year from 2011-12 to 2022-23 in February this year, the GDP values changed for all years from 2011-12 till date. Garg took the GDP value of April-June 2025 calculated using the 2011-12 base year and the GDP value of April-June 2026 calculated using the 2022-23 base year, to calculate the first quarter GDP growth rate for this year. Using numbers from two different series is patently wrong.

The writer is Managing Editor, The Indian Express. Off the Record is a fortnightly column

Signs of political change

FIFTH COLUMN
BY TAVLEEN SINGH

THERE IS a new political mood in Delhi. It is complex and hard to define but I shall give it my best shot. In this past week of grey skies and muggy, rainy days, I have wandered about talking to friends who have been in politics for long enough to have reliable opinions. Some are close friends to whom I turn when I am not sure whether I am reading the mood right or not. I went to meet them and said that I detected that something fundamental had changed in recent weeks. They agreed and said that the most crucial thing that had changed was that people seemed no longer scared.

Here I need to give you some context. I have never denied that when Narendra Modi first became prime minister, I was one of his most devoted devotees. But allow me to tell you why. My childhood and most of my growing years were spent in that 'socialist' India that was defined by shortages of everything from sugar and spice to bread and milk. I remember queues at ration shops of people waiting for sugar. It always disappeared just before festivals like Janmashtami and Diwali. As for things like cooking gas or a telephone, you needed political connections to get these.

Modi arrived on the national political stage saying he believed in free markets and that it was 'not the business of government to do business.' Words that were music to my ears since it is my considered opinion that India would have been a rich country had our economic policymakers not been 'socialist'. In the name of socialism, they built a huge, unwieldy, mostly unprofitable public sector instead of building schools and hospitals. When Modi took the same economic road, I was disappointed.

What disappointed me more was that he became a prime minister of the strongman kind and instilled fear into the polluted air we breathed. Almost the first victim of his strongman policies was the media. When people speak contemptuously of the 'Godi Media', they need to understand that it has been dangerous to displease the government. Delhi which has a tradition of people speaking about politics raucously in restaurants and cafes became, till just the other day, a city in which people looked nervously around before saying anything critical of government policies in a public place.

The Cockroach Janta Party may achieve nothing in the future, but it has already achieved a great deal by taking fear out of the Delhi air and kicking it into the dustbin. This has encouraged others to do the same. Last week two Muslim women journalists who were badly treated by the Delhi Police refused to accept this lying down and made videos of their injuries to put on social media.

When a Hindutva thug came forward to boast on camera that he was responsible for causing serious head injuries to a Jantar Mantar protester's father, he was quickly forced to backtrack. He had boasted that it was his connection to important BJP leaders that acted as his shield and kept him from being arrested. Then he quickly retracted this statement and made it more ambiguous. The cockroaches were by then back in protest mode marching to Parliament Street police station to force the Delhi Police to do its job and charge this Hindutva thug with attempted murder.

These may seem like small things. They are not. From the time that Modi became prime minister for a second term he has consciously cultivated the image of a strongman who tolerates neither dissent nor disagreement. Elderly Maoists ended up in jail for being 'urban Naxals'. Some were treated so badly that they died. The message went home swiftly to future dissidents and most of them either retired into the shadows or learned to watch what they said. In Bollywood those who made films that seemed not to be patriotic enough also retired into the shadows. The fear that spread was not imaginary. It was backed up by the weaponisation of state agencies.

The prime minister on his foreign travels assures democratic leaders and his devotees in the diaspora that India is the 'mother of democracy' and so democratic practices came naturally to Indians. International democracy watchdogs were not convinced. Freedom House moved India from 'free' to 'partly free' five years ago and that is where we remain. Other watchdogs like Sweden's V-Dem put India among ten countries in which liberal democracy has declined fastest in the past decade.

For someone like me who has seen Delhi change because of this diminishment of liberal democracy it has been depressing to see the city change. This is why it cheered me up enormously to discover last week from my conversations with old political friends that they agreed that something vital has begun to change. The Prime Minister himself has changed his mode of public discourse. When he first changed his platform to Instagram, he posted a reel in which he 'forgave' the young women who he said had insulted him and his late mother from Jantar Mantar.

He appeared soon to notice that this approach was not working. His recent reels have taken a more conciliatory tone. Does this mean that he has decided to ditch being a strongman and act more like an elected leader, a humble servant of the people? Perhaps not. But something does seem to have changed.

INSIDE TRACK | BY COOMI KAPOOR

OUTSIDERS UNWELCOME

Diplomatic insiders in both Delhi and Bangladesh see a powerful lobby in the external affairs ministry playing a part in thwarting efforts to bring about a rapprochement in Indo-Bangladesh ties. The MEA is perhaps upset over Modi's appointment of a non-IFS officer, politician Dinesh Trivedi, as India's High Commissioner to Bangladesh. In a meeting with Indian envoys earlier this year, Modi hinted at more non-IFS ambassadorial appointments in our neighbourhood. Trivedi's efforts at bridging the growing gulf between the neighbours, even persuading Bangladesh PM Tarique Rahman to agree to dates for a visit to India, was not appreciated by all. After the dates leaked, the MEA acted as a spoiler. Ignoring conventional foreign policy protocol, it permitted Sheikh Hasina to hold a virtual press conference at Delhi's Foreign Correspondents Club, where she attacked her country's government. (It is pertinent to note that a year ago, the MEA stymied a proposed Hasina press conference at the Delhi Press Club and in 2018, denied permission to a British emissary to speak on behalf of late Khaleda Zia, then jailed in Bangladesh. Belatedly, two weeks after a Hasina press conference, when the FCC tried to organise a foreign policy seminar which had speakers with alleged Awami League links, the government ordered its cancellation and some 50 policemen descended on the club premises!)

Incidentally, the MEA's non-conciliatory tone is echoed by some former Indian diplomats in articles, suggesting Rahman's visit was in fact called off because of internal differences within Bangladesh over its foreign policy direction towards India. Embittered feelings on both sides indicate Rahman is unlikely to attend the BRICS summit in Delhi.

DIVISIONS AT HOME

The Home Ministry is on the backfoot after the police overreach towards CJP student protesters. However, just a month after the much-criticised July police crackdown, Cabinet Secretary Dr T V Somanathan and Home Secretary Govind Mohan, who were both due to retire this month, were given a year's extension. The extensions are believed to reflect the PM's appreciation of the two senior officials' mature decision to refuse to succumb to political pressure that called for more stringent action during the Jantar Mantar agitation. The Home Secretary reportedly helped salvage the situation by halting the firing of pellets, a draconian measure which backfired badly. He was backed by the Cabinet Secretary. The Delhi Police's harsh methods were adopted within three days of the abrupt transfer of commissioner Satish Golcha, who was replaced by Anurag Kumar, the Intelligence Bureau special director, in the belief that his background would help in dispersing the restive students. In fact, the reverse happened, the confrontation escalated. A fallout of the Jantar Mantar debacle is that officials are increasingly requesting for written ministerial orders.

UNFAIR CLUBBING TOGETHER

BJP MPs who decry what they term as Delhi's Lutyens culture have little sympathy for the government's eviction notice to the Gymkhana Club. They think club culture is perpetrated to make those excluded feel like lesser mortals. A minister recalls when he came to Delhi years ago as a visitor in connection with a case in the Supreme Court, he was taken by his lawyer to the India International Centre for tea. He was made to feel like an outsider and suspected it was because he did not speak in English. His prejudice against the IIC may be misconceived, and the comparison unfair. The IIC membership criteria is based on a prospective candidate's professional accomplishments and an interest in foreign affairs, while the complaint against the Gymkhana is its entrenched hereditary membership and elitism.

NON-PARSIS' EXCLUSION

There was an interesting subplot in the tussle for control of the Tata empire. Some months ago, when then trustee Mehli Mistry raised the issue of the 1923 deed of the Bai Hirabai Tata Charitable Foundation, which stipulates that all trustees should be Parsis, the assumption was that he was merely targeting the two non-Parsi trustees, Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh. But some Parsis suspected he might also be hinting at Noel Tata. As Naval Tata's son, Noel's Parsi credentials should be impeccable, but a few old-timers quibbled that Noel's late mother, nee Simone Dunoyer, was a Christian. They could not recall a young Noel's *navjote* ceremony, the initiation rite for being inducted into the faith. In fact, there is no ambiguity about Noel's standing as a Parsi. Before his marriage to tycoon Shapoorji Pallonji Mistry's daughter, Aloo, the conservative and deeply religious Shapoorji insisted that his prospective son-in-law go through the *navjote* ritual before the wedding.

India held together by making room for linguistic identity

HISTORY HEADLINE
BY SHUBHAM KUMAR

BY DECEMBER 3, 1952, the telegrams reaching Jawaharlal Nehru had become frantic. Potti Sriramulu was on the 46th day of a fast unto death. He wanted a state for the Telugu-speaking districts of Madras. Nehru told Chief Minister C Rajagopalachari that he was "totally unmoved" and would ignore the fast.

The telegrams kept coming. Madras Governor Sri Prakasa warned of the consequences if Sriramulu died. Union Labour Minister VV Giri said delays would deepen bitterness in Andhra. Nehru's own words soon revealed his unease: the Andhra dispute had become a "festering sore".

On December 9, Nehru told the Council of States that the government was prepared to create Andhra from the uncontested Telugu-speaking areas, excluding Madras city. Six days later, Sriramulu died on the 58th day of his fast. Hartals and violence followed. Nehru recorded disturbances at Vijayawada railway station; Parliament received notices of damage to railway property, disrupted communications and some police action.

In a letter to Rajaji the day after, Nehru maintained that the proposed step followed his December 9 statement and was not prompted by the death. Speaking in Parliament, however, he recognised what the country had seen: the Andhra question had become "entangled with the self-sacrifice" of Sriramulu. By December 20, the hesitation in his letters had given way to haste. The government had taken its first definite step towards Andhra, he told Rajaji, and the sooner it was completed, the better.

In 17 days, Nehru's refusal to be spurred by the fast had become an insistence on speed. The Union government was forced to face a question it had postponed since Independence. Would states built around language pull India apart, or would the refusal to create them provoke greater unrest?

The Congress had not always feared the answer. In Nagpur in 1920, it reorganised its provincial committees along linguistic lines. Campaigning in languages people spoke helped it become a mass movement. Gandhi

Jawaharlal Nehru with C Rajagopalachari.
NEHRU ARCHIVE

supported linguistic provinces, though he warned against weakening Indian unity. Then came Partition. Princely States had only been integrated. The government feared that a province with a dominant language might begin to see itself as a nation. In 1948, the Linguistic Provinces Commission, led by Justice SK Dar, advised against reorganising provinces primarily by language. A year later, the JVP Committee of Nehru, Vallabhbhai Patel and Pattabhi Sitaramayya recommended postponement, while accepting that insistent public sentiment might prevail. The Constituent Assembly had already ensured that India's internal borders would not be permanent. Members debated whether Parliament should need a state's consent before changing its name, area or boundary. Article 3 required the state legislature to be consulted but gave it no veto. Parliament had the power to redraw the map.

Once Andhra state was created on October 1, 1953, demands from Marathi, Kannada and Malayalam speakers could no longer be dismissed. Nehru asked Justice Fazl Ali to chair the States Reorganisation Commission. The assignment, he wrote, might involve "the drawing up of a new map of India". HN Kunzru and KM Panikkar joined Fazl Ali. The three commissioners spent two years listening to competing versions of the map. Even after the deadline, memoranda, resolutions and telegrams kept arriving. The Commission received 1,52,250 documents, travelled over 38,000 miles and interviewed over 9,000 people.

Their report explained why language could no longer be ignored. Universal adult franchise required the government to work in languages voters understood. In multilingual provinces, communities also suspected one another of monopolising public jobs, development funds and political power. The commissioners stopped short of treating language as the only test. A new state also needed revenue, administrative capacity and safeguards for minorities. They warned that if a linguistic state were treated as the exclusive homeland of its largest community, people speaking other languages could be reduced to "alien settlers". A state could conduct business in the regional language without treating some residents as guests.

Bombay showed how difficult that balance would be. In his 1948 memorandum, Maharashtra as a Linguistic Province, BR Ambedkar supported a united Maharashtra with Bombay as its capital. On the city's Gujarati commercial interests, he borrowed Lord Birkenhead's reply to Irish leader John Redmond: there were cases where "a minority is a majority". By 1955, however, Ambedkar had changed his proposal — he now favoured several Marathi-speaking states and a separate city-state centred on Bombay.

The quarrel spilt out of the meeting rooms into the streets. The Samyukta Maharashtra movement claimed Bombay for Maharashtra; the Mahagujarat movement pressed the Gujarati claim. CD Deshmukh resigned as Nehru's Finance Minister over provisions concerning Bombay in the States Reorganisation Bill. By February 1956, even Nehru's language had changed. He wrote of of Bombay "wounding itself". The question was no longer simply where the city would fall on the map, but whether its people could live together after the line had been drawn.

When the States Reorganisation Act and the Constitution's Seventh Amendment came into force on November 1, 1956, India had 14 states and six UTs. Marathi- and Gujarati-speaking regions were placed together in an enlarged bilingual Bombay state.

The arrangement was soon tested. After the 1957 election, Nehru told Vijaya Lakshmi Pandit that Congress had been "very badly beaten" in Maharashtra proper and much of Gujarat. The leadership had believed that the bilingual state was broadly acceptable. The results in Maharashtra and much of Gujarat showed otherwise. In 1960, Parliament returned to the map, creating Maharashtra and Gujarat. This August 31 marked 70 years since the Act received presidential assent.

Sriramulu did not live to see Andhra appear on the map. The Parliament would draw some lines drawn in 1956 again. India's leaders had feared that linguistic states would pull the country apart. Instead, the map gave its diversity room to breathe.

The writer is a constitutional lawyer

We are like this only

ON THE LOOSE
BY LEHER KALA

IN A video shot on an Indigo flight, around 15 people can be seen feasting on homemade snacks served on disposable plates, the airplane aisle randomly turned into a personal fiefdom. *Theplas* and *dhoklas* were passed around with people moving busily between rows without a care in the world for the passengers who weren't invited to this makeshift party. Unsurprisingly, the Internet weighed in, mostly to lament a chronic Indian malaise — an utter disregard for cabin etiquette, and manners in general. The questions have been raised before: Why is even basic self awareness nonexistent among Indians? How is it that we feel no discomfort at the thought that our actions might inconvenience others?

An enterprising girl I knew had started "etiquette" classes for 4- to 10-year-olds. The "coursework", other than learning the distinction between "Can I" and "May I", was never to interrupt someone while they are talking (bless her), and learning to queue up. These are lessons that should be inculcated at home, except, sadly, in our dog-eat-dog world, Indians see education as a race to excel in Maths and Physics, not integrity or consideration for others.

There seems to be an inbuilt insecurity — probably the legacy of scarcity — that if we don't grab and seize the benefits meant for everyone, we'll fall by the wayside. It's not entirely untrue. Fifteen lakh students compete for 18,000 undergraduate seats at IIT. The scene is no different for government jobs, Bollywood, law, art and pretty much every career one can think of. Making it big involves a clever mix of talent, luck, effort and, more often than not, unscrupulous rule breaking.

This bitter knowledge percolates into all aspects of our lives. Most of us have come to the conclusion the benefits accrued by shoving and pushing our way to the front, outweighs the costs. So, if some passengers are affronted by the aromas of chutneys and traditional snacks on a plane, who cares? It's not like they can do anything about it. In the same vein, we honk away and jump red lights with alacrity and, much to the horror of foreigners, feel entitled to break into the garba on a German metro. Repeated studies have shown, as the stakes go up, so does the rate of transgressions. For example, doping prevalence is way higher at the Olympics than at the Commonwealth Games. Modern thinking cynically goes, when faced with a difficult situation, one must do the right thing for oneself.

In the age of AI, it is a depressing reality that the bar for unethical practices has been dramatically lowered. Students don't see using ChatGPT to submit assignments as fundamentally wrong. The excuses are everyone else is doing it, so we don't have a choice. Perhaps, we need to acknowledge that circumstances play a role in behaviour too. Life is too much of a struggle to expect students to get by on an ordinary grade. If the perception is, there are no rewards for being average but honest, how should we live? The only way to get people to think beyond their own selfish ambitions is to develop a moral compass at the school level itself. In the convent I attended till I was 10, Moral Science was a daily period. Stories from *The Bible* and the *Mahabharata* demonstrated lessons of perseverance and bravery and subtly built perspective among awestruck children. We developed a set of values and a respect for rules. The personal glories and mistakes of, say, a Yudhisthir, depict universal human experiences across generations, providing a blueprint for a life well lived. Others' trials and travails convey a precious truth, that we are all the same; we don't, necessarily, need to trample on anyone to get ahead.

The writer is director, Hutkay Films

NEPAL DISASTER: AROUND 5,000 REMAIN MISSING; MORE THAN 13,100 RESCUED

60-yr-old woman, Chinese national rescued 10 days after flash floods

900 workers still unaccounted for, rescue ops intensify

Press Trust of India
Nuwakot, Kathmandu, September 5

A 60-YEAR-old woman and a Chinese national were rescued alive on Saturday after being trapped for 10 days following devastating floods in Nepal, according to local media reports and the Nepali Army.

Chandika Shrestha, 60, was pulled out unconscious from the upper floor of a four-storey house buried under debris in Betrawati, Nuwakot district, *The Kathmandu Post* reported.

A nine-member Armed Police Force team rescued Shrestha from the house in Bidur Municipality-10 and flew her by helicopter to the Nepali Army's Maithili Barracks in Trishuli for initial treatment. She would be brought to Kathmandu for further treatment if necessary, the Nepal Prime Minister's Office was quoted as saying.

Separately, a Chinese national was rescued alive from a hydropower tunnel in flood-hit Rasuwa district, 10 days after the project was struck by floods.

The man, identified as Luhaitao, was trapped inside Audit Tunnel 4 of the Upper Trishuli 1 Hydropower Project.

"A joint rescue team comprising the Nepali Army and foreign rescuers has rescued a Chinese national, Luhaitao, alive from inside a tunnel at the Upper Trishuli-1 Hydropower Project," the Nepali Army said.

Luhaitao was rescued at 1.30 pm from a point approximately 225 metres inside the tunnel. His health was being assessed while search and rescue operations continued, the army said.

The latest rescue brings to three the number of workers pulled alive from Trishuli hydropower projects. Two Nepalese workers, Kabir Maharjan, 45, and Sanjay Sah, 30, were rescued from a tunnel at the Trishuli 3A hydropower plant on Friday.

The rescues came on the 11th day of the Bhotekoshi flood, which devastated towns and villages in northern and central Nepal. The flash floods, triggered by an ice-rock avalanche near the Nepal-Tibet border on August 26, killed more than 1,300 people, while around 4,900 remained missing, while over 13,100 people have been rescued, officials said.

At least 900 workers are missing from a dozen hydropower projects, with about 500 believed to be inside tunnels.

60-year-old Chandika Shrestha (left), after she was rescued from a house in Nuwakot ; Army personnel rescue a Chinese national from a hydropower tunnel during a rescue operation district on Saturday. PTI

PM Shah to address UN session to voice concern over climate change

Press Trust of India
Kathmandu, September 5

NEPAL PRIME Minister Balendra Shah will visit the US later this month to address the 81st session of the UN General Assembly, where he is likely to raise the issue of climate change and seek compensation from the international community over the devastating flash floods.

Shah is scheduled to address the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) session in New York on September 24, according to the UN's official speaking schedule. This would be his first foreign trip since taking office on March 27.

Shah will lead the Nepalese delegation to the UNGA, Foreign Ministry sources said. Discussions and consultations are underway at various levels to formulate Nepal's position for the UNGA.

Nepal is likely to raise the issue of climate change and campaign for compensation from the international community during Shah's address to the UNGA. Foreign Minister Shisir Khanal will accompany Shah on the high-level visit.

Putin, Zelenskyy agree to pause strikes amid talks with US envoys

Associated Press
Moscow, September 5

THE LEADERS of Russia and Ukraine on Saturday agreed to pause strikes on each other's capitals while US envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner hold talks to try to revive a stalled push to end Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine.

"(Russian President Vladimir) Putin has ordered that no strikes be carried out against Kyiv for three days, starting at midnight today," presidential spokesperson Dmitry Peskov told Russia's *Tass* news agency.

He said the decision was tied to Witkoff and Kushner's planned visit to the Ukrainian capital, which Kyiv has said will take place on Sunday.

Peskov also confirmed that Kushner and Witkoff would meet Putin during their Moscow visit on Saturday, but said there was "no talk of new ideas" to end the conflict.

The envoys' trip comes as both sides escalate aerial attacks, some 4 1/2 years after the Kremlin's invasion of its neighbour. Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said that Ukraine was prepared to halt strikes on Moscow until Monday.

He said he spoke on Saturday afternoon with the US delegation after their arrival in Moscow.

"From now through the end of Saturday, as well as on Sunday and Monday, Ukraine is ready to refrain from strikes on Moscow, and we expect the Russians to do the same regarding Kyiv," he said. He had urged Russia Friday to reciprocate halt in airstrikes.

The envoys were met at the airport in Moscow by Russian envoy Kirill Dmitriev, *Tass* reported. Dmitriev shared photos of him meeting the US delegation as they disembarked, alongside the caption, "Welcome to Moscow Peacemakers."

With peace efforts stalled, Russia has intensified its attacks on Kyiv and other cities with relentless bombardments recently stretching into daylight hours, taking advantage of Ukraine's shortage of air defence systems.

In a social media post on Saturday, Zelenskyy said that Russia had carried out overnight strikes on Kyiv and Boryspil international airports, and linked the attack to the planned US visit. "Clearly, these Russian strikes on the airports are a reaction to the discussions and preparations for the possibility of the US side using an aircraft to travel to Ukraine," he said.

"We have taken note of this Russian move, and next week we will adjust our operation accordingly regarding Russian airspace, which has become dangerous because of our drones and missiles. Of course, there are and will be no threats to diplomacy from our side."

US ambassadors Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner with Russian envoy Kirill Dmitriev in Moscow on Sunday. @KADMITRIEV

US strikes 3 Iran tankers after IRGC attack on naval ships

Reuters
Dubai, September 5

US FORCES struck three Iranian oil tankers on Saturday, US Central Command said, including one off the coast of Kharg Island, near Iran's key oil export hub.

The strikes were carried out after Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps launched ballistic missiles at two US Navy ships, Central Command said.

"Let the message to the IRGC be clear: If you shoot at two of our ships, we will impose an even higher economic cost — taking out three of yours," said Admiral Brad Cooper, head of US Central Command.

Tasnim, the semi-official Iranian news agency, reported earlier that four US missiles hit a tanker in the area of Kharg's anchorage. *Tasnim* quoted local sources as saying there were no casualties and the tanker's crew was being evacuated.

No American personnel were harmed, Central Command said. There was no immediate official announcement by Iranian authorities.

US President Donald Trump said on August 31 in a one-line social media post accompanied by an AI-generated video that Kharg Island was being "blown to smithereens".

Iranian authorities have vowed a strong response if Kharg is attacked.

Iran is the third-largest producer in the Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries and exported 90% of its crude via Kharg Island before the war, but flows have been disrupted since a US blockade of Iranian oil exports began in mid-April.

Trump said on June 11 that he wanted to take over Kharg Island, but then said a threatened US military operation there was off the table for now, days before Tehran and Washington signed an interim agreement aimed at ending the war on June 17.

A US attack on Kharg would further pressure Iran's oil industry and its wider economy, which is already reeling from the US naval blockade.

The US imposed its blockade on Iranian ports after Iran effectively shut the Strait of Hormuz, an important waterway that carried one-fifth of the world's oil supply before the war.

A screen grab from a video released by CENTCOM shows fire and smoke rising during strikes on Iranian oil carriers on Saturday. REUTERS

UN backs world map showing Africa's true size

New York: The United Nations Friday voted for a shift away from the 16th-century Mercator global map towards one more accurately reflecting countries' true size, a resolution sponsored by African states to counter perceptions the continent is peripheral.

Togo led the initiative to further the African Union campaign to limit use of the Mercator map, which distorts relative size of land masses by expanding those nearer the poles. It makes Greenland appear roughly the same size as Africa, though Africa is about 14 times larger.

"A fair world begins with a fair map," Togo's Foreign Minister Robert Dussey told Reuters ahead of Friday's vote.

The resolution promotes the Equal Earth projection, which more accurately portrays the size of the continents. REUTERS

• BRIEFLY

People watch as smoke rises after the crash of a F-4 Phantom fighter jet during Athens Flying Week air show in Tanagra, on Saturday. REUTERS

GREECE

Two killed as F4 fighter jet crashes during annual air show near Athens

A GREEK air force jet crashed at an air show north of Athens on Saturday, killing the two pilots, officials said, as thousands of people were in attendance at the event. A fire after the crash sent up large plumes of black smoke. There were no injuries among the spectators. The crash of the twin-seat Phantom F4 jet occurred during a low-altitude maneuver. Air force officials in Greece said the bodies of the two pilots were located during a rescue operation, hampered in the early stages by the fire on the grounds of Tanagra air force base, 60 kilometers north of Athens. AP

BOLIVIA

2 dead, 14 missing after explosion at military base

AT LEAST two people were killed and dozens injured on Friday after an explosion at a military barracks in the Bolivian municipality of Viacha, about 30 km from La Paz, Defence Minister Ernesto Justiniano said. His ministry said that 14 people were missing. The blast occurred at 2:30 pm in an area used to store pyrotechnic material, authorities said, adding while the cause is yet to be established, the blast originated from the defence ministry's fireworks stockpile. REUTERS

SRI LANKA

Ex-president's son arrested in corruption case

NAMAL RAJAPAKSA, the elder son of Sri Lanka's former president Mahinda Rajapaksa, was arrested by the anti-graft commission over alleged corruption linked to purchase of Airbus aircraft for SriLankan Airlines. Rajapaksa, 40, was asked to appear before the Commission to Investigate Allegations of Bribery or Corruption Friday. He was arrested after over five hours of questioning before being presented before Magistrate Asanga S Boderagama. PTI

US envoy calls Israeli settlers 'terrorists' after weeks of violence in West Bank

Associated Press
Jerusalem, September 5

THE UNITED States ambassador to Israel condemned Israeli settler violence in the occupied West Bank again on Saturday, calling the behavior an "act of terror" as he visited with Palestinian American residents shaken by months of attacks.

Ambassador Mike Huckabee referred to such settlers as "terrorists," a word that US officials usually reserve for Palestinian militants.

"If there are squatters that come in and put up their own flags and take possession of something that does not belong to them, if they burn a car, if they torch a mosque, if they go into someone's home and vandalize it, paint graffiti on the walls, that's a criminal act. But it extends beyond a criminal act. It's an act of terror," Huckabee said during his visit to the village of Turmus Ayya, which has reported frequent attacks by settlers over the past year.

Such attacks have surged since the war in Gaza began with the Hamas-led attack on southern Israel on October 7, 2023, according to the United Nations humanitarian office.

Huckabee also used the term "terrorists" last month after weeks of unrest in the West Bank town of Qusra, where settlers surrounded several homes including one owned by a Palestinian American.

Days later, residents of the West Bank village of Bazariya said settlers burned a mosque and left a message on a wall in graffiti reading "Huckabee regards from the terrorists" in Hebrew.

US ambassador Mike Huckabee during a press conference after he met with residents in a West Bank village on Saturday. REUTERS

Digging For Victory

People compete during the international grave-digging championship at a cemetery in Nyergesújfalu, Hungary, on Saturday. Thirty-eight competitors, forming 19 two-person teams, took part in the contest organised by the Hungarian Association of Cemetery Maintainers and Operators to showcase the skills of the profession and challenge taboos surrounding death. REUTERS

• AT ITS PEAK EARLY THIS DECADE, AT LEAST 40,000 PEOPLE IN NAIROBI WERE BEING PAID TO DO HOMEWORK FOR OVERSEAS STUDENTS

Kenya's essay writers thrived in the global gig economy, then AI came for their work

Adam Satariano & Paul Mozur
Nairobi, September 5

TERESIOS BUNDI once symbolized the strange, life-changing opportunities the internet provided. Hailing from a farming village in Kenya, Bundi moved to the capital, Nairobi, in 2011 to be the first in his family to attend university. There, a friend suggested he try a new online job: writing essays for cheating overseas college students.

His first assignment was a two-page essay on the health benefits of the Garcinia cambogia. It was a fruit he had never heard of, and an essay written for a student he didn't know anything about. He earned $7 for three hours of work.

"That was a lifeline for me, I needed the money," Bundi, now 34, said in an interview in Nairobi. He added: "I could not sleep that night. I was ready to burn the midnight oil."

Bundi estimates he wrote more than 2,500 essays over the next 12 years, sometimes three a day. He balanced completing his public health degree with helping faraway students studying engineering, medicine and computer science to finish theirs. Some students gave him their school login information so he could keep up with their assignments.

Bundi didn't know it then, but he was in the boom era of internet gig work.

Newly wired to the global internet and hungry for jobs, well-educated youths from places like Kenya, the Philippines and India found opportunities in the crevices of the digital economy.

They could make money online doing unglamorous tasks that others further up the economic ladder did not want to do.

Then AI arrived, and the good times ended.

In 2022, OpenAI released ChatGPT. At colleges worldwide, students made a simple calculation that has become more pronounced today: Why pay a freelancer in Kenya when ChatGPT could do the job?

Essay work began to thin. Rates fell, and assignments dwindled. Before long, the industry shrank to almost nothing. "I never would have expected AI could do this," Bundi said.

His fate is shared by others who had found a foothold in the global online gig economy. Kenyans also transcribed meetings through the freelance platforms Upwork and Fiverr. They flagged Facebook posts to help the platform decide what could stay up. One after another, those opportunities have withered.

"It's not just going to be Kenya — it's going to be everywhere we see a big transformation," said Mark Graham, an Oxford University professor who has studied the global gig economy. "AI has come in and taken big chunks of labor markets."

Bundi said he had regrets. When he graduated from college in 2015, he bypassed a public health career to start an online essay-writing business, charging $40 to $70 per paper.

Assignments came in through digital platforms, and he divvied up work between himself and students he hired. He rented a house near a university and filled it with desks, fast internet and mattresses.

Students worked between classes and slept when too exhausted to write. Bundi said he had made at least five times as much as he could earn in public health. He sometimes considered the ethics of helping students cheat, but decided it was ultimately their choice. He said he saw himself as a tutor and was proud that a young Kenyan was thriving unnoticed inside Western academia.

Around Nairobi, new money among essay writers was visible.

At its peak early this decade, at least 40,000 people in the city were being paid to do other people's homework, researchers estimated. Essay writers drove new Subarus, carried the latest smartphones and booked exclusive tables at clubs.

After the crash, Bundi closed his essay-writing business and struggled to find a career path. He is now working for a German government development organization helping young Kenyans find opportunities in the digital economy. He said his experience was a cautionary tale.

"A.I. is coming for bankers, for accountants, it's coming for engineers, and A.I. will come for architects," he said. "It's coming for everybody." NYT

Teresios Bundi ran an essay-writing business for overseas students. NYT

NUMBER OF INVESTORS ROSE TO 8,467 IN Q1FY27, FROM 3,483

GIFT City sees retail rush as Indians seek global investments

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, September 5

AS INDIAN markets have increasingly been outpaced by their global peers, more Indians are now investing in international markets through the Gujarat International Finance Tec-City (GIFT City), data from the International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) showed.

The number of investors in such retail schemes rose to 8,467 in the April-June quarter, up from 3,483 in the previous quarter. This was also the first time when the retail audience controlled the biggest piece of the pie in GIFT City's fund management ecosystem, constituting over 52% of the total investors putting money into such international funds.

For context, GIFT City in Gujarat's Gandhinagar is an IFSC hub that provides tax benefits, reduced regulatory compliance, and other incentives to attract international players. It also offers high-net-worth individuals, NRIs, and retail audiences an avenue to invest in foreign markets in foreign currencies through GIFT City IFSC funds.

Meanwhile, alternative investment funds totalled 7,683 investors in the latest quarter, up 26% quarter-on-quarter, with their share in the hub's fund management ecosystem dropping from nearly 64% in the previous quarter.

"Global markets have done exceedingly well compared to Indian markets and Indian investors have understood the importance of global diversification, and hence participation from retail investors has increased," said Vaibhav Shah, head of products, business strategy, and international business at Mirae Asset Mutual Fund.

Shweta Rajani, head of mutual funds at Anand Rathi Wealth, attributed this retail momentum to "improving access to global investments from within India, along with greater clarity around the taxation of retail schemes and ETFs."

All fund houses that typically run overseas fund-of-funds stopped fresh intake into their overseas schemes between July and early August due to the industry hitting its overseas investment limit. Thus, these fund houses cannot accept fresh subscriptions in such schemes despite demand remaining high as most major global markets continue to outpace India.

For context, the benchmark Nifty 50 and Sensex indices are down around 8-10% so far this year. Stock markets in the US, South Korea, Taiwan, and Japan have grown 10-59% in that time.

"Of couse, when the domestic stock market is underperforming, many in the retail section who have the money will also chase growth in other markets. So this pent-up demand is materialising through GIFT City as access improves and funds launch new IFSC funds," a fund manager said.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• GIFT City's IFSC: Surge in retail investors

QUARTER	RETAIL SCHEMES	CATEGORY I AIFS	CATEGORY II AIFS	CATEGORY III AIFS
Q1FY27	8,467	853	1,655	5,175
Q4FY26	3,438	772	1,611	3,773
Q3FY26	1,239	722	1,503	3,257
Q2FY26	255	646	1,273	2,559
Q1FY26	0	526	1,100	1,957

SOURCE: IFSCA

NSE IPO: India's biggest issue faces key questions ahead of its listing

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, September 5

WITH REGULATORY hurdles finally cleared after a nearly decade-long wait, the National Stock Exchange (NSE) looks set to complete its IPO and list publicly by the end of this month.

The estimated Rs 30,000 crore public issue — the largest in India's IPO history so far — has drawn significant attention from both institutional investors and retail audiences. But some questions remain unanswered, like if NSE's shares will be permitted to trade on its own exchange.

What regulations say

Under current regulations, the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) prohibits a stock exchange from listing on its own platform. Stock exchanges act as the first-level regulator in the listed space, overseeing compliance for the entities that trade on their platform. Thus, an exchange being listed on its own platform becomes a conflict of interest, as it would have to regulate itself.

However, there is a potential solution to this for the NSE — the permitted-to-trade (PTT) route, which allows an exchange to trade its shares on its own platform without getting listed. This would allow NSE to shift the compliance burden onto the exchange the stock is primarily listed on — BSE in this case — while allowing traders on NSE to trade these shares too.

For that, NSE shares will first get listed on the BSE. NSE's board will then discuss and come up with a detailed proposal for the SEBI on how the exchange will avoid conflict of interest if its shares are allowed to trade on its own platform. The proposal also includes the standard operating procedure for NSE shares in case of day-to-day functions like price bands and surveillance.

If the SEBI accepts NSE's proposal, the shares will then be allowed to trade on its own exchange via the PTT route.

What BSE says

A stock's presence on a particular stock exchange does not just provide visibility. In NSE's case, its shares would benefit from the exchange's dominance in terms of liquidity, cash market volumes, and derivatives volumes.

For context, the NSE currently commands around 93% of India's cash market turnover, nearly the entirety of the futures premium, and around 75% of the options premium, according to Geojit Financial Services.

It would also allow NSE shares to be included in the exchange's widely tracked indices, such as the Nifty 500 and the Nifty Financial Services, which would in turn boost passive mutual fund flows into the stock. Currently, around 250 stocks aren't listed on the NSE but are allowed to trade on the exchange through this route.

On this topic, SEBI Chair Tuhin Kanta Pandey late last month said the regulator has not yet discussed the matter and that the matter is currently "too far". Rival BSE's MD Sundararaman Ramamurthy, however, strongly opposed such an arrangement.

"Self-listing is not permitted regulatorily. Currently, there is no regulatory framework for permitting oneself to trade on oneself," he said in an interview with *CNBC-TV18* on Thursday. He also added that this "permitted-to-trade" proposal was not part of NSE's DRHP and that the exchange has clarified that it will not issue an addendum or update to its IPO papers. "In such a situation, there is nothing to comment further," said Ramamurthy.

For context, the SEBI had rejected BSE's permitted-to-trade proposal when it had listed back in 2017, citing conflict of interest.

IPO valuation, timing

The public issue comes at a time when the Indian IPO market is gathering pace following months of slowdown due to the West Asia war and the AI wave. The months of July and August accounted for around 73% of the funds raised through mainboard IPOs in 2026, and the Indian market also recovered a bit after being among the biggest underperformers this year among major global markets.

It also comes at a time when five big-ticket issues are either open or scheduled to open next week. For example, Meerut-based Kanohar Electricals is aiming to raise around Rs 1,056 crore through its IPO opening on Tuesday. Mumbai-based specialty chemicals manufacturer Prasol Chemicals aims to raise Rs 500 crore. However, this concentration of public issues is unlikely to impact NSE's issue due to the sheer size, scale, anticipation, and brand value behind its IPO.

Brokerages like Deven Choksey and Kotak expect NSE's issue to garner a price-to-earnings (PE) ratio between 35 and 49 times its FY26 earnings. This depends on the price band, which is expected to be announced around September 15, according to a *Reuters* report.

The P/E ratio indicates a stock's valuation. A lower valuation means investors can potentially earn more returns from the stock in the longer run.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

LIC gets RBI nod to raise ICICI Bank stake to 9.99%

ENS Economic Bureau
Chennai, September 5

THE RESERVE Bank of India (RBI) has given its nod to Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) to acquire an aggregate holding of up to 9.99% of the paid-up share capital or voting rights in ICICI Bank, giving the state-owned insurer headroom to more than double its existing stake in the private lender.

The approval is valid for one year from the date of the RBI's approval letter, failing which it will stand cancelled, ICICI Bank said in a regulatory filing on Saturday. The approval is subject to compliance with applicable statutory and regulatory provisions. As of the June 2026 quarter, mutual funds held 29.60% of ICICI Bank, while insurance companies owned 8.24%. LIC's stake in the lender stood at 4.35%.

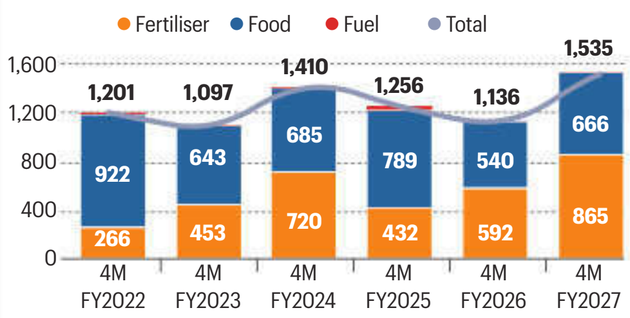
The RBI approval is an enabling provision and does not mean LIC will immediately raise its holding to 9.99%.

Any increase in its stake will remain subject to applicable regulatory requirements and LIC's investment decisions.

The approval comes weeks after LIC received the central bank's clearance to increase its stake in HDFC Bank to up to 9.99%. As of August 14, LIC held 4.11% of HDFC Bank's total share capital. FE

• INDIA'S RISING SUBSIDY BILL

India's subsidy bill rose by 35% in the first four months of the ongoing financial year (4MFY27) against the same period last year (4MFY26). It was led by the fertiliser subsidy bill, which shot up by 46.2% amid the ongoing war in West Asia, followed by food subsidies at 23%. The total subsidy bill came in at Rs 1,535 billion, with a miniscule share of subsidy on fuels in it, according to a ICRA report.



FIGURES ARE IN RS BILLION; SOURCE: CGA, MINISTRY OF FINANCE, GOI; ICRA RESEARCH

TCS to set up Rs 70K-cr data centre in Hyderabad

Urvi Malvania
Mumbai, September 5

HYPERVAULT AI Data Center, a subsidiary of Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), has secured 264 acres in Hyderabad to develop a large-scale artificial intelligence data centre campus with capacity of up to 1 gigawatt.

When fully built, the campus is expected to rank amongst the most advanced and largest AI infrastructure campuses in India.

HyperVault and its partners are expected to invest up to Rs 70,000 crore to build and manage the campus, which will be purpose-built to serve frontier AI companies and hyperscalers, supporting high-density GPU deployments for AI training, inference and advanced computing workloads. The development will be carried out in phases, depending on customer demand and technology requirements.

TCS' chief executive officer (CEO) and managing director K Krithivasan framed the project as part of the company's infrastructure-to-intelligence strategy.

"HyperVault advances TCS' strategy by bringing together AI-ready infrastructure with our cloud, engineering, enterprise transformation and AI capabilities. Hyderabad offers the scale, talent and ecosystem to serve global customers," Krithivasan said. FE

• BRIEFLY

NCLT halts disposal of Byju's K3-linked assets, flags valuation

New Delhi: The insolvency tribunal NCLT has ordered a status quo on the assets sold by the resolution professional of Think and Learn Private Limited, the parent entity of debt-ridden edutech firm Byju's, in one of its subsidiaries. The Bengaluru-based bench of the NCLT has put a hold on any further disposal of Byju's K3 Education's assets till the next hearing on September 21 amid allegations that assets worth around Rs 150 crore were sold for just about Rs 16 crore. PTI

Auto component suppliers sitting on Rs 98,000 cr inventory: Report

New Delhi: The automotive component industry has around Rs 98,000 crore locked in inventory, of which Rs 29,000-39,000 crore could potentially be released by improving inventory management, according to a Vector Consulting Group report. The report said the potential working-capital release could include Rs 4,000-5,600 crore within the MSME ecosystem, around 80 % of auto component manufacturers. PTI

Tata Motors launches tender offer for Iveco

New Delhi: Tata Motors launched an all-cash voluntary tender offer to acquire all common shares of Iveco Group for EUR 14.10 per share, valuing the Italian commercial vehicle maker at approximately EUR 3.82 billion. The offer is being made through TML CV Holdings BV, and the acceptance period will run from September 7 to October 26, 2026, according to a joint announcement by Tata Motors and Iveco Group on Friday. PTI

Maruti Suzuki official: Premium hatchback space to keep growing

New Delhi: The premium hatchback segment is anticipated to grow in the Indian passenger vehicle market, even as SUVs remain the dominant choice among customers, a senior executive of Maruti Suzuki India Ltd said on Saturday. The company, which has introduced the new version of its premium hatchback Baleno with special festive prices starting at Rs 6.09 lakh (ex-showroom Bengaluru), believes that when the overall passenger vehicles sales is expected to reach the size of 63 lakh units annually. PTI

Foxconn says Q3 to outperform expectations on AI strength

Reuters
Taipei, September 5

FOXCONN'S THIRD-quarter performance is expected to outperform market expectations given strong AI-related demand, the Taiwanese contract electronics maker said on Saturday, though it offered caution about "volatile" global politics.

Foxconn, Nvidia's biggest server maker and a major Apple supplier, has been a big beneficiary of the trend towards AI, reporting last month a 35% rise in second-quarter profit that beat analyst forecasts.

"In the third quarter, as AI demand continues to grow, and ICT products also enter the peak season of the second half of the year, operations are expected to gradually gain momentum," it said in a statement, referring to information and communication technology.

"Currently, the company's visibility for the third quarter has improved compared to the previous month, with overall performance expected to outperform market expectations," it added, without giving details.

However, Foxconn said it remained necessary to "monitor the impact of the volatile global political and economic situation". It likewise did not elaborate. Foxconn, formally called Hon Hai Precision Industry, does not provide numerical forecasts.

KARNATAKA POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED

(CIN: U40109KA1999SGC025521)

No: CEE/T&P/SE-2/2026-27/5973-85 Dated: 04.09.2026

BRIEF TENDER NOTIFICATION
(Through kpp portal Mode Only)

KPTCL invites Bids on electronic mode for the following works against following enquiry numbers on **Partial Turnkey basis.**

Sl. No.	Enquiry No. & Name of the work
1.	**KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_INDENT4148** Establishing of following sub-stations along with construction of associated transmission lines (Stage-1) including design of line towers: **a)** Establishing 2x200MVA, 220/110 kV and 1x20MVA, 110/11 kV sub-station at **PM Mitra Textile Park, Kalaburagi** along with construction of associated transmission line for a distance of 1.985km and construction of 2 nos. of 220 kV terminal bays at 400/220 kV Ferozabad (Kalaburagi) sub-station. **b)** Establishing 2x20MVA, 110/33 kV and 2X20MVA, 110/11 kV sub-station (Station-1) at **PM Mitra Textile Park at Keeranagi Village** along with construction of associated transmission line for a distance of 1.811km in Kalaburagi Taluk and District. **c)** Establishing 2x20MVA, 110/33 kV and 2X20MVA, 110/11 kV sub-station (Station-2) at **PM Mitra Textile Park at Keeranagi Village** along with construction of associated transmission line for a distance of 1.114km in Kalaburagi Taluk and District."

The bids will be received through electronic tendering mode only. The details regarding participation in the e-tendering process can be obtained by logging on to KPTCL website **https://kptcl.karnataka.gov.in** with hyperlink "E Procurement KPTCL" or **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** on or after **18.09.2026 @ 15:00hrs.** Last date & time for receipt of Bids and **any extension of Due date for Bid submission will be intimated in the Karnataka Public Procurement portal.** Any details required in this regard can also be obtained from the office of the undersigned during office hours.

All Corrigendum/Addendums shall be noticed by the bidders before the last date of submission of the Bids.

Sd/-, Chief Engineer, (Electy).
Tendering & Procurement, KPTCL, 9th Floor,
Indhana Bhavana, A. R. Circle, Bengaluru-560009.

HFCL LIMITED

CIN: L64200HR1987PLC148689
Regd. Office: Plot No. 38, Institutional Area, Sector 32, Gurugram - 122 001 (Haryana)
Website: www.hfcl.com; **Email:** secretarial@hfcl.com; **Tel.:** 91-124-4310000; **Fax No.:** +91-124-4310050

NOTICE OF 39TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING ("AGM"), E-VOTING, REMOTE E-VOTING AND RECORD DATE
[THIS IS FURTHER TO OUR EARLIER NOTICE PUBLISHED ON SEPTEMBER 03, 2026 REGARDING AGM]

NOTICE is hereby given that:

1. The **39th Annual General Meeting of HFCL Limited (the "Company")** is scheduled to be held on **Tuesday, 29th September, 2026 at 11:00 a.m. (IST) through Video Conferencing ("VC") / Other Audio Visual Means ("OAVM")**, to transact the Ordinary and Special Businesses, as set out in the **Notice dated September 02, 2026** convening the AGM, in due compliance with the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 (**"Act"**), the Rules made thereunder, and the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (**"SEBI Listing Regulations"**) read with the General Circulars numbered 14/2020, 17/2020, 20/2020, 02/2021, 19/2021, 21/2021, 02/2022, 10/2022, 09/2023, 09/2024 and 03/2025, dated April 08, 2020, April 13, 2020, May 05, 2020, January 13, 2021, December 08, 2021, December 14, 2021, May 05, 2022, December 28, 2022, September 25, 2023, September 19, 2024 and September 22, 2025, respectively issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (**"MCA Circulars"**).
2. In compliance of the provisions of Sections 101 and 136 of the Act read with Rule 18 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 as amended, the Notice setting out the business to be transacted at the AGM along with the Statement and the Annual Report of the Company for the financial year 2025-26 have been sent **through electronic mode only** to the members whose e-mail IDs are registered with the Depositories/ the Depository Participants/ the Company/ the Registrar and Share Transfer Agent (**"RTA"**), whose names appear in the Company's Register of Members / Beneficial Owners maintained by the Depositories, **as on Friday, August 28, 2026.** Further in terms of Regulations 36(1)(b) of SEBI Listing Regulations, the Company has also sent a letter containing the web link and QR Code (including the exact path) to access the complete Annual Report to those shareholders who have not registered their email addresses with the Depositories/ the Depository Participants/ the Company/ the RTA. The Annual Report including the Notice of AGM are also available on the Company's website www.hfcl.com, website of the stock exchanges i.e. the BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com and the National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com and also on the website of NSDL at www.evoting.nsdl.com.
3. The Dispatch of Notice of AGM through e-mails has been completed on **September 05, 2026.**

Remote Voting through Electronic Mode ("Remote e-Voting") and e-Voting during AGM

Pursuant to Section 108 of the Act read with Rule 20 of the Companies (Management & Administration) Rules, 2014, as amended and Regulation 44 of the SEBI Listing Regulations and the Secretarial Standard on General Meetings (**"SS-2"**), Members holding shares either in physical form or dematerialized form, are provided with the facility to cast their vote on all the resolutions set forth in Notice of AGM using electronic voting system from a place other than the venue of AGM (**"Remote e-Voting"**), provided by the National Securities Depository Limited (**"NSDL"**). All the Members are informed that:

i) The Business as set forth in the Notice of AGM shall be transacted through voting by electronic means.
ii) The remote e-Voting shall **commence on Saturday, September 26, 2026 (9.00 a.m. IST).**
iii) The remote e-Voting shall **end on Monday, September 28, 2026 (5.00 p.m. IST)** and shall **not be allowed** beyond this time.
iv) The **Cut-off date** for determining the eligibility to vote by Remote e-Voting and / or e-Voting during AGM is **Tuesday, September 22, 2026.** The voting rights of the member shall be in proportion with the paid-up value of their share in the Equity Share Capital of the Company as on Cut-off date i.e. **Tuesday, September 22, 2026.**
v) Any person, who becomes the member of the Company after dispatch of the Notice of the AGM and holding shares as on the Cut-off date i.e., **Tuesday, September 22, 2026**, may obtain the user ID and Password by sending a request at evoting@nsdl.com or to the Company at secretarial@hfcl.com or to the RTA at MCS Share Transfer Agent Limited (Unit: HFCL Limited) at admin@mcsregistrars.com, by mentioning their folio No./DP ID and Client ID. However, if a member is already registered with NSDL for Remote e-Voting/ e-Voting, the member can use the existing user ID and Password for casting his/her vote through Remote e-Voting/ e-Voting during AGM.
vi) The Members may note that:
   a) once the vote on a resolution is cast by the member, the member shall not be allowed to change it subsequently;
   b) the facility for e-Voting on NSDL platform shall also be available at the AGM;
   c) the members who have exercised their vote by Remote e-Voting may also attend the AGM but shall not be entitled to cast their vote again at the AGM;
   d) a person whose name is recorded in the register of members or in the register of beneficial owners maintained by the depositories as on the Cut-off date, i.e., **Tuesday, September 22, 2026** only, shall be entitled to avail facility of Remote e-Voting as well as e-Voting at the AGM; and
   e) a person who is not a member as on the Cut-off date should treat this Notice for information purpose only.
vii) The detailed procedure and instructions for Remote e-Voting / e-Voting are provided in the Notice of the AGM and e-mail sent to each shareholder.
viii) In case of any queries or grievances connected with facility for Remote e-Voting/ e-Voting, members may refer to the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) for Members and Remote e-Voting User Manual for Members available at the 'Downloads' section on www.evoting.nsdl.com or call on 022-4886 7000 or contact **Ms. Pallavi Mhatre**, Assistant Vice President, NSDL, at the designated e-mail address: evoting@nsdl.com.
ix) The Board of Director of the Company has recommended a final dividend @20%, i.e. ₹0.20/- (Twenty Paisa Only) per equity share of face value ₹1/- each. The final dividend if approved, by the members in the ensuing AGM will be paid within 30 days of AGM. Further, please refer to our e-mail communication dated July 16, 2026, to the shareholders in respect of Deduction of Tax at Source on Dividend under relevant provisions of the Income- Tax Act, 2025.
x) The Company has fixed **Tuesday, September 22, 2026** as the record date for determining the entitlement of members for final dividend for the financial year ended March 31, 2026, if approved at the AGM.
xi) Mr. Baldev Singh Kashtwal (FCS–3616 & COP No. 3169), Practicing Company Secretary, has been appointed as the Scrutinizer by the Board of Directors of the Company, to scrutinize the entire Remote e-Voting process and e-Voting during AGM, in a fair and transparent manner.
xii) Pursuant to the provisions of the Act, a member entitled to attend and vote at AGM is entitled to appoint a proxy to attend and vote on his / her behalf and the proxy need not be a member of the Company. Since, this AGM is being held pursuant to the MCA Circulars and the various circulars issued by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (**"SEBI"**) from time to time through VC / OAVM, the requirement of physical attendance of members has been dispensed with. Accordingly, in terms of the MCA Circulars and the circulars issued by the SEBI, the facility for appointment of proxies by the members will not be available for this AGM and hence the proxy form, attendance slip and route map of AGM are not annexed to the Notice. However, corporate members intending to appoint their authorised representatives pursuant to Section 113 of the Act, as the case may be, to attend the AGM through VC / OAVM or to vote through Remote e-Voting / e-Voting during AGM, are requested to send a certified true copy of the board resolution to the Scrutinizer by e-mail at scrutinizer@hfcl.com with a copy marked to NSDL at evoting@nsdl.com and to the Company at secretarial@hfcl.com.
xiii) **Shareholders holding shares in physical mode and have not registered/updated/completed their e-mail addresses/KYC details with the Company, may get registered /updated/completed the same, by sending in duly filled and signed Form ISR-1 (Form for registering PAN, KYC details or changes/ updation thereof) which is available on the website of the Company at www.hfcl.com to the Company's RTA at admin@mcsregistrars.com or to the Secretarial Department of the Company by e-mail at secretarial@hfcl.com. Shareholders holding shares in dematerialized mode may contact/ write to their Depository Participants to register/ update/complete their e-mail address/KYC details. This would help the shareholders to avoid transferring their shares/unpaid dividend into Investor Education and Protection Fund account.**

Voting Results

The voting results along with the Consolidated Report of the Scrutinizer shall be placed on the Company's website at www.hfcl.com, NSDL's website at www.nsdl.com and also on the web-site of Stock Exchanges, viz., the National Stock Exchange of India Limited (NSE) at www.nseindia.com and the BSE Limited (BSE) at www.bseindia.com, within 2 working days of the conclusion of the meeting, after declaration of the voting results by the Chairman or a person authorized by him in writing. Subject to receipt of requisite number of votes, the Resolutions shall be deemed to be passed on the date of the 39th Annual General Meeting i.e. **September 29, 2026**.

For **HFCL Limited**
Sd/-
(Manoj Baid)
President & Company Secretary

Place : New Delhi
Date : September 05, 2026

Office of the Principal, Govt. Doon Medical College

Dehrakhas, Patel Nagar, Dehradun - 248001 (Uttarakhand)
Tel. No. 0135-2728020, 2728021 Email: doonmedicalcollege@gmail.com Website : www.gdmcuk.com

Letter No.: 6411/Tender/2026-27 Dated: 05/09/2026

E-Tender Notice

Online Bids are invited through E-tendering system from Original Manufacturer under two bid systems for financial year 2026-27 & 2027-28 by Principal, Govt. Doon Medical College, Dehrakhas, Patel Nagar, Dehradun, Uttarakhand. on behalf of Governor of Uttarakhand for procurement of Surgical Items under Rate contract. Reference Detailed Information Specifications & Tender/bid Documents are Available on website **uktenders.gov.in** from 05.09.2026, 02:00 pm onwards.

Principal
Govt. Doon Medical College, Dehradun

उत्तर प्रदेश ग्रामीण बैंक
UTTAR PRADESH GRAMIN BANK
(सरकार के स्वामित्वाधीन अनुसूचित बैंक)

Tender For Hiring/leasing of Hotel Rooms For Holiday Home At Ayodhya

Uttar Pradesh Gramin Bank, Lucknow invites applications for hiring/leasing of Ten (10) hotel rooms, in ready-to-occupy condition, for use as **"Holiday Home" at Ayodhya,** located within a radius of 15 km from **Ayodhya Cantt Railway Station.**

Interested parties may obtain/download the detailed tender document from the Bank's official **website www.upgb.bank.in** under Tender, and participate in the tender through **GeM Bid No. GEM/2026/B/7987587 publication Date 02.09.2026.**

Last Date of Bid 23.09.2026, 15:00 Hrs

For detailed terms, eligibility criteria, specifications and other information, please visit the Bank's website and GeM portal. The interested bidders are requested to submit the bids through GeM Portal only.

Date: 02.09.2026

General Manager
Uttar Pradesh Gramin Bank Lucknow

UJVN LIMITED

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No: 773 **Corrigendum No-01 (Time Extension)** Date: 5/09/2026

e-TenderNo-02/DGM(M&U-YV)/UJVNL/2026-27

Due to Unavoidable reasons, the dates of e-TenderNo-02/DGM(M&UYV)/UJVNL/2026-27 invited byOffice of the Dy. General Manager (M&U-Yamuna Valley) UJVN Limited, Hydel Colony, Dhalipur, Dehradun (Uttarakhand) hereby extended as follows

Name of work. - Underwater Inspection of the Water conductor system of 4X60 MW Chibro Hydroelectric Project by Remote-Operated Vehicle (ROV)

Last date for submission of bids on website: 11.09.2026 at 17:00 hrs.
Last date for submission of bids (Hard Copy): 16.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs.
Date of opening Bid: 16.09.2026 at 15:30 hrs

For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal **http://uktenders.gov.in**

Dy. General Manager

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF TELANGANA LIMITED

e-TENDER NOTICE

The TGTransco invites online Bids under e-procurement platform for Supply of 154 Nos. of Toner Cartridges for HP and Brother make printers. **Specification No.** TGPMM31-30/2026.

Tenderers can have further details and download the tender schedule from e-procurement market place i.e., **www.tender.telangana.gov.in** Contact Nos: **040-23396000 (Extn.: 3323/3537/3583/3487).**

Sd/- Chief Engineer/P & MM

DIPR R.O.No. 496-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-2027, Dt: 05-09-2026

दक्षिणांचल विद्युत वितरण निगम
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, विद्युत भण्डार मण्डल, आगरा

ई-अल्पकालीन निविदा सूचना

ई-निविदा सूचना : ESC/A/T-06 (2026-27)	दिनांक 05.09.2026
कार्य का नामः पावर परिवर्तको की ऑन साईट सर्विसिंग का कार्य।	
ई-निविदा प्रपत्र शुल्कः रू. 5,900/-	धरोहर राशिः रू. 3,75,000/-
ई-निविदा की अन्तिम तिथि 19 सितम्बर 2026, 14:00 बजे तक	
विस्तृत जानकारी एवं प्रपत्र वेबसाइट https://etender.up.nic.in पर उपलब्ध है। अग्रेतर समस्त सूचनाए वेबसाइट पर ही प्रदर्शित की जाएगी।	
पत्रांक : 3374 अधी.अभि.(भं०)/आ/निविदा	दिनांकः 05/09/2026

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Manish Singh alias Jyoti alias Deepak S/O Sansar Singh R/O House No. 67 Sanjay Nagar, Jammu is evading his arrest / wanted in case FIR No. 252/2002 U/S 379 RPC, of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name : Manish Singh alias Jyoti alias Deepak
S/O : Sansar Singh
Address : House No. 67 Sanjay Nagar, Jammu
Age : 40-45 Years

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1. DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949
4. SP City South : 0191-2430002
5. SDPO City East : 01912433778
6. P/S Bahu Fort : 0191-475133

Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu

DIP/J-9545/26 DATE 05.09.2026

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
RWS&S DIVISION: ATHAGARH

25001/1078/2627

At/PO: Athagarh, Email: eerwssathagarh@gmail.com

INVITATIONS FOR BIDS (IFB) [e-Procurement]
Bid Identification No. RWS/ATH/07/2026-27

1)	The Executive Engineer, RWS&S Division, Athagarh on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites lump sum rate bid in double cover system in ONLINE MODE from eligible contractors for the works as detailed below under RWSS Division,Athagarh.		
2	Nature of work	:	Development of potable water supply and sanitation facility at Mahakali Pitha Complex at village Kharod under Baramba Block in the district of Cuttack.
3	No. of Work	:	01 (One) No.
4	Class of Contractor	:	A and B
5	Cost ofTender paper	:	Rs. 10,000.00 (Online)
6	Approx. Estimated Cost	:	Rs. 14l.21 lakhs
7	EMD to be deposited	:	Rs. 1.50 Lakhs
8	Period of completion	:	12 (Twelve) Calendar Months
9	Availability of bid documents in the website.	:	From dt. 11.09.2026 to dt.28.09.2026
10	Date & time of seeking tender: clarification.	:	24.09.2026 during Office hours
11	Date of Opening of Bid	:	On dt. 29.09.2026 at 11.30 AM onwards
12	Any corrigendum / Amendment / Cancellation of IFB will be displayed in the e-tender website only.		

The bidders have to participate in **ONLINE** bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website i.e. **http://tendersorissa.gov.in**

Sd/-
Executive Engineer,
RWS&S Division, Athagarh

OIPR-25001/25165/1/26-27/0002

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Amit Singh S/O S/O Sarju Singh R/O Last Morh Gandhi Nagar, Jammu is evading his arrest / wanted in case FIR No. 62/2006 U/S 341/326/34 RPC, 4/25 Arms Act, of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name :- Amit Singh
S/O :- Sarju Singh
Address:- Last Morh Gandhi Nagar, Jammu
Age :- 40-45 Years

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1. DPO, Jammu :- 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D :- sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu :- 0191-2605949
4. SP City South :- 0191-2430002
5. SDPO City East :- 01912433778
6. P/S Bahu Fort :- 0191-2475133

For **Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu**

DIP NO.: DIP/J-9548/26 DATED 05.09.2026

AU SMALL FINANCE BANK LIMITED
(A SCHEDULED COMMERCIAL BANK)

Regd. Office :- 19-A, Dhuleswar Garden, Ajmer Road, Jaipur-302001, (CIN : L36911RJ1996PLC011381)

APPENDIX IV [SEE RULE 8(I) POSSESSION NOTICE]

Whereas, The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of the **AU Small Finance Bank Limited (A Scheduled Commercial Bank)** under the "Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest [Act, 2002 (54 of 2002)] and in exercise of Powers conferred under Section 13 (12) read with [rule 3] of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued demand notice dated **18-Apr-26** Calling upon the Borrower **M/S M S Arun Bangle Store (Borrower),** Kamlesh Kumari **(Co-Borrower), Arun (Co-Borrower), (Loan Account No. L9001060143533600)** to repay the amount mentioned in the notice being for **Rs. 2032247/- (Rs. Twenty Lac Thirty-Two Thousand Two Hundred Forty-Seven only)** within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.

The borrower/ mortgagor having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower/ mortgagor and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under Sub-section (4) of section 13 of Act read with Rule 8 of the Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002 on this the **02 Day of September of the Year 2026.**

The borrower/ co-borrower/ mortgagor in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the AU Small Finance Bank Limited (A Scheduled Commercial Bank) for an amount of for for **Rs. 2032247/- (Rs. Twenty Lac Thirty-Two Thousand Two Hundred Forty-Seven only)** as on **15-Apr-26** and interest and expenses thereon until full payment.

The borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub section (8) of section 13 of the Act **read with rule 8 (6), in respect of time available, i.e., 30 days from this intimation,** in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

DESCRIPTION OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES

(1) All that part and parcel of residential/commercial property Land/ Building/ Structure and fixtures Property Situated At -Gata No 173, Prempurraipura, Across Railway Line, Tehsil District - Agra, Uttar Pradesh, 282005 **Admeasuring 800 Square Feet** owned by **Kamlesh Kumari**

(2) All that part and parcel of residential/commercial property Land/ Building/ Structure and fixtures Property Situated At -Gata No 173, Prempurraipura, Across Railway Line, Tehsil District - Firozabad, Uttar Pradesh, 283203**Admeasuring 514.49 Square Feet** owned by **Arun**

Date : 02-Sept-26
Place : Uttar Pradesh

-Sd-
Authorised Officer
Au Small Finance Bank Limited

DELHI POLLUTION CONTROL COMMITTEE

Department of Environment, (Govt. of NCT of Delhi)
3rd Floor, Block-1, DMRC IT Park Building,
Shastri Park, Delhi-53
Visit us at: http://dpcc.delhi.gov.in/

LiFE Lifestyle for Environment

Prohibition of Dust generating activities and Mandatory Installation of Anti-Smog Guns/Mist Systems in High-Rise Buildings and Construction Sites

In pursuance of the directions issued under Section 5 of the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 by the Department of Environment & Forest, Government of NCT of Delhi, it is hereby notified that all commercial high-rise buildings having a built-up area **exceeding 3,000 sq.m.**, including malls, hotels, office buildings and other institutional buildings of **G+5 and above**, shall mandatorily install **Anti-Smog Guns (ASGs)** as per the prescribed guidelines or **Mist Systems** as per the approved specifications within their premises.

Further, **all under-construction sites having a plot area exceeding 1,000 sq. m.** shall mandatorily install Mist Systems to ensure effective dust suppression during the construction phase.

Minimum Number of Anti-Smog Guns (ASGs):

Built up area	Number of ASGs to be deployed
Less than 10000 sqm	At least 03
10001-15000 sqm	At least 04
15001-20000 sqm	At least 05
20001-25000 sqm	At least 06
Thereafter for each 5000 sqm additional antismog gun would be installed	

*Water used for Anti-smog Guns should be treated water.

Detailed guidelines and technical specifications of ASG and Mist Spray System are available at **https://dpcc.delhi.gov.in/sites/default/files/DPCC/important-news/egazette_gnctd_environment_23_june_2026.pdf.**

There will be complete ban on dust generating demolition activity and outdoor civil construction activity (from 1st November to 31st January), except essential public infrastructure projects.

Further, there will be complete ban on construction and demolition activities, except for urgent government projects of importance affecting public convenience and in emergency conditions, from 10th December to 20th January.

All owners, occupiers and managers of the applicable buildings and construction and demolition sites are requested to ensure strict compliance.

Member Secretary

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender are invited by Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (G)/N.E. Railway/ Izatnagar for & on behalf of the President of India for the following work:-

S.No-1, Tender Notice No.: IZN-Elect-OT-29-2026, Dated 01-09-2026 Description of work: General Electrification work in connection with Development/upgradation of goods shed with world class facility at Chhatarpur, Provision of Modular sewerage treatment plant at various stations (KGM, KPV, LKU, HDW, RUPC, BC, KJN, FBD, PBE & KSJ), Construction of Type-II (10 Nos.) & Type-III (05 Nos.) Quarters for operating staffs and Construction of Type-II (10 Nos.), Type-III (03 Nos.) & Type-IV (02 Nos.) Quarters for operation staff in PBE-MLN Section over IZN division. **Details:** Approximate tender Value in Rs.: ₹ 1,34,12,012.50, Earnest Money in Rs.: ₹ 2,68,300/-, Cost of tender paper in Rs.: Nil, Tender Type: Open Tender, Date & time of closing E-tender: 23-09-2026 at 17:00 hours, Completion time from the date of issue of letter of Acceptance: 09 Months. **S.No-2,** Tender Notice No.: IZN-Elect-OT-28-2026, Dated 04-09-2026 Description of work: General Electrification work in connection with "Replacement of old dilapidated steel overhead tank by RCC overhead tank with repair/improvement of distribution pipe lines at Gursahaiganj, Kaimganj, Kasganj, Ganjdundwara stations", "Provision of deep tube well along with RCC overhead tank at Farrukhabad, Hathras city & Mathura cantt & RCC overhead tank at Mathura cantt near Mathura junction", "Provision of 2nd platform with FOB and 04 unit Type-II staff quarters at Ganj Dundwara (GWA) Station", "Provision of quarters on replacement base 14 Nos Type-II Qtr. at Sikandra Rao station", "Provision of platform No. 2 & COP at Sikandra Rao station" and leftover works under "Improvement & strengthening of power supply, lighting arrangement & replacement of existing LT overhead lines by underground cabling at station colony (RPO, KAP, CRB, BJR, BLU, SSD, KMJ, DRO & FGR) of Fatehgarh section" over Izzatnagar Division.. **Details:** Approximate tender Value in Rs.: ₹ 1,11,59,462.67, Earnest Money in Rs.: ₹ 2,23,200/-, Cost of tender paper in Rs.: Nil, Tender Type: Open Tender, Date & time of closing E-tender: 25-09-2026 at 17:30 hours, Completion time from the date of issue of letter of Acceptance: 12 Months.

• Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and such manual offer received shall be ignored. • The tender can be viewed at website *http://www.ireps.gov.in*. • The tenderer/bidders must have Class-III Digital signature certificate & must have registered on IREPS Portal • All relevant papers must be uploaded at the time of participating in e-tendering. • The bidders are advised to periodically check for online corrigendum issued, if Any. No separate publication in newspaper shall be issued.

Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer (G)
CPRO/Vidyut-175 **Izatnagar**

Never travel on roof and foot boards.

SBI

STATE BANK OF INDIA, STRESSED ASSETS MANAGEMENT BRANCH-I
12th Floor, Jawahar Vyapar Bhawan (STC Building),
1, Tolstoy Marg, Janpath, New Delhi-110001, E-mail : sbi.04109@sbi.co.in

POSSESSION NOTICE (Under Rule 8 (1) of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules ,2002
(For immovable property)

Whereas, The Authorized Officers of State Bank of India led Consortium Member Banks under Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(2) read with rule 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued demand Notices on different dates as per undernoted details by member banks.

Sr. No.	Name of the Lender	Date of 13(2) Notice	Amount of the Notice as on date of issuance of 13(2)	Future Intt from
1.	State Bank of India	06.01.2026	82,66,28,754.76	06.01.2026
2.	Canara Bank	03.03.2026	16,27,14,721.11	03.03.2026
3.	Bank Of India	02.05.2026	29,13,68,645.62	02.05.2026
	Total		1,28,07,12,121.49	

Calling upon the borrower/guarantors:-

1. **M/s Swastik Pipe Limited (Borrower)** at 1/23 B, Asaf Ali Road, Ajmeri Gate Extn, New Delhi 110002 .
2. **Sh Sandeep Bansal S/o Sh Devki Nandan Bansal (Guarantor)** R/o House no. 2, Road no. 60, West Punjabi Bagh, Delhi 110026 .
3. **Smt Anupama Bansal W/o Sh Sandeep Bansal (Guarantor)** R/o House no. 2, Road no. 60, West Punjabi Bagh, Delhi 110026 .

To repay the amount mentioned in the notices being **Rs 1,28,07,12,121.49(Rupees One Hundred Twenty Eight Crores Seven lacs Twelve Thousand One Hundred Twenty one & Forty Nine Ps only)**as per detail above along with future interest on the aforesaid amount together with incidental cost, charges etc. within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.

The borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower/guarantors and the public in general that the **undersigned being the Authorised Officer of State Bank of India on behalf of SBI led Consortium Banks has taken POSSESSION** of the property (s) described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under section 13(4) of the said Act read with rule 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules,2002 on this **31st Aug 2026.**

The borrower/guarantors in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property (s) and any dealings with the property (s) will be subject to the charge of the SBI led consortium for an amount of **Rs 1,28,07,12,121.49 (Rupees One Hundred Twenty Eight Crores Seven Lacs Twelve Thousand One Hundred Twenty One & Forty Nine Ps only)** as on above dates along with future interest on the said amount, incidental cost, charges etc thereon.

The borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE/MORTGAGED PROPERTY

1. Property bearing Khewat no. 181 Min , khata no. 500 min, Khasra no. 809(2-4),Khasra no. 815 (4-L6) situated in village Asaudha Todran, Tehsil Bahadurgarh , Dist Jhajjar Haryana -124507 admeasuring . 21168 Sq yd i.e. 4.3735 acre approx in the name of M/s Swastik Pipe Limited having sale deed Regn. No. 823, dated 24.10.1973 bounded as follows :
   East : Road 17m wide **North:** HPCL Plant
   West: Property of Saksham Containers **South:** Road 12m wide & Kia Land
2. Property bearing no. 1/23 B, First Floor, Front side portion without roof rights situated at Asaf Ali Road, New Delhi -110002 admeasuring 2318.88 sq. ft in the name of M/s Swastik Pipe Limited having sale deed no. 512 dated 09.02.1998 bounded as follows :
   East: Property No. 1/B-24 **North:** Remaining Part of Property (rear side portion)
   West: Property No. 1/B-22 **South:** Asaf Ali Road 65 ft wide below
3. Commercial free hold property bearing no. 4, situated in the Central market, west Punjabi Bagh, New Delhi-110026 admeasuring 132 sq. yards in the name of Sri Sandeep Bansal having sale deed no. 3696 dated 27.05.1993 bounded as follows :
   East: Property No. 5 **North:** Rear Passage
   West: Property No. 3 **South:** Entry Road

DATE : 31.08.2026
Place: New Delhi

Sd/-
Authorized Officer, State Bank of India

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SOUTH

CHATTARPUR : A & M MEDIA ADVERTISING, Ph.: 9811602901, 65181100, 26301008, **KALKAJI :** ADWIN ADVERTISING, Ph.: 9811111825, 41605556, 26462690, **MALVIYA NAGAR :** POOJA ADVERTISING & MARKETING SERVICE, Ph.: 9891081700, 24331091, 46568866, **YUSUF SARAI :** TANEJA ADVERTISEMENT & MARKETING Ph.: 9810843218, 26561814, 26510090

NCR

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EDUCATION (IAS & PMT ACADEMIES)

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AU SMALL FINANCE BANK LIMITED (A SCHEDULED COMMERCIAL BANK)

Registered office :- 19-A, Dhuleswar Garden, Ajmer Road, Jaipur-302001, Rajasthan(India) CIN L36911RJ1996PLC011381

APPENDIX-IV-A [See proviso to rule 8(6)] Sale notice for sale of immovable properties

E-auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8 (6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower (s)/ Co-Borrower (s)/Mortgagor (s) and Guarantor (s) that the below described immovable properties mortgaged to the Secured Creditor, the constructive/physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of **AU Small Finance Bank Limited (A Scheduled Commercial Bank),** the same shall be referred herein after as **AUSFB**. The Secured Assets will be sold on **"As is where is", "As is what is", and "Whatever there is"** basis through E-Auction for recovery of amount mentioned in the table below along with further interest, cost, charges and expenses being due to **AUSFB** viz. Secured Creditor.

It is hereby informed you that we are going to conduct public E-Auction through website **https://sarfaesi.auctiontiger.net**

Loan A/c Number / Name of Borrowers/ Co-Borrowers/ Guarantors/Mortgagers	Date & Amount of 13(2) Demand Notice	Date of Possession	Description of Property	Reserve Price For Property	Earnest Money For Property	Date & Time of E-Auction	Date of Bid Submission	E-Auction Place of Tender Submission	Contact Person and property visit date
A/c No.: L9001060732097133 & L9001060838156489 **Virendra Singh Malik (Borrower),** Smt.Savita Devi (Co-Borrower)	19-Jun-25 Rs. 1433909/- Rs. fourteen Lakh thirty-three Thousand nine hundred nine Only **As on 12-Jun-25** & Rs. 584333/- Rs. five Lakh eighty-four Thousand three hundred thirty-three Only **As on 10-Jun-25**	20-Jul-26	Property Situated At- Plot No-20 B And Part Of Plot No-21, Khasra No-179/1, Village- Kaili Pargana Sarawa, Teh & Distt- Meerut, Uttar Pradesh **Property area as per documents 193.73 SQ Yrd but physically available 173.33 SQ Yrd.**	Rs. 3740000/- Rs. Thirty-Seven Lakh Forty Thousand Only.	Rs. 374000/- Rs. Three Lakh Seventy-Four Thousand Only.	29-Oct-26 2.00 PM to 4.00 PM with unlimited extension of 5 minutes	On or Before 27-Oct-26	Au Small Finance Bank Ltd, Ground Floor, 76, Delhi Road, Meerut, Uttar Pradesh 250001	Amit Lohiya , 7340011760 & 9773358234 , auctions@aubank.in visit date : 23-Oct-26

The terms and conditions of e-auction sale:-

(1.) The E-Auction sale of Secured Asset is on "as is where is" , "as is what is" , "whatever there is" and "no recourse" basis for and on behalf of the Secured Creditor viz. AUSFB and there is no known encumbrance which exists on the said property. **(2.)** For participating in online e-auction sale, Bid document, copies of PAN Card, Board Resolution in case of Company and photo ID, address proof are required to be submitted along with EMD, which is payable by way of **RTGS/NEFT/DD in the name of MSME AUCTION POOL ACCOUNT OF AU Small Finance Bank Limited, Current account No.1921201121711599** AU SMALL FINANCE BANK LIMITED Fifth and Sixth Floor Sunny Big Junction STC Khasra No. 64 to 67 ,Gram Sukhaipura New Atish Market Jaipur 302020, **IFSC Code: AUBL0002011,** Once an Online Bid is submitted, same cannot be withdrawn. Further any EMD submitted by bidder will be required to send the **UTR/Ref no/DD No of the RTGS/NEFT/DD** with a copy of cancelled cheque on the following **email IDs i.e. auctions@aubank.in (3.)** All Interested participants / bidders are requested to visit the **website https://sarfaesi.auctiontiger.net & https://www.aubank.in/bank-auction** for further details including Terms & Conditions, to take part in e-auction sale proceeding and are also advised to contact **e-mail of auctions@aubank.in**

Please Note: - This is also a 30 days notice Under Rule 8(6) read with Rule 9(1) to the Borrowers/Co Borrowers/Mortgagors of the above said loan account about sale through tender / inter se bidding on the above-mentioned date. The property will be sold, if their outstanding dues are not repaid in full by the borrower in the given notice period.

Place : UTTAR PRADESH Date : 05-09-2026 **Authorised Officer AU Small Finance Bank Limited**

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Bhim Sain S/O Kidar Nath Caste Kathari R/O Gurdaspur Main Punjab is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 362/1992 U/S 406/419/420 RPC of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name :- Bhim Sain
S/O :- Kidar Nath
Caste :- Kathari
Address:- Gurdaspur Main Punjab

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1. DPO, Jammu :- 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D :- sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu :- 0191-2605949
4. SP City South :- 0191-2430002
5. SDPO City East :- 01912433778
6. P/S Bahu Fort :- 0191-2475133

For **Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu**

DIP NO. DIP/J-9550/26 DATE 05.09.2026

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Surjeet Singh alias Sunny S/O Nek Ram Caste Tahakar Rajput R/O Rajwalta Tehsil Billawer Kathua is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 194/2003 U/S 457/380 RPC of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name : Surjeet Singh alias Sunny
S/O : Nek Ram
Caste : Tahakar Rajput
Address : Rajwalta Tehsil Billawer Kathua

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1. DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949
4. SP City South : 0191-2430002
5. SDPO City South : 01912433778
6. P/S Bahu Fort : 0191-2475133

Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu

DIP/J-9549/26 DATE: 05.09.2026

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I Monika W/o Sachin Taneja R/o G-251, DLF, Sector-10, Faridabad HR have changed my name to Monieka Taneja

0040876767-4

I, Manoj Khatri, S/o Moolchand Khatri, R/o Flat No.1550, Catenia Tower, Mahagun Mascot, Crossing Republik, Ghaziabad, UP-201016, have changed my name to MANOJ KUMAR KHATRI for all future purposes. 0071059056-1

I,HIMANI AGARWAL,W/O-UMESH AGARWAL,R/O-J-15,HAUZ KHAS ENCLAVE DELHI-110016,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO HIMAANI AGARRWAL FOR ALL PURPOSES

0040876780-8

I,Zubair Ahmad,S/o Abdul Aziz,R/o-J-3/140,Kishan Kunj,Laxmi Nagar Delhi-92,has changed my name to Zubair Ahmed,for all purpose

0040876791-11

I, POONAM CHAUDHARY,w/o VIRENDRA SINGH,H.No-N34 ULDHANPUR, New vidhya vihar Naveen SHAHADARA EAST DELHI-110032,have changed my name to POONAM DEVI

0040876780-1

I Sabba Parveen D/o Afroj Alam R/o Village-Jaynagra, Post-Manipur, PS-Nokha, Meyari, Rohtas, Bihar - 802217, have changed my name to Yasmin Parveen

0071059113-1

I, Montu S/o K.D. Panday R/o,H.No.25B, Gali-No.25A, Swatantra Nagar, Kureni, Narela, North-West Delhi, Delhi-110040,have changed my-name to Mantu Pandey.

0040876791-4

I,Pranay Praveen Deshmukh,S/o-Praveen Kumar Deshmukh,R/o-Flat No.C-2512,Ace City, Sec-1,Greater Noida West,Gautam Buddha Nagar,Uttar Pradesh-201306 have changed my name to Pranay Deshmukh.

0040876767-6

I AAYUSH RUSTAGI R/O A-142 SUSHANT LOK-1 GURGAON HARYANA-122002 HAVE CHANGED MY MINOR SON NAME NUMAIRE RUSTAGI TO NUMAIR RUSTAGGI.

0040876780-3

I hitherto known as Anil Kumar Alias Anil K Kher S/o Ajudhia Nath Kher residing at F-256, Near Shankar Road, PO-New Rajinder Nagar, Delhi - 110060, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Anil Kumar Kher.

0071059102-1

I,Gaurav Soni,S/o-Kailash Soni,R/o.A-229,Second Floor,Today Blossom 1, Sector-47,Gurugram (Haryana)-122018,have changed my Minor Son's name from Atharva Soni to Atharv Soni.

0040876780-10

I,RENU SAGAR alias RENU RATAWAL alias RENU D/O-Pooran Chand, Ex-W/o Manish Ratawal, R/o-Plot No-266, Flat No-404, 4th Floor, Najafgarh Road, Nawada Village, Uttam Nagar, D.K. Mohan Garden, Delhi-59, declare that I got divorce from my husband Vide Court Decree HMA No. 680/19 Dated 02.05.2019. further I have changed name of mine shall hereafter be known as RENU SAGAR.

0040876710-2

I, BABITA W/o JUGAL KISHORE VASHIST, R/O D- 496A, D-497, INDRA PARK, MAKSUDA COLONY, NAJAFGARH, DELHI-110043, have changed my name to BABITA VASHIST for all future purposes

0071059042-1

I Mohd Warik S/o Ushuf R/o H2, N-34, B-194, T Huts, H-Block, Jahangir Puri, North West Delhi-110033, have changed my name to Mohd Barik.

0071059116-1

I,SHUBHAM S/O TILAK RAJ R/O HNO.42/7 TEHSIL CAMP RAM NAGAR PANIPAT HARYANA-132103.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SHUBHAM JHAMB.

0040876791-6

I,Lalit Aggarwal,s/o-Padam chand Aggarwal,r/o-Ashirwad Palam Farm 6,village Salahapur Bijwasan,Delhi - 110061 have changed my name to Lalit Kumar Aggarwal.

0040876767-8

I Martina W/o Mahender Kumar R/o House No-38,Block-B,Gali No-4,Taj Highway Rajmarg Jagdamba Enclave, Noida. UP-201301. Have Changed My Name To Martina Basu Matari.

0071059106-1

I,Gupta Bharti Ashok,W/o-Ashok Gupta,R/o-F-G2,Aditya Mega City,Vaibhav Khand,Ghaziabad (Uttar Pradesh) - 201014, have changed my name to Bharti Gupta.

0040876780-12

I,Sanjeev S/o Kailash Chand Goel R/o Flat-No.304, Tower-C-4, Supertech Eco Village-2, Sector-16B, Greater Noida(U.P) have changed my name to Sanjay Goel for all purposes.

0040876708-2

I,Shivali Saini,W/o Saqib Noor,R/o-House.No-H/30,3rd-Floor,Lajpat Nagar-1,Delhi-110024,have changed my name to Shivali Permanently

0040876652-1

I,Mohammed Javed S/o Mohammed Saleem R/o Jhuggi No-168,Lal Bagh T-Huts,Azadpur, Delhi-110033have changed my name to Mohammed Jawed

0040876767-1

I, MANINDER KAUR BAMRAH W/o TEJINDER SINGH, R/O 310, SAINIK VIHAR, PITAMPURA, DELHI-110034, have changed my name to MANINDER KAUR for all future purposes

0071059045-1

I,ANITA W/O RAVINDER SINGH RAWAT R/O HNO.41 BLOCK-H MANGOL PURI DELHI-110083.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ANITA RANI FOR ALL PURPOSES.

0040876780-5

I,VINOD S/O KANNU DUTT SHARMA,R/O-B-81-A, 2ND FLOOR,DEEP VIHAR PANSALI, DELHI-110042,have changed my name to VINOD SHARMA

0040876791-8

I Sajid Khan S/O Asger Ali R/o Papari Khurd bujurg, Kaimganj, Farrukhabad, Barjhala, UP-209502 has changed the name of my minor son aged 9 years from Mo. Jain to Mo. Ali for all future purposes.

0040876646-1

I,Pankaj Kumar,S/O-Sh.Ramesh Chand Garg,R/O.A-7/30,Sec-15,Rohini,Delhi-110089.Declare that on some documents,my name has been mentioned,as,Pankaj Kumar and,on some other documents,my name has been mentioned,as Pankaj Kumar Garg.So that I,hereby declare that both the,names Pankaj Kumar and Pankaj Kumar Garg,are related to me and are same person and I will be Known by Pankaj Kumar in future all purposes.

0040876767-10

I Santosh W/o M Prasanna Kumar R/o Flat No-J 308 Tulip ETA The Gardens, Near Binny Mill Road No-9, PO-Magadi Road, Dist-Bengaluru, Karnataka - 560023, have changed my name to Santosh Porwal

0071059109-1

I,Moumita Das,D/o-Sh.Prashant Das,R/o-1060/10,D-Block,Street No.13, Khajoori Khas,North East,Delhi-110094,declare that,name of my father,has been wrongly written,as Prasanta Das in my Educational Documents.the actual name,of my father is,Prashant Das.And Prashant Das and Prasanta Das are the same person.

0040876791-1

I,INDERJET JODDER S/o CHANCHAL JODDER R/o A'250, JJ Camp Tigari, BSF Camp Tigari, Delhi-110062,have changed my name to INDERJEET.

0040876767-3

I,TARLOK SINGH,S/o-GURDEEP SINGH R/o-A-262 YAMUNA ENCLAVE NEAR SEC 13,17 PANIPAT HARYANA 132103, have changed the name to TIRLOK SINGH.

0040876780-7

I,Ghazala W/o Zubair Ahmed R/o-J-3/140 Kishan Kunj Laxmi Nagar Delhi-92,has changed my name to Ghazala Begum,for all purpose

0040876791-10

I Aditya Kumar S/o Rama Shankar Singh R/o Jhalkhora, Rohtas, Bihar - 821107, have changed my name to Vishal Kumar

0071059112-1

I,Preeti D/O-Anil Kumar Gupta,R/O.D-62, Gali No-3, Block-D, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi-110092, have changed my name to Preeti Gupta.

0040876791-3

I , Anuradha W/o Raj Mohan Gupta R/o BP - 16 , Pitampura , Delhi - 110088 , have changed my name to Anuradha Gupta permanently.

0040876705-2

I,ANAMIKA,W/O-PANKAJ MISHRA,R/O-FLAT NO-H1-703,Toward C CLASSIC RESIDENCY,RAJ NAGAR EXTENSION,GHAZIABAD-201017 UP,HAVE CHANGE,MY NAME TO,ANAMIKA MISHRA,FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE.

0040876767-5

I,Chand Mohammad,S/o-Mohammad Jamil,R/o-Golden Homes,First Floor,Kh No-207,Gali No-4,Sai City,Shahdara Beri,Gautam Buddha Nagar,Uttar Pradesh-201009,have changed my name to Chaand Mohammad.

0040876780-9

I,SATENDER KUMAR s/o-Ravinder Pratap, R/o-A-32B, Vishwakarma Colony, Lal Kuan, Pul Pehladpur, New Delhi-44, have changed the name of my minor son FUNNY KARAN, aged 05yrs and he shall hereafter be known as KARAN KUMAR.

0040876710-1

I,MARUN BEGUM,W/O-HANIF,R/O-Ward No-27,H.No-866 Balco Nagar Aigarbhar Korba Chhatishgarh-495684,have changed my name,and shall hereafter be known,as MAIRUN BEGUM.

0040876791-14

I,VIRENDER SINGH,S/O SHISH RAM SINGH, H.NO-N-34,ULDHANPUR New VIDHYA Vihar,Naveen SHAHADARA EAST DELHI-110032Have changed my name toVIRENDRA SINGH

0040876780-2

I, SACHIN CHAWLA S/o JAGAN NATH CHAWLA R/o 1C-119, NH-1, FARIDABAD, FARIDABAD HARYANA, 121001 have changed the name of my minor Son from VANNSH CHAWLA to VANSH CHAWLA for all purposes. 0071059115-1

I, Satybhama Kulashari W/o Maheshwar Prasad Kulashari R/o,F1/5C, MIG-Flats, Hari-Nagar, Mayapuri, South West-Delhi, Delhi-110064,have changed my-name to Saty Bhama Kulashari.

0040876791-5

I,Prayag Dutt S/o Tulla Ram R/o B-703, The Golden Palm Sector-168, Noida(U.P) have changed my name to Prayag Datt for all future purposes.

0040876703-1

I,PARDEEP KUMAR SHARMA,S/O-LACHHU RAM SHARMA(L R SHARMA),R/O-FLAT NO.P-401,JAIPURIA SUNRISE GREEN,AHINSA KHAND,INDIRAPURAM,GHAZIABAD,UTTAR PRADESH-201014,have changed,my name to PRADEEP SHARMA. 0040876767-7

I, Mohd Noorhashan S/o Samedin R/o-91, Gali-20, Gurana Road, Baraut, Baghpat, UP have changed my name to Noorhasan.

0071059055-1

I,Neha Ashok Gupta,W/o-Siddhant Malhan,R/o-F-G2, Aditya Mega City, Vaibhav Khand,Ghaziabad (Uttar Pradesh)-201014, have changed my name to Neha Gupta.

0040876780-11

I,Jatinder Kour S/o Mehar Singh R/o G-203, Antriksh Forest Apartment, Sector-77, Noida(U.P) have changed my name to Jatinder Kaur for all purposes.

0040876708-1

I, TEJINDER SINGH BAMRAH S/o JEET SINGH, R/O 310, SAINIK VIHAR, PITAMPURA, DELHI-110034, have changed my name to TEJINDER SINGH for all future purposes

0071059043-1

I AAYUSH RUSTAGI R/O A-142 SUSHANT LOK-1 GURGAON HARYANA-122002 HAVE CHANGED MY MINOR SON NAME MERAKSH RUSTAGI TO MAYRAKSH RUSTAGGI.

0040876780-4

I,AJAY KUMAR SINGHAL,S/o-RAMESHWAR DAS JI,R/o-H.NO.-3, POCKET-H,SECOND FLOOR,SECTOR-18,ROHINI,DELHI-110085 have changed my name to AJJAY KUMAR SINGHAL

0040876791-7

I SURAJ KUMAR SHARMA s/o MANOJ KUMAR SHARMA r/o B-95, Left Side, Third Floor, Hari Nagar, New Delhi-110064 have changed my name as SURAJ SHARMA.

0040876684-2

I,AARTI GIDWANI CHATRATH,D/O-LATE HARISH GIDWANI,R/o -F-9/4,MODEL Town-2,Dr. MUKHERJEE NAGAR North-West DELHI-110009, have changed my name to AARTI GIDWANI.

0040876767-9

I, Noorjahan W/o Ahsan R/o A-197, Third Floor, Devli Extension, Dr. Ambedkar Nagar, New Delhi-110062 declare that my date of birth has been wrongly mentioned as 30.12.1987 in my Passport No.P 5151316. My correct date of birth is 06.07.1990.

0071059107-1

I,Jag Mohan,S/o-Girdhari Lal Juneja,R/o-House No-B-17 F/F, Kalkaji,South Delhi, Delhi - 110019, have changed my name to Jag Mohan Juneja.

0040876780-13

I BANEESH KUMAR BANGIA S/O RAMESH BANGIA R/O 1/47-A GALI NO 4 VISHWAS NAGAR SHAHDARA DELHI-110032 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO BANEESH BANGIA

0040876701-1

I,Jyoti,D/o Ram Chand Matta,R/o-17/26, First-floor,Shakti-Nagar,Shakti Nagar,(North Delhi),PO-Malka Ganj,DIST-North Delhi,Delhi-110007,have changed my name to Jyoti Matta

0040876652-2

I,Usha Rani Kapoor W/o-Vijay Kumar Kapoor, R/o.B-279, Second Floor, Saraswati Vihar, Pitam Pura,Delhi-110034,have changed my name to Usha Kapoor.

0040876767-2

In my son's passport his name and date of birth is wrongly published as Hakanwaj and 01/01/2008 but his correct name is HAKNAWAZ and date of birth is 15/11/2007 for all future purpose. HAKNAWAZ S/O SHAHANWAJ Malik Nagar Muradnagar, Ghaziabad

0071059051-1

I,Prerana,D/o-Shyamnarayan Patel,R/o-9/85 Block 9,Press Colony,Subhash Nagar,Delhi-110027,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Prerana Patel.

0040876780-6

I,HARSIMRANJIT SINGH S/O-BHUPINDER SINGH,R/O-57, POCKET-6,SECTOR-23, ROHINI DELHI-110085,have changed my name to HARSIMRAN JIT SINGH

0040876791-9

I Sajid Khan S/O Asger Ali R/o Papari Khurd bujurg, Kaimganj, Farrukhabad, Barjhala, UP-209502 has changed the name of my minor daughter aged 14 years from Irfa Urf Anabiya to Anabiya Sajid for all future purposes.

0040876646-2

I Noor Jahan W/o Mazhar Hussain R/o 1 Village-Chak Hasana, Sasamusa, Gopalganj, Bihar - 841505, have changed my name to Nurjahan Khatun

0071059110-1

I,Praveen Gupta S/O Inder Prakash Gupta R/O Flat.No.18,Pragatisheel Apartment, Sector-9,Rohini, Delhi-110085,have changed my name to Praveen Kumar Gupta.

0040876791-2

I , Raj Mohan S/o Leela Dhar Gupta R/o BP - 16 , Pitampura , Delhi - 110088 , have changed my name to Raj Mohan Gupta permanently.

0040876705-1

SIKH/PUNJABI

42 yrs, 5'10", Radiologist (PCMS), Teetotaller, Puran Gursikh, Parents Govt. service retired; brother Orthopedician (PCMS). Family owns 8 killa fertile agricultural land. Seeking alliance with religious Sikh girl from respectable family.

0050297034-1

DOCTORS

B'FUL BRAHMIN GIRL MBBS MD 27/5'3" DOING BUSINESS SEEKS MATCH ONLY FROM DOCTOR/BUSINESSMAN/IAS/IPS CASTE NO BAR CALL FATHER 9115551721

0050297019-1

Amritdhari ; Doctor/ Civil Services; Khatri / Arora boy for Dastardhari ; Amritdhari ; 1996/5'4"; M.B.B.S., M.D.[Pediatrics], girl - 9878811167 / 9417990777

0050297035-1

SUITABLE MATCH FOR A GIRL

30/5'4", MS (ENT)

Currently Senior Resident at GMC Kozhikode. Belongs to a respectable Punjabi family from Mumbai. Father is into Construction Business, Brother is Deputy Commissioner (IRS). Looking for a highly qualified professional (Medical/Civil Services/Business) from a Cultured Background. Pref : 5'7"+, Age : 29-33 Yrs.

Call: 9820053170

Marriage Beuro/Website Pls Excuse

SITUATION VACANT

PART TIME JOBS

REQD part/full time, MNC job. Age 30-65 yrs. Prefd- Retired, H'wife, VRS, Self empl. Earn 50k-2 lac / Month 9910653135

0040875821-2

PROPERTY FOR SALE

GENERAL

VILLA for sale- Siolim, Goa/ Riviera Sapphire 2BR+ Study/ 1600 sq.ft., 3 pools, Lawns/ Peaceful Location. Call-9711074727.

0071059040-1

SERVICES

ARE YOU NGO WITH FCRA? CONTACT FOR PROJECT PROPOSALS : 9584355072

0050294545-1

LOST & FOUND

Lost of my FDR (File No.F-16(7163)/2012/RHN, Application No.128420, Priority No.13027) in Rohini LIG Scheme C-1/2019, Sector-34, Rohini, Delhi. In the Name-of Santosh W/o-Gopal Krishan.Finder may Contact-Bhawna D/o-Gopal Krishan at-3262/1, Mahindra Park,Rani Bagh,Delhi-110034

0040876706-1

ORIGINAL SALE DEEDS OF PROPERTY NO.WZ-1853,FIRST FLOOR,RANI BAGH, SHAKUR BASTI,DELHI-110034,HAVE LOST. FINDER CONTACT RAJESH TANDON AT ABOVE ADDRESS/M.NO.7838839699

0040876767-13

Lost Original Sale Deed documents No. 1844, Book No. I, Volume No. 257, on Page 07 to 09, dated 22.06. 1992, registered in the office of SR Ghaziabad, U.P.Finders may contact at Indian Bank, Sector -63, Noida, U.P.

0040876673-1

Original sale deeds of C-23, Shankra Acharya Road, Adarsh Nagar, New Delhi, jointly owned by Vijay Kumar Dang and Anil Kumar Dang, sons of Late Shri Desraj Dang, misplaced during shifting.

0050297022-1

I, Suresh Kumar S/o Sohan Singh R/o Ghori Bacheda, Greater Noida, G.B Nagar U.P have lost my Allotment Letter on Plot No-118, Block-B, Area-130 Sqm, Allotment No-Ghd01978, Village/sector-Ghori Bacheda Greater Noida G.B.Nagar

0071059118-1

Lost my Original FDR No.16429(Application No.164192) of Rohini Residential Scheme,1981.Finder may contact-Rajeshwari Malkoti,W/o Late Ajit Ram Malkoti(Sharma), S-3.,Arjun Apartment,Vikaspuri,Delhi.Contact No-9212479070

0040876767-12

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the general public that my client, Afroz Begum W/o Mohammad Naeem, R/o A-458, Third Floor, New Ashok Nagar, Delhi-96, has disowned and debarred her son Mohammad Asif Ali S/o Mr. Mohammad Naeem, from her movable and immovable properties due to his misconduct and inappropriate behaviour.

Accordingly, Mohammad Asif Ali has no right, title, claim or interest whatsoever in any movable or immovable property of my client. My client shall not be responsible for any transaction, agreement, loan, liability or any other act undertaken by him in her name or in respect of her properties. Any person dealing with him shall do so at his/her own risk and responsibility.

AZIZ ULLAH (Advocate) Enrl. No.D/2988/15 Chamber No.E-711, Karkardooma Courts, Shahdara, Delhi-32

PUBLIC NOTICE

My clients Sh. Sushil Babu Jain, S/o Sh. Sewa Ram Jain, and his wife Smt. Reeta Jain, R/o H. No. 4/1692, Bhola Nath Nagar, Ration Office Road, Shahdara, Delhi -110032, have severed all relations with their son Sh. Chirag Jain and daughter-in-law Smt. Sneha Jain on account of their disobedient conduct, and have disowned and debarred them from all their movable and immovable properties, present and future, including Property Nos. B-78 and B-79, Sector 10, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh 201301. The said persons shall have no right, title, interest or claim therein, by inheritance or otherwise. Anyone dealing with them shall do so at his/her own risk, and my clients shall not be liable for any act, deed or liability of the said persons.

MADHUR ARORA (ADVOCATE) 128-A, (R.S Block), Street No.14, Bhola Nath Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi-110032

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform to public at large that my client namely Sh. Raisuddin S/o Late Shamsuddin R/o S-153/131, 2nd Floor, Abul Fazal Enclave Part-1, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi-110025, has severed all relationship from his second wife Nishat and two of her daughters before marriage namely Ziya and Anam and disowned and debarred them from all movable and immovable properties of my client as they has become disobedient and they are out of control of my above client and my client have nothing to do with them. Nobody should deal with them in regard to any of existing assets or any other assets which may be acquired by clients in future. My client shall not be responsible for their acts, deeds and things.

ABHISHEK SONKAR (Advocate) Ch. No. B-72, B.G.S. Block, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client Smt. Kusam Jain @ Kusam Kumari Jain, W/o Sh. Sewa Ram Jain, R/o H. No. 4/1692, Bhola Nath Nagar, Jain Mandir Road & Ration Office Road, Near Babu Ram School, Shahdara, Delhi 110032, has severed all relations with her grandson Sh. Chirag Jain and his wife Smt. Sneha Jain (Muskan) on account of their disobedient conduct, and has disowned and debarred them from all her movable and immovable properties, present and future including Property No. 4/1692, Bhola Nath Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi 110032. The said persons shall have no right, title, interest or claim therein, by inheritance or otherwise. Anyone dealing with them shall do so at his/her own risk, and my client shall not be liable for any act, deed or liability of the said persons.

MADHUR ARORA (ADVOCATE) 128-A, (R.S Block), Street No.14, Bhola Nath Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi-110032

PUBLIC NOTICE

To be known to all that my client Manju Sharma W/o Sh. Kapil Dev Sharma R/o Flat No. CB-49D, First Floor, G-8 Area, Rajouri Garden, Hari Nagar, New Delhi-110064. The Original documents i.e. DDA Allotment Cum Demand Letter, DDA Possession Letter, Possession Slip, NOC for Electric and Water has been lost. An FIR to this has been lodged vide LR.No.604054/2026:dated:03-09-2026. Any Person(s) claiming any right, interest, having any objection or found in possession of original documents may write/ contact with above named person at above address within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice. The person claiming any right, interest, objection with respect to this property can personally informed.

Sd/-B.B.N.Deo,Advocate SR.II.B.Campus,Janak Puri,New Delhi-58

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client L&T Finance Holdings Ltd, Sector-63, Noida, U.P. is in the process of advancing a loan to Mrs. Tilottama Nischal against mortgage of Entire Basement, Ground Floor, Entire First Floor & Entire Terrace above the Third Floor of Property No. 12, (125 sq. yds.), Block-B-7, Safdarjung Enclave, New Delhi (after release of the same from SBI) and has represented that she is the absolute owner of the said property vide Relinquishment Deed dated 06.02.2012 (Doc. No. 1312) executed by Mrs. Sureela Nischal, Mrs. Bharti Nischal & Mrs. Vidhu Nischal. If anybody, person, body corporate (other than SBI), has any right, lien, claim or objections whatsoever on the said Property by way of inheritance, mortgage, sale or otherwise, then he/she/it may contact the undersigned with documentary proof of claim within 7 days of publication of this notice, otherwise it shall be deemed that either there are no claims or the same have been waived off. No claim or objection shall be entertained thereafter and Bank shall proceed to advance the loan on mortgaging of the said property.

Vishal Chopra, Advocate Narang & Associates D-28, Jangpura Extension, New Delhi-110014.

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client L&T Finance Ltd., 5th Floor, DCM Building, 16, Barakhamba Road, C.P., New Delhi is in the process of advancing a loan to Mr. Shanker Lal, for purchase of Ground Floor, Part of Property No. 17/21, Shakti Nagar, Delhi from Mrs. Shashi Bala Goel who has represented that she is the owner of the said Property by virtue of Sale Deed dated 18.04.2001 (Reg. no. 1621) but she has lost all the title documents of the said floor prior to the sale deed dated 18.04.2001 and has lodged a complaint in this regard as LR No. 601496/2026 Dated 02/09/2026 with PS Civil Lines Delhi. If anyone has any right, interest, lien, claim or objection to the said sale & mortgage of the said Property on the basis of lost documents or otherwise, then he/she/it may contact the undersigned with documentary proof of claim within 7 days of publication of this notice, otherwise it shall be deemed that either there are no claims or the same have been waived off. No claim shall be entertained thereafter and my client shall proceed to advance the loan by mortgaging the said property.

Vishal Chopra, Advocate Narang & Associates D-28, Jangpura Extension, New Delhi-110014.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Information is given to general public at large upon instruction from Mrs. Vandana Jain & Mr. Ashish Jain who intends to mortgage Property No. G-70, First, Second, Third & Fourth Floor, G block, Laxmi Nagar, New Delhi-110092 are the owners through Sale Deed dated 30.05.2023 executed by Mrs. Vaishali Jain duly Regd. as Doc No. 3829, in Book No.1, Vol No. 2816, Page No. 33-42, Dated 31.05.2023, (SRO-VIII-A, Delhi) who was the owner through Sale Deed dated 10.08.2020 executed by M/s Kaka Buildcon Ltd. (Doc No.2632). That Original Sale Deed dated 10.08.2020 executed by M/s Kaka Buildcon Ltd. (Doc No.2632) is missing and not traceable. An online F.I.R. has been lodged on 05.09.2026, in P.S. - Krishna Nagar, Delhi vide LR No: 608126/2026/ 2026. Anyone who find it is requested to submit the same to above mentioned address. Misuse of the same may be liable for legal action.

Any person(s), institution(s) having any claim and/or objection in respect of the said property shall communicate the same to the undersigned at our address within 14 days from the publication of this notice with documentary evidence in support thereof, failing which all the claim, of such person(s)/institution(s) shall not be binding upon the said property or Godrej Finance Limited. Mohd K. Hussain (Advocate) D-21, Basement, Block-D, Jangpura Extn, New Delhi-110014, 8810391672

COURT NOTICE

IN THE COURT OF MS. DIVYA GUPTA, ARC-02, ROOM NO.36, THE CENTRAL, DELHI

MOHIT AHUJA ......PETITIONER

V/s

USHA DHAWAN ....RESPONDENT

E-31/26(RC ARC 35/26)

1. SH. ANIL DHAWAN
2. SH. SUNIL DHAWAN

BOTH AVAILABLE AT: SHOP NO 5228, GROUND FLOOR, KOLHAPUR ROAD KAMLA NAGAR DELHI

BOTH AVAILABLE AT: R/O E-4/21-C MODAL TOWN, DELHI 110009

(Name, description and place of residence of the tenant); WHEREAS PETITIONER has filed an application (a copy of which is annexed) for your eviction from THE TENANTED PREMISES (mentioned in copy attached) on the ground specified in clause (e) of the proviso to sub-section (1) of Section 14.

You are hereby summoned to appear before the Controller within fifteen days of the service thereof and to obtain the leave of the Controller to contest the application for eviction on the ground aforesaid in default whereof, the applicant will be entitled at any time after the expiry of the said period of fifteen days to obtain an order for your eviction from the said premises.

Leave to appear and contest the application may be obtained on an application to the controller supported by an affidavit as referred to in sub-section (5) of Section 23(B)

Given under my hand and seal of the court, this 02-09-2026.

Seal Sd/- Additional Rent Controller, Delhi

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, Aditi Sachdeva, D/o Tilak Raj Sachdeva, R/o D-1/1005, Vasant Kunj, New Delhi–110070, hereby inform that Punjab National Bank cheque nos. 088671 to 088681 have been lost/misplaced and the same has been reported to Delhi Police. Any use or misuse of the said cheques shall be considered unauthorized and illegal, and may attract criminal and legal action against the person/persons concerned.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notified that my client Mrs. Dulari Sharma W/o Late Shri Mahavir Sharma, R/o 465/10, Chander Quarter Rampura, Onkar Nagar North-West Delhi-110035, has severe relation from her son Manish Sharma and his wife Neha Sharma and their siblings. Due to their cruel and harassing behavior towards my above named client. Now she have no domestic relations with them and have disowned and disinherited them from all movable & immovable properties. Any person dealing with him/her/their will do at their own cost & risk and my clients should not be responsible for them, If any.

SAURABH GUPTA (Advocate) ENRL.NO. D/369/2011

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it know to all that my client Sh. Roop Chand Punia S/o Late Sh. Shambhu Dayal Punia R/o E-181, 2nd Floor, Kalkaji, New Delhi has severed all relations from Saurabh Punia (Son), Ms. Parul Punia (Daughter-in-Law) and Shanaya Punia (Grand-daughter) and has also debarred/disowned them from all movable/immovable properties which belong to my client. Any person dealing with above said persons shall do so at his own risk and consequences and my client shall not be responsible for any of their act/conduct.

S.K. Gautam (Advocate) Ch. No. 553, Dwarka Court, New Delhi.

PUBLIC NOTICE

For & on behalf of my client Mohd Vakil Ahmed, S/o Naeem Miyan & Mrs. Sanjila Khatoon W/o Mohd Vakil Ahmed, R/o Plot No-74 Second Floor Block R3/A2 Mohan Garden, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi–110059 have disowned thier son Gul Mohammad and his wife Mrs. Varisha Khatoon, Due to inappropriate behavior and mental harassment, They disown and debar him/her from all thier movable and immovable properties. My client will not be responsible for their acts. Any one dealing with them shall do at his own risks.

Sohan Kumar (Advocate) B-5, Suneja Tower-1, District Center Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, Savita Sachdeva, D/o Jagdish Judeja, R/o D-1/1005, Vasant Kunj, New Delhi–110070, hereby inform that Punjab National Bank cheque nos. 181563 to 181565 have been lost/misplaced and the same has been reported to Delhi Police. Any use or misuse of the said cheques shall be considered unauthorized and illegal, and may attract criminal and legal action against the person/persons concerned.

"IMPORTANT"

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The Indian EXPRESS — JOURNALISM OF COURAGE —

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

HC D VENKETESWARLLU 64 Bn BSF 19.03.1967 – 06.09.2003

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Head Constable Venketeswarllu on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he made ultimate sacrifice operational duty in area of BOP Kinokhal, Cachar (Assam).

CT SURESH SINGH 92 BN BSF 01.09.1967 – 06.09.1989

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Suresh Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injury in Counterpart firing in area of FDL Kaziranga, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

CT SAMU MARANDI 142 BN BSF 09.02.1968 – 06.09.1990

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Samu Marandi on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries in a fierce encounter with militants in Pulwama area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

LANCE NAIK GOUR CHANDRA DHAM, PMG 69 BN BSF 01.03.1950 - 06.09.1989

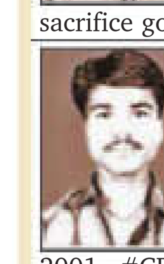
CONSTABLE RAVAN KUMAR, PMG 69 BN BSF 05.09.1966 - 06.09.1989

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans Lance Naik Gour Chandra Dham and Constable Ravan Kumar on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in Ferozepur, Punjab. They fought bravely and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty. Their sacrifice and gallant action have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding them with PMG(Posthumously).

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

Veer Balidani Constable A. Suresh 12 Bn 13-08-1970 To 06-09-1993

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable A. Suresh of 12 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being grievously injured in a cowardly attack by insurgents in Nagaland on 6 September 1993. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Constable Panwar Vijay Gangadhar 122 Bn 05-06-1975 To 06-09-2001

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Panwar Vijay Gangadhar of 122 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice in an IED blast while trying to stop forced entry of an IED - laden truck into his camp at Magam, Budgam, J&K on 6 September 2001. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Constable Desai Paswan 3 Bn 25-10-1966 To 06-09-2001

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Desai Paswan of 3 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being grievously injured in a fierce encounter with Maoists in Latehar district, Jharkhand on 6 September 2001. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Sub Inspector/Ministerial Prabir Bhattacharjee 31 Bn 19-10-1962 To 06-09-2001

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Sub Inspector /Ministerial Prabir Bhattacharjee, who made the supreme sacrifice after being seriously injured in an IED blast in Jammu and Kashmir on 6 September 2001. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Constable Sunil Kumar Pandey 186 Bn 08-07-1985 To 06-09-2023

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Sunil Kumar Pandey of 186 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being grievously injured in a knife attack while trying to apprehend a suspect on Assam - Arunachal Pradesh border on 6 September 2023. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS KATHUA

E- mail: sspkathua@jkpolice.gov.in
Fax/Phone No.: 01922-234010

LOOK OUT NOTICE

On 27-08-2026, one person namely Shakeel Akhter S/O Abdul Majeed R/O Kalyal Tehsil Ramkot District Kathua lodged a written report at PP Ramkot stating therein that on 25-08-2026 his wife namely Nazia Begum, age 25 years went missing from home. The complainant made best efforts to search her wife but all in vain. On this, missing report vide DD No. 24 dated 27-08-2026 has been entered at Police Station Billawar.

During the course of investigation, best efforts were made to locate missing individual, whereas she is still un-traced.

As such Description Roll/Photograph of said missing individual is being shared with the appeal that anybody having clue/information about her whereabouts may inform us accordingly. The informer will be rewarded suitably:-

DESCRIPTION ROLL

- Name: Nazia Begum
- Husband: Shakeel Akhter
- Permanent Address: Kalyal
- Present Address: Kalyal
- Tehsil: Ramkot
- Police Station: Billawar
- Age: 25 years
- Height: 5 feet 05 inch
- Complexion: Fair
- Built: Normal
- Face: Oval
- Eyes: Brown
- Languages known: Hindi/ Dogri

PHOTOGRAPH

Any information related to the whereabouts of the subject may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. DPO Kathua 01922-234010 (Phone/Fax)
2. dpokathua@jkpolice.gov.in (Mail ID)
3. PCR Kathua-01922-234311(Phone/Fax)
4. Police Station Billawar - 9186316020

DIP NO.: DIP/J-9529/26 DATE 05.09.2026

Sr. Superintendent of Police, Kathua.

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, पश्चिमी सिंहभूम, चाईबासा

ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

ई– निविदा सूचना संख्या – RDD/SD/CHAIBASA/05/2026-27

1. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी:

क्र०सं०	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	अग्रधन की राशि	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1	पश्चिमी सिंहभूम जिला के मनोहरपुर प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत पंचायत–छोटानागरा के ग्राम–बाईहातु से टोला–सेतारूईया रोड में कोयना नदी पर पुल निर्माण।	50705700.00	1015000.00	10000.00	24 माह
2	पश्चिमी सिंहभूम जिला के आनन्दपुर प्रख ण्ड अन्तर्गत ग्राम–गुड़गाँव से नवाडीह नाला पर पुलिया निर्माण।	26894300.00	538000.00	10000.00	18 माह
3	पश्चिमी सिंहभूम जिला के मनोहरपुर प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत लाइलोर पंचायत अन्तर्गत फुलवारी रोतिया टोली एवं उरॉव टोली के बीच फुलवारी नाला पर पुल निर्माण।	24334300.00	487000.00	10000.00	15 माह

2. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि – 12.09.2026
3. ई–निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय–दिनांक 12.09.2026 से दिनांक 03.10.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक
4. ई–निविदा खोलने का स्थान – कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, पश्चिमी सिंहभूम, चाईबासा।
5. ई–निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय –. 05.10.2026 अपराह्न 2:00 बजे
6. ई–निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :– कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, पश्चिमी सिंहभूम, चाईबासा
7. ई–निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं० – 7209247617 (संबंधित कार्यपालक अभियंता का दूरभाष नम्बर)
8. परिमाण विपत्र की राशि घट–बढ़ सकती है तदनुसार अग्रधन की राशि देय होगी।
9. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रधन की राशि केवल Online Mode द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।
10. निविदा खोलने की तिथि से 5 दिनों के अन्दर निविदादाता अपनी आपत्ति / दावा दर्ज कराये अन्यथा अवधि बीतने के पश्चात् कोई भी आपत्ति / दावा मान्य नहीं होगा।
11. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रधन की राशि का ई–भुगतान संवेदक के जिस बैंक खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रधन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बंद कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही आपकी होगी।
12. किसी भी समय बिना सूचना के निविदा रद्द एवं किसी भी प्रकार का संशोधन करने का अधिकार अधोहस्ताक्षरी को सुरक्षित रहेगा एवं इस पर किसी प्रकार का दावा एवं आपत्ति मान्य नहीं होगा।

विस्तृत जानकारी के लिये वेबसाईट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।

ह०/–
कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, पश्चिमी सिंहभूम, चाईबासा।

PR.NO.389103 West Singhbhum(26-27):D

BRIDGE

DEALER: South **VULNERABLE:** Both

NORTH	SOUTH
♠ K 5 4 2	♠ A J 8
❤ K 10 7 5	❤ A J 9 6 4 2
♦ 6 5 2	♦ K 7
♣ 10 4	♣ K Q

SOUTH	WEST	NORTH	EAST
1❤	dbl	2❤	pass
4❤	pass	pass	pass

West leads the club ace, then the club five; East plays the seven and nine. Plan the play.

THE WEST HAND

♠ Q 10 9 7 ❤ 3 ♦ A Q 3 ♣ A 8 6 5 3

THE EAST HAND

♠ 6 3 ❤ Q 8 ♦ J 10 9 8 4 ♣ J 9 7 2

Declarer should win trick two, draw three rounds of trumps ending in dummy (starting with the king, since West, who doubled for takeout, is more likely to be void of hearts than East), then lead a low spade to the eight. Once trumps have behaved, this line ensures the contract against any distribution of the cards. West can capture the eight of spades, but he is end played: any lead gives declarer a tenth trick.

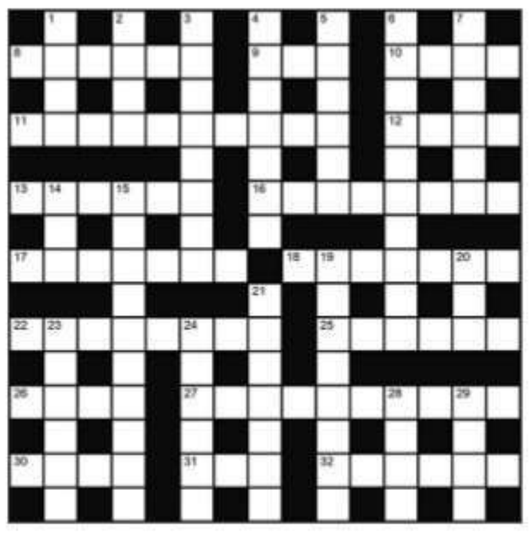
DEALER: West **VULNERABLE:** East/West

NORTH	SOUTH
♠ A 5 4	♠ 7 6 3 2
❤ K 6 3	❤ A 8 7
♦ K 8 7 4 2	♦ A Q
♣ 9 4	♣ A K 5 3

SOUTH	WEST	NORTH	EAST
	pass	pass	pass
1NT	pass	3NT	pass
pass	pass		

West leads the spade king. Plan the play.

• SUNDAY CROSSWORD 2598



QUICK CLUES

ACROSS

8. Get hold of (6)
9. Vietnamese New Year (3)
10. Ship's body (4)
11. Make young again (10)
12. Snack (4)
13. Given the present situation (2,2,2)
16. Largest moon of Jupiter (8)
17. Selecting (7)
18. Glowing with light (7)
22. Paper for brides (8)
25. Very small (6)
26. Metric prefix (4)
27. Put parts together again ? (10)
30. Bludgeon (4)
31. "Nope!" (3)
32. Icily (6)

DOWN

1. Accomplished (4)
2. Social ostracism - "Abut" anagram ? (4)
3. Physically present ? (6,2)
4. In general (2,5)
5. Scattered about (6)
6. A rare occurrence (10)
7. Shut (6)
14. Asian honorific (3)
15. Run away or flee (4,6)
19. Cut into two equal parts (8)
20. Fruit kernel (3)
21. Ms. Basu of Bollywood (7)
23. US state "no goer" anagram ? (6)
24. Crowd (6)
28. Factory (4)
29. Interval of calm (4)

CRYPTIC CLUES

ACROSS

8. A little medicine having great power to identify the snake-haired non-male malefactor (6)
9. Do auditors partially belong to this organization ? (3)
10. Is not curtailed in broken tins (4)
11. Instrument noted for precision (6,4)
12. Kick the rear end (4)
13. Towards the back, be obstructive (6)
16. Imagined having had some food, so upset inside (8)
17. Not a large measure of spirit, just a little one (4,3)
18. Opening with a spinner might be very good (3-4)
22. Many go wrong-many go wrong-it's comic (8)
25. Copies Her Majesty by wearing her Latin American shawl (6)
26. Keep going on about a musical instrument ? (4)
27. Make it intelligible to cancel the egg order ? (10)
30. ...we need it badly in the valley (4)
31. Hesitate to take on the gang leader in a work unit (3)
32. Be prone to self-abasement (6)

DOWN

1. Beelzebub took stock (4)
2. I put up with what sort of Amazonian language? (4)
3. Jumper having a pocket in front (8)
4. He plays by himself (7)
5. Take heart from the deer making progress (4,2)
6. He was to a relatively large extent on the watch (3,7)
7. Zoe's no sort to sleep (6)
14. Roman trinity (3)
15. I try reeling in neat tourist (3-7)
19. Baseball player batting thus but not working (2,6)
20. One of those that might be smacked at a get-together (3)
21. Illustrated invitation to go in for a drink (3,4)
23. Being back in the old quarter has an exhilarating effect (6)
24. Pistol mother got from the employer (6)
28. Many have cut down (4)
29. Animal to finish off the troops (4)

SOLUTIONS TO 2597 **QUICK CLUES ACROSS:** 8 Jump, 9 Ample, 10 Enzo, 11 Recoup, 12 Nosedive, 13 Esoteric, 15 Eaglet, 17 Produce, 19 Fleming, 22 Savage, 24 Gigantic, 26 Revenant, 28 Antony, 30 Ages, 31 Istle, 32 Bite **DOWN:** 1 Jute, 2 Sprouted, 3 Caspar, 4 Spinach, 5 Newsreel, 6 Sea-dog, 7 Azov, 14 Syria, 16 Ennui, 18 Clematis, 20 Manitoba, 21 Agitate, 23 Atease, 25 Grapes, 27 Eggy, 29 Nett **CRYPTIC CLUES ACROSS:** 8 Vera, 9 Hedge, 10 Urus, 11 Jackal, 12 Figurine, 13 Aquarius, 15 Hearty, 17 Willowy, 19 Pickaxe, 22 Doesn't, 24 His grace, 26 Smoother, 28 Nestle, 30 Ibid, 31 Oxbow, 32 Neva **DOWN:** 1 Bema, 2 Walk tall, 3 Chilli, 4 Odd fish, 5 Feng shui, 6 Nutria, 7 Juan, 14 Quito, 16 Toxic, 18 Watchdog, 20 Kerosene, 21 Cherubs, 23 Shoddy, 25 Sinewy, 27 Mobs, 29 Livy

IF IT'S YOUR BIRTHDAY

SUNDAY SEPTEMBER 6: This is a year of learning and teaching. Take time to renew your spiritual beliefs. Explore meditation, prayer or introspection, along with philosophies that give you a better understanding of your life.

MONDAY SEPTEMBER 7: This year will bring benefits from all your hard work. It's time for major decisions and accomplishments. Seize opportunities.

TUESDAY SEPTEMBER 8: Take inventory of your life. Let go of people, places and things that hold you back. Do some internal and external housecleaning. Relax and commune with nature.

WEDNESDAY SEPTEMBER 9: Keep your eyes open for new opportunities and be ready to act. Prepare for leadership. What you do now will bring great benefit in the future.

THURSDAY SEPTEMBER 10: This is a slower paced year. Take time to rejuvenate your energy. Focus on business and personal relationships and hang out with people who have your best interests at heart.

FRIDAY SEPTEMBER 11: Nurture the happiness and beauty you have within. Let your guard down and loosen up a bit! Have fun but remember your goals.

SATURDAY SEPTEMBER 12: Create foundations in your life, both external and internal. Take charge of your health. Stay grounded and levelheaded.

• YOUR WEEK AHEAD

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Relations with parents and authority figures might be strained today. Your best choice is to work hard. Fortunately, relations with partners are good. This Week: Work hard/party hard.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Steer clear of squabbles today, which can easily arise. You might feel criticized. Or, conversely, you might feel critical about someone else. This Week: A playful week. Relations with friends improve.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Money disputes or quarrels about the ownership of something might arise today. Meanwhile, someone older or perhaps a member of a group might challenge your point of view. This Week: Enjoy playful, mental games, plus reading and writing.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Today the Moon is lined up with Mars in your sign at odds with Saturn. This puts a strain on your conversations with others because you might be a tad aggressive. This Week: Fast pace. Romantic social times, plus home repairs.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Something going on behind the scenes might rankle you today. It might have something to do with rules and regulations, the law or tradition. Whatever it is, you might want to ignore it or fight it. This Week: Possessions, plus discussions. Redecorate and entertain.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Relations with friends and groups might be tested today. You might feel someone is not being fair. They might demand too much of you. Or you might think they're not pulling their weight. This Week: Be charming, yet enjoy competitions.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): This is a tricky day. You like to keep the peace and you enjoy harmony in all your relationships. But today your relations with authority figures are aggressive. You might feel criticized, especially by a partner. This Week: Express your thoughts.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Be smart and steer clear of controversial subjects. They could quickly explode into an argument. Meanwhile, issues related to your job, your work or even your health seem to be onerous today. This Week: Shop for wardrobe goodies. Make travel plans.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Something to do with socialising, dealing with your kids, vacations, the arts or romance might be disappointing today. This Week: You're admired. Socialise with younger people.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): This is the classic day for irritable conversations and challenges when dealing with people. An older family relative or a parent might even be in the mix. This Week: Warm friendships. However, be patient with partners.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Although relations with others are aggressive and challenging today, you can get a lot of work done. Steer clear of negative thinking as well as hurt feelings. This Week: Travel plans.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Disputes about money and finances, especially about the cost of a vacation, a social occasion, sports or entertainment are likely today. It's the perfect day for a nap. This Week: Competitive sports. Romance and travel.

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

At the height of ____, the universe is flung into a kaleidoscope of new possibilities - Jean Houston (8)

DLLAE HPSYLU

SUWRT HEIGHT

SOLUTIONS: Ladle, Wurst, Plushy, Eighth
ANSWER: At the height of **laughter**, the universe is flung into a kaleidoscope of new possibilities- Jean Houston

SUDOKU 6432

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 5s INSTRUCTIONS
To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

					7	3	8	
7		6	5	8				
9								
2	4		3			1		
		5			6		7	4
								6
				4	8	2		9
	2	8	6					

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6431

7	2	6	1	5	4	3	9	8
5	9	8	7	2	3	4	1	6
1	3	4	6	8	9	5	7	2
2	1	3	5	9	7	6	8	4
9	8	5	2	4	6	1	3	7
4	6	7	8	3	1	9	2	5
6	4	1	3	7	8	2	5	9
3	7	2	9	6	5	8	4	1
8	5	9	4	1	2	7	6	3

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused Namely: **Subham @ Lambu, S/o. Sanjay, R/o.: H.No.C-375, Balbir Vihar, Kirari, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.71/2024 U/S 392/394/411/34 IPC** registered at **P.S Aman Vihar, Rohini District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said accused **Subham @ Lambu** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Subham @ Lambu** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Subham @ Lambu**, accused of **FIR No. 71/2024 U/S 392/394/411/34 IPC, P.S Aman Vihar, Rohini District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.10.2026**.

By Order, Ms. Shagun,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-North-West,
Room No.109, First Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi.

DP/12592/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Robin Shah** S/o Harak Shah, R/o B-81, Sudama Puri, Moti Nagar, Delhi also at Vill-Beldadi, PS-Beldadi, Distt. Kanchanpur, Nepal has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 249/15 U/s 457/380/511/34 IPC, PS Lahori Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Robin Shah** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Robin Shah** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Robin Shah** in **FIR No. 249/15 U/s 457/380/511/34 IPC, PS Lahori Gate, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.11.2026**.

By order
Ms. Payal Singhal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-09
Central, Room No. 286
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/12218/N/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82(2) (ii) Cr.Pc./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Md. Anish S/o Md. Iqbal** R/o Jhuggi CN 04, Takiya Kale Khan, Meer Dard Road, IP Estate, Delhi and also at H.No. CM4, Dhobi Ghat Takiya Kale Khan Meer Dard Road, Guru Nanak Hospital, New Delhi have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 23152/2023 U/s 411 IPC** has been registered at **P.S. Darya Ganj, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Md. Anish** namely cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Md. Anish** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Md. Anish** of under **FIR No. 23152/2023 U/s 411 IPC** Registered at **P.S. Darya Ganj, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.10.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Nidhi Bala,
JMFC, NI Act-05, Room No. 241,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/12553/CD/2026
(court notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused persons, **Salman@Aryan, S/o.** Sh. Mohd. Arif, **R/o** HN. D-55, Gali No. 18, Chauhan Bangar, Garhi Mendu, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **E-FIR No. : 800029043/2025, U/s. 305 Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita,** registered at **P.S.: Wazirabad, Delhi,** and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Salman@Aryan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Salman@Aryan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person, **Salman@Aryan, E-FIR No. : 800029043/2025, U/s. 305 Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita,** registered at **P.S.: Wazirabad, Delhi,** are required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.10.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Aakash Mohan Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-12 (Central)
Room No-264, 2nd Floor, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/12599/N/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Sh. Chandera Kesh Tiwari R/o Flat No. 108, Pocket-1, Sec-A-6, Near Budh Bazar Road Narela Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **No. 2528/22 U/s 138 NI Act at P.S.: Rani Bagh, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Sh. Chandera Kesh Tiwari** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sh. Chandera Kesh Tiwari** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Sh. Chandera Kesh Tiwari of case No. 2528/22 U/s 138 NI Act of P.S.: Rani Bagh, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 06.10.2026.**

By order
Aakanksha
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
North West Court No.107, 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/11777/OD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Raju S/o Babu R/o Premises Near House No. 132 and 133, Khasra No. 48, Near BSES Pole No. JFPU 127, Old Lal Dora, Village Khaira, Najafgarh, New Delhi-110043** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **FIR No. 802/2022, U/s 135 Indian Electricity Act, PS Chhawla, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Raju** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Raju** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Raju** of Case **FIR No. 802/2022, U/s 135 Indian Electricity Act, PS Chhawla, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **16.10.2026**.

By Order
Harleen Singh
Addl. Sessions Judge
Special Court (Electricity)
Dwarka Court Complex, New Delhi

DP/12568/DW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Akshay@John, S/o.** Naresh, **R/o:** H.No. C-44 Shiv Baksh Park, Nangloi, Outer District, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 1162/2021, U/s: 380/457/411/34 IPC,** registered at **P.S.: Nihal Vihar, Delhi,** and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Akshay@John** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Akshay@John** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Akshay@John, FIR No.: 1162/2021, U/s: 380/457/411/34 IPC,** registered at **P.S.: Nihal Vihar, Delhi,** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.10.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Komal Garg, LD.
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No. 292, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/12615/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Raja S/o Aslam R/o C-12/15, Street No. 8, Kabir Nagar, Jyoti Nagar, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 12469/2022 U/s 379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Darayaganj, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Raja** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Raja** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Raja** of case **FIR No. 12469/2022 U/s 379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Darayaganj, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.10.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Nidhi Bala
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
Central District, Room No. 241
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/12549/CD/2026 (Court Matter)

Department of Water Resources, Government of Odisha

32001/807/2627

"e" Procurement Notice No. ACEDC-BBSR- 08/ 2026-27

1. **Name of the Works:** Total 03 (Three) Nos. Drainage work.
2. **Estimated cost:** Rs. 111.47 lakh to Rs. 336.35 lakh
3. **Period of Completion:** 11 (Eleven) months
4. **Date and time of availability of bid document in the portal:** From 11.00 hours of Dt. 07.09.2026 to 18.00 hours of Dt. 21.09.2026.
5. **Last date/time for receipt of bids in the portal:** 18.00 hours of Dt. 21.09.2026.
6. **Date of Opening of Technical Bid:** 22.09.2026 at 11.00 hours
7. **Name and address of the Officer inviting Bid:** Additional Chief Engineer, Drainage Circle, Unit-8, Bhubaneswar-751012. e-mail Id:- **sedrainagebbsr12@gmail.com**.
8. The update notification will be intimated to the participated bidders to their registered e-mail & to their registered mobile number through an autogenerated text message by e-procurement system. On such intimation, individual bidder needs to log in to their ID through DSC to know the uploaded summary, i.e. details of opening of financial bid, lottery date time, venue, acceptance of bid etc.

Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement portal of Odisha Government **https://tendersodisha.gov.in**. All information, notices, addendum, corrigendum, cancellation notice etc. if required, will be published in this portal.

Sd/-
Additional Chief Engineer
Drainage Circle, Bhubaneswar

OIPR-32001/32409/1/26-27/0009

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Rahul @ Ganja @ Vivek S/o Laxmi Narayan R/o H. No. A-69, JJ Colony, Sector-25, Rohini, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 252/2016 U/s 392/34 IPC, P.S. Paschim Vihar East, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rahul @ Ganja @ Vivek** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rahul @ Ganja @ Vivek** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rahul @ Ganja @ Vivek** of case **FIR No. 252/2016 U/s 392/34 IPC, P.S. Paschim Vihar East, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.10.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Moksha Bains
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11
West, Room No. 31
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/12456/OD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (i) Cr.P.C.)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Wasim S/o Sh. Nabab R/o Pradeep Gurjar Ka Makan, Village Nithari, Near Pani Tanki, Noida, Distt. Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **FIR No. 254/2020, U/s 304 IPC, PS Mandawali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Wasim** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Wasim** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Wasim** of Case **FIR No. 254/2020, U/s 304 IPC, PS Mandawali, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **31.10.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Sachin
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
East Dist., Court No. 16
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/12039/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

मध्यप्रदेश पुलिस आवास एवं अधोसंरचना विकास निगम

कार्यालय परियोजना यंत्री, भदभदा रोड
संभाग क्रमांक-02, भोपाल, Mobile No. : 9425601534,
ई-मेल : bhopaldivision2@gmail.com
क्र.-मप्रपुआअविनि/936/पयं/भोपाल-02/तशा/2026
भोपाल, दिनांक 02.09.2026

प्रेस विज्ञप्ति

निर्माण कार्य 400 मीटर सिंथेटिक एथलेटिक रनिंग ट्रेक (Top Layer) मोतीलाल नेहरू स्टेडियम, लाल परेड ग्राण्उड भोपाल के निर्माण कार्य हेतु निविदा क्रमांक-08/2026-27 ऑनलाइन निविदा क्रमांक-MPPHCL/ TENDER No-2026_MPPHC_533681_1) आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 21.09.2026 समय 5.00 बजे तक ऑनलाइन से खरीदे जा सकते हैं, विस्तृत निविदा सूचना एवं अन्य विवरण **Portal : https://mptenders.gov.in** पर देखे जा सकते हैं।

म.प्र. माध्यम/127864/2026 **परियोजना यंत्री**

DULEEP TROPHY

The spikes are the tell: Inside Shami's refusal to stop bowling

Out of the India side for 545 days, the fast bowler is set to play his 100th first-class match in Chennai

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, September 5

Whenever East Zone have needed a wicket, Mohammed Shami has asked Ishan Kishan for the ball. PTI

IT HAS been 545 days since Mohammed Shami last played for India. It has been 1,182 days since he last did it in a Test, steaming in with that rhythmic run-up and smooth action, seam upright, making the ball talk the way only he can. Since then, the wickets haven't stopped. Just not for India. Ranji Trophy, Duleep Trophy, empty stands, different corners of the country, Shami has kept turning up and kept taking wickets, toiling away with every door to the dressing room seemingly shut.

He isn't giving up. Unlike some of his younger, similarly exiled peers, he hasn't retreated into the IPL alone. At 36, the fire is still there, still asking questions of batsmen, still reminding the selectors he exists, just in case an opening appears out of nowhere. On Sunday, when he walks out for East Zone in the Duleep Trophy final against South Zone at the MA Chidambaram Stadium, it will be his 100th first-class match. A number that says everything about how long he has kept doing this without an audience that matters to selectors.

His captain has noticed. Whenever East Zone have needed a wicket, in the quarterfinal against North East Zone, in the semifinal against Central Zone, Ishan Kishan says Shami would ask for the ball himself. Not sulking about the omission. Not turning his back on the system that made him. Which leads to the obvious question. Why?

Bharat Arun, the former India bowling coach who knows Shami as well as anyone, has an answer. "He loves bowling," Arun tells *The Indian Express*. "It doesn't matter whether it is in the nets or in the middle of a game. You give him the red ball, or any ball for that matter, he would mark his run-up and start bowling."

Arun remembers trying to manage Shami's workload during his time with the Indian team, and mostly failing. "Some days he would turn up at the nets and say 'I don't want to bowl'. But in a matter of a few minutes, he would grab the ball and start bowling. And then you can't stop him unless he bowls for 45 minutes to one hour. So that's what makes Shami. He loves bowling irrespective of where he is."

Eventually Arun found only one method that worked. "So the best way to stop Shami from bowling is, before he leaves the hotel, I will ensure he doesn't wear his spikes to the ground." The spikes are the tell. Shami and his spikes are inseparable, the way a Bharatanatyam dancer is inseparable from her anklets, the start of the same rhythmic act.

"If he wears the spikes, you know he is in the mood to bowl," Arun says. "He doesn't talk much or share his emotional side, but he takes immense pride in being the fast bowler with the best seam position in the world."

That pride survived the thing that should have ended his career. At the 2023 World Cup, Shami took 23 wickets in seven matches, before an ankle injury and the surgery that followed took nearly a year away from him. He came back to deliver in the 2025 Champions Trophy, and has lived on the domestic circuit since. "At the start, he used to try a lot. But he kept learning. Once he realised the seam position is his strength, he worked around it. He started relishing making batsmen uncomfortable with his movements," Arun says.

Built-in endurance

It was never supposed to last this long. When Shami first appeared on the scene, there were doubts about whether he'd sustain it, given how late he'd come to organised coaching, well past his teenage years. The answer was written into his body before it showed up in his numbers. In Sahaspur, he ran on ploughed agricultural fields to build the endurance that carries him, at 36, into his hundredth first-class match, still bowling long spells for a East Zone side chasing its first Duleep Trophy title since 2012-13.

> **"If he wears the spikes, then you know he is in the mood to bowl. He doesn't talk much or share his emotional side, but he is someone who takes immense pride in being the fast bowler with the best seam position in the world."**
>
> **BHARAT ARUN,** FORMER INDIA BOWLING COACH ON MOHAMMED SHAMI.

"As a captain, looking at the effort, I felt very nice, because Shami bhai coming in, asking me for those extra overs to get the wickets, it always gives confidence," Ishan says. "Looking at Shami bhai this season, I feel he has been very different. I've seen him in the past, but his approach towards the game, his intensity, his energy has been very different. When you are not regularly playing for the Indian team and to again have that same kind of motivation for your domestic games, it is tough but I feel I see that hunger in him. I think he has that hunger and that motivation right now like he wants to do that comeback, he wants to be part of Indian squad again and which you can see in him."

Did India shut the door too early? Arun doesn't hedge. "They shouldn't have closed the door on Shami," he says. "There is plenty of cricket left in him. When someone is performing, age shouldn't be a factor. You see his durability. It is an outstanding number for the talent he possesses. It is befitting for Shami. 100 first-class matches with what he loves most, the red ball."

DULEEP TROPHY FINAL: EAST ZONE VS SOUTH ZONE, live from 9:30 am on Star Sports and JioHotstar

Pakistan's batting debacle makes gulf with India evident

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, September 5

Sree Charani (R) picked up three wickets for seven runs. CREIMAS

FOR THE better part of an hour on Saturday, something conspiratorial hung over the Dubai International Cricket Stadium. As if the universe had colluded — à la Shah Rukh Khan — to offer the Women's Asia Cup match between India and Pakistan a pseudo semblance of parity. Never mind that Pakistan had beaten India only three times in 17 T20Is before today, and not once in an ODI. Of all fixtures, this particular fixture — the one that sells tickets, captivates crowds, breaks the internet — cannot be a mundane drab.

So wished the marketing department, perhaps, in the quiet moments before Pakistan were bowled out for 55, which India chased down in 8.4 overs, securing a seven-wicket triumph in the process.

In those initial exchanges, Pakistan had a lot going their way. They won the toss and pushed India into unfamiliar terrain by asking them to do something they had not done in the first two matches — bowl first. They did not lose a wicket in the first four overs — a rare occurrence in itself. Catches were dropped — dollies, at that. Muneeba Ali, the solitary Pakistani batter with over 500 runs in T20Is since 2025, was offered two reprieves. A run out opportunity was politely declined.

When all of it was said and done, Pakistan's score read 27/0 after 4.2 overs. The run rate of 6.24 promised nothing so grand as a thriller, but offered, at least, the shape of a contest. It turned out to be a mirage. Over the next 29 balls, Pakistan lost six wickets and scraped together eight runs. The battle, if one could call it that, had already ended; only the formalities remained.

Shafali strikes

The Pakistani meltdown had an unlikely arsonist in Shafali Verma. Harmanpreet Kaur, featuring in her 150th T20I as a captain — no cricketer has ever done that, regardless of the gender — asked her opener to bowl inside the powerplay. It looked, in that instant, like a gamble. Verma had bowled in the powerplay only five times across 113 caps and had no wickets to show for it.

This time, she did.

In her third delivery, she bowled Ali. An off-spinner castling a southpaw was the first victory for match-up enthusiasts. The second was when left-arm spinner Sree Charani, who was held back when Ali was at the crease, dismissed two right-handers in the next over — Gull Feroza and Shawaal Zulfiqar.

And then there was almost nothing left. The remaining batters added barely 24 between them, and a couple more came from extras, before the innings gave up entirely. India's spin trio of Charani, Prema Rawat and Deepti Sharma were effective yet again, taking eight wickets for 21 runs.

Besides Harmanpreet, a couple of more records were made on the night, both by Pakistan. The first was incidental — it was their 200th T20I. Although, for those who have not watched any of the previous 199, their batting gave the impression of this being the first. The second was earned, in the worst sense of the word — it was their lowest-ever T20I total.

The stands had more life than the innings did. Albeit in a diluted form, pockets of noise still tried to conjure the old fever of an India-Pakistan night. Among the crowd sat cricketers from Hong Kong and Thailand. They might not have imagined that Pakistan's display would make their scores against India — 56 and 65 respectively — look respectable.

India's batting, though, paled in comparison to their bowling, and not for the first time in this competition either. Captain Fatima Sana fought alone from the green corner, and fought valiantly, dismissing every member of India's top three inside the first four overs.

On the macrocosmic fate of the game, her spell was never going to leave a telling impression. What it did, though, was delay the obvious — India eventually took 52 deliveries to chase the total down — whilst also raising a few questions about India's batting. In her third opportunity, India's makeshift number three, Pratika Rawal, scored only four runs.

Sana aside, no other Pakistani bowler caused the Indian team any trouble. Harmanpreet remained unbeaten on a run-a-ball 18, while Deepti contributed 12 runs.

With this victory, India will finish atop Group A, and will face the runners-up of Group B in the semi-final on September 10. Pakistan will now face Hong Kong, who could pose more of a challenge than what they offered the 50-over world champions in this match.

BRIEF SCORES: Pakistan 55 all out (Shawaal Zulfiqar 14; Sree Charani 3/7) lost to India 57/3 in 8.4 overs (Harmanpreet Kaur 18 not out; Fatima Sana 3/17) by seven wickets.

Harman, Sana skip handshake at toss

THE HANDSHAKE saga between the Indian and Pakistani cricket teams continued on Saturday, as the two sides skipped the customary pre-toss pleasantry exchange. Indian skipper Harmanpreet Kaur and her Pakistani counterpart, Fatima Sana, went through the toss without shaking hands.

With this, it has now been nearly a year since the two teams have not been shaking hands on the field of cricket. The trend began on September 14 last year, at the same venue and in the same tournament — then the men's edition of the Asia Cup. Played in the aftermath of the April 22 Pahalgam attack, the fixture saw then-Indian T20I captain Suryakumar Yadav decline to shake hands with his Pakistan counterpart Salman Ali Agha. **ENS**

US OPEN

Serena and Venus' reunion ends in defeat, not in farewell

Bhuvan Gupta
New Delhi, September 5

Serena and Venus Williams lost 3-6, 7-6 (8-6), 6-7 (7-10) to Chan Hao-Ching and Maya Joint. AP

THE WILLIAMS sisters refuse to move on. Serena does not like the word retirement. Venus doesn't want to "ever be ruled out." So when they reprise their old doubles partnership, the crowd feels both things at once, joy at seeing them together again, and the suspicion that this might be the last time.

The evergreen duo, a combined age of 90, forged a three-hour thriller at Arthur Ashe Stadium on Saturday. Serena and Venus led 5-0 in the final-set tiebreak. They lost anyway, to Taiwanese-Australian pair Chan Hao-ching and Maya Joint.

Four years ago, at the same venue, the 14-time Grand Slam-winning pair lost in the first round to Czechia's Lucie Hradecka and Linda Noskova. It looked like the end. Serena had already written in *Vogue* about her daughter Olympia wanting to be a big sister, about "evolving away from tennis." Adira River Ohanian was born the year after.

Back in business

Neither sister could say goodbye, though. Venus kept playing singles and returned to doubles in 2025. Serena followed in 2026. Serena's singles comeback came at Wimbledon, where Joint beat her too.

It was Olympia who pushed for the reunion. "You need to play with Auntie VV," Serena recalled her daughter saying, on *Good Morning America*. She obliged. A knee injury in her singles match kept her from pairing with Venus at SW19, but they played Cincinnati together, and got a US Open wildcard. New York got the last singles-superstar doubles team standing, one more time.

Venus steadier

Serena, rusty after four years away, showed flashes of the old forehand. She'd served superbly earlier, in the mixed doubles competition with Carlos Alcaraz. She couldn't repeat it here.

Venus was steadier, fewer unforced errors, more of the contest riding on her racquet. Chan and Joint ran away with the first set. Then Venus held serve at 2-3, broke with a volley, and the fightback was on. Serena chipped in at the net to help level things at a set apiece.

In the decider, they fell to 1-4. The crowd got louder. They clawed back, forced a tiebreak, went 5-0 up.

Then Chan and Joint remembered who they were.

Joint had now faced, and beaten, both Williams sisters inside three months. "I'm at a loss for words to think that happened," she said courtside. "She's an idol of mine. I looked up to both of them growing up in Michigan. Just to be able to play them twice is amazing."

> **"It's just really wanting my children to see me play at a different age. You can do anything at any age as long as you work hard and put some effort and dedication behind it."**
>
> **SERENA WILLIAMS,** ON WANTING TO PLAY MORE SINGLES MATCHES AT 44.

"Welcome to the Williams Show," read one poster in the stands. The crowd applauded on cue and went quiet midpoint, a rare discipline for an Ashe crowd. Noise dipped in the first set, rose once the sisters found their rhythm, dipped again on match point, then came back one more time. Flushing Meadows saying goodbye, still unsure if it needed to.

"The atmosphere was surreal," Joint said later. "It was something we've never experienced before, and to play against such legends of the game was super special."

The sisters lost. They left smiling anyway, and skipped the press conference.

Retirement question

Before the match, Venus had waved off the retirement question entirely. "I don't think I should have to," she told reporters, after a straight-sets loss to Sofia Kenin in singles. "My mind is fully focused on that: how I recover from this completely insane evening and get ready for the next one."

Serena, after her mixed doubles campaign with Alcaraz, had said much the same. "I probably will play again. I have to. After some of those returns, I think I need to play at least once."

Her daughter started this, the stepping away, and the coming back. She's also why Serena, 23 singles majors deep, isn't done yet.

"It is just really wanting my children to see me play at a different age. You can do anything at any age as long as you work hard and put some effort and dedication behind it," she said.

Until the next time, then.

Home-hope Anisimova sent packing by Potapova

Reuters
New York, September 5

Anastasia Potapova beat 10th seed Amanda Anisimova 6-2, 7-5 in the third round. AP

AMERICAN 10TH seed Amanda Anisimova went out of the US Open in the third round on Saturday, losing 6-2, 7-5 to Austrian Anastasia Potapova as she failed to recapture the magic of her run to the final a year ago.

Potapova defended 13 of the 16 break points she faced to reach the fourth round in New York for the first time, where she will play either Russian Mirra Andreeva or Czech Nikola Bartunkova.

Anisimova, a runner-up at Wimbledon last year as well, has been unable to reach a tournament final in 2026 and had a long chat with her coaches after the opening set, where Potapova broke her to love in the third game and converted on another break point chance in the seventh.

The pair traded breaks three times in a competitive second set, when the crowd at Louis Armstrong urged on the American at every turn.

But Anisimova, who had 46 unforced errors across the match, gave her opponent a leg-up when she sent a shot just past the baseline on break point in the penultimate game. Potapova absorbed Anisimova's power from the baseline in a fine final rally, clasping her hands to her mouth after the American sent the ball out again on match point.

Zheng beats Keys

Meanwhile, China's Zheng Qinwen came back from 5-0 down in the deciding set to beat American Madison Keys 1-6 7-6(3) 7-5 as she battles back from a chronic right elbow injury that has stunted her career. The 22nd-seeded Keys pulled off an escape act worthy of Houdini in the second round, saving five match points against Anna Bondar, but did not have the magic this time as she let the contest slip in the final moments.

Gasly grabs the first-ever F1 pole position in his career

Pierre Gasly stunned the favourites to grab the pole position for Alpine. AP

Reuters
Monza, September 5

FRENCH FORMULA One driver Pierre Gasly upset the favourites to grab a stunning career-first pole position with Renault-owned Alpine at the Italian Grand Prix on Saturday.

Gasly, who won at Monza with Red Bull-owned AlphaTauri (now Racing Bulls) in 2020 and lives in nearby Milan, seized pole from Mercedes's George Russell with his final effort and a lap of one minute 21.786 seconds -- 0.060 quicker than the Briton.

"It's been nine years trying to chase the opportunity to get a pole," said Gasly, who was the last of the pole contenders to complete his final flying lap. "I won my first race in Monza and got my first pole at this track. It's something special around here." Gasly had already hinted at something special in the earlier phases, leading Q1 and fourth fastest in Q2, and his mechanics erupted in jubilation as the pole was confirmed -- a day after he had been stripped of third place at last June's Monaco Grand Prix.

The pole was also the first for Renault's team since they became Alpine in 2021.

Russell, a title contender, hailed an incredible performance by the 30-year-old Frenchman in his 190th start.

"We were finishing a game of chess about 15 minutes before qualifying and he beat me there and I went 'well, I think I will beat you in qualifying' and here we are, he's ahead of me again," said the Briton.

McLaren's Oscar Piastri qualified third at the 'Temple of Speed' but was then handed a three-place drop for impeding Red Bull's Liam Lawson.

That created an all-Ferrari second row with Charles Leclerc, a two-time winner of his team's home race, directly behind Russell and teammate Lewis Hamilton in fourth after the seven-time world champion had sneaked into the final phase by the skin of his teeth -- 0.001 of a second.

Red Bull's Max Verstappen, last year's race winner, will line-up fifth with Piastri sixth. Mercedes's championship leader Kimi Antonelli, who is 59 points clear of Russell and Hamilton, qualified seventh but will go to the back due to engine penalties.

CHINA MASTERS SUPER 750

Sat-Chi look to cap off consistent runs in China with Masters title

Indian pair defeats Malaysian duo of Azriyn-Kiong with third-game surge to make yet another final in Shenzhen

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, September 5

IS SHENZHEN the new Paris? Rather, China Masters the new French? Satwik-Chirag's exceptional consistency in front of Chinese crowds, amongst the world's most astute in badminton, continues. The World No 5 pair defeated Nur Mohd Azriyn Ayub Azriyn and Tan Wee Kiong 21-16, 18-21, 21-11 to make their third China Masters final and 4th successive Last 4 finish. Perhaps it's that the duo tend to peak in August when the Olympics or World's take place and tournaments around that timeline get the best of them. This time, they will be stretched properly through September at the Asian Games. But first, they have unfinished business with the China Masters. They've made two semis and advanced to two finals before, but lost on Sundays. This time around, the Indian 4th seeds have played long matches with short endings -- the third set making you wonder why they didn't wrap it up in straights. But cometh the China Masters, cometh India's finest doubles pairing -- never mind what the rest of the season indicates.

2026 has been good for them. But Azriyn and Kiong, ranked 29th, and aged 33 and 37, didn't make it straightforward for the Indians.

As has been routine this week, the first set was pocketed without a fuss, though they started 0-5 down. The defensive blocks look seamless on days even though opponents of all rankings, ratings and resources, don't hesitate to use the drops to make the Indians bend. Azriyn and Kiong succeeded in drawing them into criss-cross battles that basically take place on a central rectangle, and in which the Indians aren't too shabby either. Still, it ended up luring them into the decider.

Problem solver

Coach Tan Kim Her, a Malaysian himself, is a good problem-solver and reads Malaysian pairs particularly well. But though Azriyn and Kiong don't come with massive pedigree, they have the usual traits of mixing things up and not allowing opponents a free pass to attack them with steep downers.

The plan was for Satwik to go on the body attack but the Malaysians didn't always view it as dreadful and hopeless, defending gamely.

A 54-shot rally - unusual in men's doubles - saw Azriyn and Kiong parry the Indian attack and push them for one smash or too many, but it ended with the Malaysians sending the shuttle long. These rivalries are very cordial and Chirag would even apologise for a net chord and get a high five, but the Indians didn't seem to be troubled too much till the end of the second when they got into catch-up mode at 12-13 down, and couldn't close out.

Satwik would later say, "It's the story of this whole week. We have been playing the first game easily, then the second game, 15-all, 16-all. It happened against the Popovs in the second round, then quarters again.

Satwik-Chirag will face Chinese pair of He Ji Tung and Ren Xiang Yu in the final. BADMINTON PHOTO

Today also the same scenario." He didn't seem to mind though. "It's fine. It's a good tournament for us on our comeback. We wanted those crucial matches before the Asian Games. We want to get that feel, that confidence. Even when we are 16, 18-all ... like yesterday we were down and then we won. We want to get that kinda practice. One more final here. Shenzhen has been really special."

Chirag reckoned that nobody really fancied getting dragged into the third, but it was good they were able to come back when down. "Glad that even after losing the second set we could bounce back in third and finish comfortably," he said.

Like the match against the Popovs, the third set turned lopsided because the Indians had too much firepower and weren't going to suffer too much resistance as they pushed a gear and got the job done. Azriyn and Kiong have never played a Super 750 Tour final, and the gulf in capability showed.

The question of why they haven't won China Masters yet persists.

Last year, it was a loss to Koreans Seo Seung-jae and Kim Won-ho in straight sets. The Korean great Seo had combined with Jin Yong and defeated the Indians in the 2024 semis.

The Chinese current World champs, Liang-Wang had broken Indian hearts in 2023 with a start to finish lead in the third set of the 2023 final.

Home challenge

On Sunday they will need to get past the Chinese pair of He Ji Tung and Ren Xiang Yu (who have in fact reunited after the shuffle in 2024). The Indians are still smarting from a loss in the World's and have an Asian Games campaign up ahead, though this might well be their second 2026 title after Singapore. But a Super 750 win playing a home pair in front of a home crowd might be a good time to solve the nagging mystery of China Masters.

"Go back. Recover. Wake up. See how the body feels. But we will push 100 percent," Satwik promised.

City win three in a row; Liverpool register first victory

Reuters
Manchester, September 5

MANCHESTER CITY made it three wins from three but were relieved to hear the final whistle as they beat promoted Coventry City 1-0 in the Premier League on Saturday.

Crystal Palace earned their first victory of the campaign as they twice came from a goal down to win 3-2 at Fulham but four other games ended all square.

Newcastle United recovered from a two-goal deficit to draw 2-2 at home to Bournemouth who scored first for the third game in a row but are still without a victory.

Tottenham Hotspur picked up their first point of the season but failed to have a shot on target in a 0-0 draw at Nottingham Forest who had a goal ruled out by VAR for handball.

Brighton & Hove Albion drew 1-1 at home to Leeds United, while Brentford versus Sunderland also finished 1-1.

After Manchester City's eye-watering spending spree that continued until Tuesday with the arrival of Argentina midfielder Enzo Fernandez from Chelsea for a British-record-equalling £125 million ($169.01 million), Coventry might have feared the worst.

Enzo debuts

Manager Enzo Maresca handed debuts to Fernandez and fellow deadline-day signing Iliman Ndiaye .

Fernandez played a key role in Erling Haaland's 26th-minute opener at The Etihad Stadium, sliding a pass for Antoine Semenyo, whose cross the Norway striker headed in.

Erling Haaland (R) scored the only goal for Manchester City. AP

Haaland also had a goal ruled out but it was Coventry who finished strongly and an equaliser would not have flattered Frank Lampard's side who forced City goalkeeper Gianluigi Donnarumma into a string of saves.

City hung on though to lead the table with nine points.

The newly- promoted side Hull City could also reach nine later on Saturday night if they beat Aston Villa and join City while champions Arsenal and Chelsea, the other teams with a 100% record after two rounds of fixtures, meet on Sunday at The Emirates Stadium in London. Coventry and Fulham remain without a point after three games, while Villa will hope to get their points tally up and running when they travel to surprise package Hull.

• KEY RESULTS

Newcastle	2-2	Bournemouth
Brentford	1-1	Sunderland
Nottm Forest	0-0	Spurs
Man City	1-0	Coventry
Fulham	2-3	C Palace
Brighton	1-1	Leeds

• BRIEFLY

Uruguay's former coach Marcelo Biesla with team during WC. AP

Uruguay name star-studded squad for India friendly, Valverde included

REAL MADRID star Federico Valverde will headline a star-studded Uruguay squad named for next month's international friendly against India, with the two-time world champions, led by head coach Diego Forlan, bringing a formidable mix of established internationals and emerging talents. India will take on Uruguay at the Vivekananda Yuba Bharati Krirangan on October 6, as part of a high-profile series of international friendlies. Valverde is among several marquee names in the Uruguay squad, which also includes Rodrigo Bentancur, Lucas Torreira, Giorgian de Arrascaeta, Facundo Pellistri, Maximiliano Araujo and Brian Rodriguez. The defence boasts plenty of international experience, with Ronald Araujo, Jose Maria Gimenez, Nahitan Nandez, Guillermo Varela, Mathias Olivera and Sebastian Caceres named in the squad. PTI

ISL to kick off on Oct 10 in home-and-away format

THE INDIAN Super League will kick off on October 10 and run through May 2027, returning to its traditional home-and-away format for a marathon eight-month league. Last season, the ISL was played in a truncated single-leg format in a short window after being delayed by administrative and commercial uncertainty. The 2026-27 edition will be staged in a new club-led era, with 163 matches scheduled across eight months of competition. PTI

Indian Women's League to begin on October 16

THE NEW season of the Indian Women's League, the country's top-tier women's competition, will kick off next month, the All India Football Federation said on Saturday. The season will begin on October 16, with six clubs from last season -- East Bengal FC, Sethu FC, Kickstart FC, Nita FA, Gokulam Kerala FC and Garhwal United FC -- joined by promoted sides HOPS FC and Juba Sangha FC. The IWL-2 group stage will start on October 23. PTI

Infantino turns up at Under-20 Women's WC

FIFA PRESIDENT Gianni Infantino has arrived at the opening of the Under-20 Women's World Cup as he faces continuing pressure since abandoning his plan to sell off World Cup profits. Infantino was seen in the stands speaking with Polish soccer federation president Cezary Kulesza as host nation Poland faced Argentina on the opening day. AP

Shreeniti wins twin World Tennis jr titles

LOCAL FAVOURITE Shreeniti Chowdhury capped a remarkable week at the KSLTA World Tennis Junior J30 Bengaluru by winning both the girls' singles and doubles titles here Saturday. The 15-year-old fourth seed first overcame fellow city mate Aahida Singh 6-4 6-2 in the singles final and returned to play with Riddhi for doubles. PTI

Liverpool top exec Hughes steps down

RICHARD HUGHES has stepped down from his role as Liverpool sporting director, becoming the latest high-ranking executive to depart the Premier League club recent months. Hughes is leaving less than two months after Michael Edwards exited as CEO of football for Liverpool. AP

Guendouzi banned for two CL games

MATTEO GUENDOUZI was banned by UEFA from Fenerbahce's first two Champions League games for provocations in a heated playoff win at Lyon in his native France. Guendouzi was at the heart of incidents before and after Fenerbahce's 2-1 win and entry to the UCL. AP

• FOCUS ON THE WORLD CHAMPION

Anand's advice to Gukesh amid slump: It happens to everybody... he can cope

Mayank Chaudhary
Bengaluru, September 5

IN LESS than three months, D Gukesh defends his world title against Uzbek challenger Javokhir Sindarov, in Geneva. It looks harder than the first time.

In 2024, against Ding Liren, Gukesh was at his peak. Fresh off the Candidates. Fresh off a gold medal at the Chess Olympiad in Budapest. Ding was inactive for months before that match, struggling with form, struggling with something more than form. This time the script has flipped. Gukesh is the one in deep water. Sindarov looks better every tournament he plays.

So which is harder: winning the title, or keeping it?

Viswanathan Anand has done both, five times over. To him the distinction matters less than what each one demands of you.

"What Gukesh is experiencing, I've experienced a couple of times. But he's experiencing it for the first time. You have no idea why the world refuses to work like it used to. You're working as hard as you think. You want it as hard as you think. But the world is just not bending like it used to," Anand said, ahead of the 2026 Global Chess League in Bengaluru.

"The only thing I could tell him is that it happens to everybody. For him, I think it will just be the challenge of dealing with this rather than it being his first time," he added.

Familiar feeling

Anand knows the feeling from the inside. Years where nothing worked and the effort never matched the result. What got him through wasn't one fix. It was smaller wins, spread across formats, the reassurance that classical chess going badly didn't mean everything was going badly.

"I had moments of shattering heartbreak a couple of times when I was 22, 23, 24. Not as prolonged, not as intense. But I was also playing a wider variety of tournaments. So inevitably, you'll get a good result. I was playing rapid tournaments in those days, and those would compensate for everything. Even if I was slumping in classical, I would do well in rapid and feel good about myself again," Anand said.

"It doesn't matter what age you're dropped into the deep end of the pool. You will learn to swim fast, or you'll splash around till you reach the surface and find something to hold on to. Maybe I was in a calmer place when I really got into crisis. But I think he can cope."

Gukesh Dommaraju will face challenger Javokhir Sindarov in the World Championships match. CGM

There's no formula, Anand admits. At some point you just stop trying to explain it. "What I did was to accept at some point that there's no point trying to understand what's happening. We try to understand what's happening, make cause and effect, organise things. But there comes a point when you feel relieved enough to accept the result. Both when it then turns around, it feels good. But sometimes it doesn't turn around. That's how it is."

> **"I don't know what I should tell him. The strength is there. It couldn't have gone away. But something in the state of mind, sadly, we don't know how to fix that."**
>
> VISWANATHAN ANAND, ON GUKESH'S STRUGGLES

"I don't know what I should tell him. The strength is there. It couldn't have gone away. But something in the state of mind, sadly, we don't know how to fix that. All of us have discussed motivation enough, but it's not very easy to explain."

Before Geneva, there's Samarkand. Gukesh leads India's Olympiad title defence there, on ground that has been kind to him before: 18 points from 21 matches across the last two editions, a 9.0/10 in Budapest with a performance rating of 3056. Individual gold both times. Team bronze in 2022, gold the edition after.

He hasn't won a tournament since becoming the youngest world champion in history. Samarkand could be the jolt he needs.

Would one tournament be enough? Anand thinks it wouldn't take even that much.

"There's no pattern as to what makes me happy. Some unexpected gift in a tournament is all I need. Because in my mind, I'm not playing badly. I deserve to. In my mind, the universe is not cooperating. When I get lucky, I think, yeah, finally it is. This is how it should be. Self-deception is what we're good at. We will find some way of picking our events that's favourable. That's where excuses come from too, trying to say that it was not your fault. He could be incredibly happy with one game and that might change his mood. It doesn't matter. As long as you feel better, that's all that matters," Anand said.

THE WRITER IS IN BENGALURU ON THE INVITATION OF THE GCL

Pipers start GCL with a win over Mumba Masters

DEFENDING CHAMPIONS Alpine APL Pipers were pushed to the limit by CheQ Mumba Masters, but wins from Vidit Gujrathi and Koneru Humpy with the black pieces earned them two crucial extra points as the Magnus Carlsen-led side started their 2026 Global Chess League campaign with a 10-8 victory in Bengaluru. However, the day belonged to Fyers American Gambits, who thrashed both PBG Alaskan Knights and Triveni Continental Kings to register two dominant wins on the opening day. Ganges Grandmasters delivered an upset in a closely fought contest against the Kings, as the most successful team in GCL history began their campaign with two consecutive losses. ENS

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SCREEN | PAGE 3

The divine and the popular

Actor-dancer Shobana on making Bharatanatyam accessible by adapting the classical dance to newer formats

SPOTLIGHT | PAGE 4

For Chef Vanshika Bhatia, less is more

VIRTUALLY A WINNER

Esports is no longer a fad. It's here to stay and do the victory lap with scores of fans behind it. ***Mayank Chaudhary*** *was in Paris for the 2026 Esports World Cup to see the commercial juggernaut unfold*

AT FIRST glance, it was nothing more than a well-crafted piece of wood with 64 squares alternating between dark walnut and pale maple. No built-in sensors, no RGB backlighting and no trace of software or code. It was a plain and simple chessboard. And yet, within hours of two signatures being inked across its surface, the auction price had surged past $20,000.

So, who were the names behind those signatures? Lee 'Faker' Sang-hyeok and Jeong 'Chovy' Ji-hoon, two of South Korea's finest esports athletes, whose hands are far more familiar with the click of a mouse and the tap of a keyboard than the touch of a chess piece. They had faced each other in a symbolic match during the 2026 Esports World Cup (EWC) in Paris, two weeks ago, a meeting that bridged the age-old, quiet world of chess with the fast-paced, digital high-stakes universe of League of Legends, the annual professional world championship. And when the board was put up for auction as a prized collectible for fans, the bidding turned out to be a frenzy.

To understand why a signed chessboard can fetch the price of a decent sedan anywhere in the world, one has to look beyond the wood and ink. It will take understanding how sports fandom has reinvented itself in a space that was a niche not long ago.

For the uninitiated, the dismissive label has remained unchanged for over a decade. Esports was a fad for many. A novelty, an entertainment gimmick and a speculative bubble blown by tech money. Legacy sports traditionalists still felt the need to ask when the "craze" would cool off.

But the numbers tell a different story. The devotion is quite real. And nowhere is that more visible than in the pull of its biggest names.

When Faker lands in a city like Paris, Seoul and Los Angeles, the crowd that forms and the security that follows are no different from that flanking a Lionel Messi or a Virat Kohli. He is the 'Unkillable Demon King', a player who has outlasted the brutal cycle of a sport where most careers are over by the time players hit their mid-20s, where reflexes fade fast and replacements are always waiting.

Chovy, on the other hand, is a great technician. The one who bends game mechanics to his will with a precision that would make a Grandmaster nod in approval. His every move is dissected with the same seriousness that once surrounded Garry Kasparov's opening prep over the board or Pep Guardiola's tactical plans on a football pitch.

So when these two put their signatures on a piece of wood, putting big money on it isn't about the object itself. It's about being part of that generational rivalry, the years of memory. The stories that millions of fans have invested in. And that, more than any chip or monitor, is what makes esports untouchable. The frenzy around the Faker-Chovy board is simply a microcosm of what the Esports World Cup has become. What began as an ambitious multi-genre gaming festival has evolved into an undeniable commercial juggernaut.

Numbers don't lie

The 2026 edition brought together 25 competitions, over 2,000 players, and an impressive $75 million (approx Rs 712 crore) prize pool, all spread across nearly 50 days.

Consider the calendar. A Summer Olympics wraps up in just over two weeks. The FIFA World Cup is done in under a month. Even the drawn-out marathon of an ODI Cricket World Cup seldom stretches beyond six weeks. The Esports World Cup in Paris ran for seven straight weeks.

As the city eased from the early-summer tourist rush into the sleepy heat of August, the tournament barely paused. Pulling off an event of that length is a logistical nightmare. But it also says something about the audience, one with an appetite and attention span that traditional sports executives often assume younger crowds have lost.

The numbers for the Paris event are staggering. The tournament was broadcast across more than 100 platforms in 47 languages, backed by roughly 5,000 co-streamers and creators. Over the event's run, the official numbers say it reached 850 million viewers globally, up 13 per cent from 2025, generating 440 million hours of watch time. During the League of Legends clashes featuring Faker and Chovy, peak viewership hit 4.3 million, numbers that stack up comfortably against a Grand Slam tennis final.

Online metrics are always up for debate. Physical footfall, however, is harder to dispute. Across the competition halls, over 175,000 match tickets were sold in Paris, nearly double the previous year's count. Add the outdoor fan zones, venues and city-wide activations, and Paris recorded two million in-person visits.

By the final weekend, the overwhelming ticket demand for the Counter-Strike championship meant that it had to be shifted into the 20,000-capacity Accor Arena, the same venue that regularly hosts NBA Paris games and major rock concerts.

Alongside PUBG Mobile, chess drew the most interest at EWC for the Indian audience. A $1.5 million prize pool was second only to the Grand Chess Tour among chess events. Over four days, Indian Grandmasters Nihal Sarin and Arjun Erigaisi each took home $75,000 despite falling short of the semifinals. Nihal, India's leading speed chess player, believes the integration of chess into the esports ecosystem is a positive step for the game's growth. "At the end of the day, the sport has to be marketed. I think faster formats are much more viewer-friendly," he said.

India fielded its biggest-ever contingent in Paris, with S8UL and GodLike as partner clubs in the Club Partner Program. S8UL competed in chess, Apex Legends, Fortnite, and Honor of Kings, among others. Meanwhile, GodLike's biggest Indian representation came in PUBG Mobile, where they and Orangutan made history as the first Indian teams to qualify for the Grand Finals.

The Paris move

When rising tensions in West Asia put Riyadh's hosting status in doubt, Paris emerged as the natural alternative. Mike McCabe, COO of the Esports Foundation, said the strong ties between Saudi and French governments helped but the real reasons ran deeper. "France has an incredible heritage for global esports events. League of Legends Worlds, Call of Duty Majors, Rocket League Worlds, all have been here recently," he said.

He added that Paris was almost a turnkey solution, with the city's muscle memory from hosting the 2024 Olympics, making it easier to welcome athletes from around the world. And Paris delivered big time.

Nassim, a local Parisian couldn't help but notice, "We can see the promotion, the marketing, it's really huge. Even if you are not from the esports community, you can see it in the streets... the billboards of the event and it's happening for so many weeks that reflects the scale of this event."

Fans, rivalry, chaos

A tournament only earns the right to be called a World Cup when fans empty their bank accounts, cross oceans and bring the spirit of their hometowns into the playing arena. In Paris, that pulse was felt nowhere better than in the vibrant collision between Myanmar and Brazil. Yangon Galacticos, the defending PUBG Mobile champions, arrived with a vocal contingent that had made the 9,000-kilometre journey from Yangon, Myanmar. Waiting for them were the travelling faithful of Brazil's Alpha7 Esports, the 2024 champions eager to settle an old score.

The Brazilians brought an entire carnival in their carry-on luggage. Armed with surdo drums, whistles and feathered carnival headwear, their section even paraded a trio of uncanny lookalikes dressed as Neymar, Vinícius Júnior and R9 Ronaldo to lead the terrace choreography. What had been a fierce feud confined to smartphone screens for years suddenly materialised into living, breathing theatre. As the match lobby prepared to load, the hallway dissolved into an impromptu battle of chants. The Myanmar supporters countered the relentless samba beat with synchronised cadence, trading banter and smiles across the barricades before the tension gave way to shared fist-bumps and group selfies. It was loud, chaotic and colourful.

Ritual of defeat

Every sporting culture invents its own sacred rituals to make heartbreak tangible, and the Esports World Cup found its answer in cold, unyielding steel.

Beside each arena stage stands a heavy hydraulic crusher, packing the brute force of seven elephants, whose sole purpose is theatrical finality. In competitive gaming, defeat is usually plain and simple. Here, it ends with a physical execution.

Every qualified player receives an engraved inner Key, and when a player or a team is eliminated, it must be surrendered to the victor. The winner marches to the hydraulic press, places the rival's key under the piston, and watches it crumple into twisted scrap. Yet, the ritual is less about humiliation than creating lasting folklore.

For an industry often dismissed as ephemeral pixels, this is a deliberate push toward myth-making. It turns virtual heartbreak into a physical one, ensuring that every contender leaves a permanent mark.

The initial hook

To pull in casual crowds, the tournament leaned on traditional sports icons like veteran footballer Karim Benzema and tennis standout Nick Kyrgios joined Formula 1 driver Pierre Gasly and NBA champion Giannis Antetokounmpo. The strategy paid off on the ground. Two young brothers from London, Ori and Itai, convinced their father to make the trip across the Channel solely to meet Antetokounmpo. "We don't know anything about the Esports World Cup," Ori admitted, flashing his phone wallpaper featuring the 'Greek Freak'. Yet, once inside the arena, the spectacle hooked them so completely that they persuaded their father to extend their stay in Paris.

That shift in perspective was not limited to young fans. James Kleban, who travelled from Dallas with his French mother and cousin, spent his weekend absorbing the festival atmosphere and brushing shoulders with pro players in the concourses. For his mother, the scale and legitimacy of the event dismantled lingering scepticism. While initially surprised that players usually represent commercial clubs rather than national flags, learning about the upcoming Esports Nations Cup shifted her entire outlook. Once hesitant about esports as a viable career, she left the venue actively encouraging her son to take his gaming seriously.

When an NBA Most Valuable Player draws spectators through the gates and the arena floor convinces sceptical parents of the sport's future, the cultural transition is hard to deny. Traditional heroes may provide the initial hook but the digital stage is proving powerful enough to hold the room on its own terms.

EWC

EXPRESS PHOTO

CLICK TO CAROUSEL

At the EWC in Paris this year, the city turned into a carnival of screens and cheers, with fans turning up from across the globe

THE WORD THIS WEEK

How to read Gloria Steinem

GLORIA STEINEM, who passed away in New York at the age of 92, was a journalist, a social movement organiser, co-founder of *Ms.* magazine, and one of feminism's most recognisable voices internationally. But, she was, first and last, a writer, and it is through her prose, wry and unflinching, that her particular brand of activism endures while offering insight into her self-interrogating brand of feminism. Those seeking to understand the woman behind the aviators should check out these five works.

Outrageous Acts and Everyday Rebellions

STEINEM HAD the unique ability to be furious and funny at the same time. This collection of essays opens with her account of going undercover as a *Playboy* bunny, documenting the humiliating uniforms, petty fines and sexual surveillance that passed for glamour. For the uninitiated, this is the place to start, a primer in Steinem's blend of reportage and memoir, and polemic.

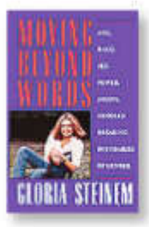
Revolution from Within: A Book of Self-Esteem

SHE CALLED this her most misunderstood work. It is easy to see why. In an era of street-level protest, a book about self-esteem seemed a retreat into therapy. However, Steinem postulates that external liberation without internal healing is hollow. Drawing on psychology and her own memories, she traced how low self-worth is a cage of its own. She reframed self-worth as a collective resource rather than an exercise in narcissism.

My Life on the Road

THIS AUTOBIOGRAPHY-cum-travelogue is anchored by anecdotes from her two years in India and her later return to meet the freedom fighter Kamaladevi Chattopadhyay. Interspersed are also tales of bad diner coffee and lost luggage, small moments that humanise the icon and reveal a woman of endless curiosity. It is a reminder that Steinem's feminism was on the road, in conversation with strangers, as opposed to the seminar room.

Moving Beyond Words



IN THIS essay collection, Steinem plays the role of an intellectual provocateur. She imagines a 'conference' where women run the global economy; she scrutinises the medical establishment's dismissal of female pain; she eviscerates the beauty industry as a trillion-dollar confidence trick. Though written in the 1990s, its critiques of corporate feminism and performative inclusion remain prescient.

Doing Sixty and Seventy

PUBLISHED IN 2006 as two linked essays, this slim volume tackles what Steinem called the last great feminist taboo: old age. She dismisses the 'invisibility' trope, arguing instead that post-menopausal women are society's most liberated cohort — free, at last, from the male gaze and finally permitted to speak their minds.

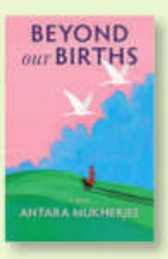
AISHWARYA KHOSLA

QUICK VERDICT

HIT

Border Lands

ANTARA MUKHERJEE'S debut novel, *Beyond our Births*, comes with strong socio-political commentary on how the circumstances of birth shape the trajectory of one's life. The Kolkata-born writer sets her novel in the '90s, when Nimki, an orphan abandoned at the India-Bangladesh border as a five-year-old, finds refuge with the Senguptas in Kolkata. But finding refuge does not mean belonging; Nimki is treated as the domestic help. She yearns for love from the family matriarch Bina Ma, who works with an NGO for displaced women and children. Juxtaposed against Nimki's struggles is the life of Ira, the Senguptas's daughter. After Ira becomes the target of sexual assault, the family decides to move out of the country for a fresh start.



BEYOND OUR BIRTHS
BY ANTARA MUKHERJEE
Bloomsbury Publishing
272 pages
₹599

The novel deals with identity. Nimki discovers that she is not only Muslim but that she was abandoned by her birth family in Bangladesh. Her journey takes off when she leaves India to seek them. Read against the backdrop of the recent SIR in West Bengal, where more than 90 lakh names were deleted from the rolls, much of them Muslim, *Beyond Our Births* is a poignant first book.

REVA THAKKAR

MISS

Same Old, Same Old

IN A market glutted with Japanese and Korean 'healing fiction', Satoshi Yagisawa's *More Days at the Torunka Cafe*, newly translated by Eric Ozawa, is a sleep-inducing, inert placebo. The novel follows the same tired recipe: World-weary customers, each nursing some private wound, serendipitously drift into a humble cafe that dispenses epiphany with a side of coffee. Where Toshikazu Kawaguchi's *Before the Coffee Gets Cold* allowed readers to reckon with their regrets through a time-travelling cafe and Hiro Arikawa's *The Travelling Cat Chronicles* had readers sobbing over the loyalty of its feline narrator, Yagisawa's story is an anaemic, formulaic sequel lacking heart, written only to tap into the popularity of its predecessors. The stories drag, and the dialogue is utterly bland. It fails to replicate the quaint charm of his *Morisaki* series, which offered a certain emotional resonance. Those expecting a balm for the agitated soul or a rendezvous with their inner selves through the book will be disappointed.

MORE DAYS AT THE TORUNKA CAFE
BY SATOSHI YAGISAWA
TRANSLATED BY ERIC OZAWA
Manila Press
224 pages
₹499

AISHWARYA KHOSLA

HIT

The Ghosts We Inherit

MISHU GREW up in her grandmother's story-filled presence. As an adult, with her New York life unraveling, she returns home to Kolkata, when her grandmother, Niyoti, slips into a coma.

Set in Calcutta, London and New York, Pia Ghosh-Roy's debut novel *And I Am the Arrow* follows three generations of women from the Chatterjee family — Mishu, her mother Ira, and her paternal grandmother Niyoti — and their servant Bani as they navigate their complex relationships, even as they find themselves interacting with the spirit of a dead man, who refuses to be called a ghost.

AND I AM THE ARROW
BY PIA GHOSH-ROY
Pan Macmillan
200 pages
₹599

The novel reflects on the intergenerational trauma passed down, intentionally or unintentionally, and the scars left behind by the people one loves. It uses multiple points of views to unfold the narrative, giving a glimpse into the minds of each character and keeping the story engaging. These are women who are flawed, and make hasty life-altering decisions, just like any of us. A recommended read to explore not just the Chatterjee women's family dynamics, but also to introspect your own.

ANUSREE K C

History's Insider Outsider

Eric Hobsbawm made a career of explaining the world's contradictions. In The Age of Hobsbawm, *Emile Chabal shows how the Marxist historian's own life was riddled with them*

Murari Tripathi

THE AGE OF HOBSBAWM: THE LIFE OF A REVOLUTIONARY HISTORIAN
BY EMILE CHABAL
Belknap Pr
480 pages
₹3,600

HISTORY CAN be cruel to the historian himself. For decades, Eric Hobsbawm was the undisputed titan of Marxist historiography, translating the mechanics of global capital into thrilling prose. Yet, the great champion of the marginalised was a man of bourgeois contradictions: a lifelong communist enjoying the comforts of the British academic establishment, and an anti-imperialist funding his research projects through US capitalism.

In his 2002 memoir, *Interesting Times*, Hobsbawm curated a meticulous image: An intellectual forged in the anti-fascist street battles of 1930s Berlin. In his biography, *The Age of Hobsbawm*, Emile Chabal uses the very tools Hobsbawm worshipped, the archives, to dismantle this mythology. Chabal poses a question: If Hobsbawm wrote a memoir, why did we need this biography? He argues that Hobsbawm was emotionally incapable of telling the whole truth about his adult life.

To grasp his enduring global grip, one must understand how he wrote. Championing 'history from below', he rejected the heavy and neutral tone of the academy. He explicitly declared his bias, arguing that true intellectual honesty meant putting your convictions on the table. This unapologetic stance produced his famous *Ages* series, a four-volume history of the 19th and 20th centuries. His immense popularity was secured by the mechanics of the publishing industry. Armed with a massive distribution deal, his paperbacks and translated editions sold like those of a pop star.

However, his ideological devotion exacted a heavy toll. When Soviet tanks rolled into Hungary in 1956, shattering the moral compass of the global Left, Hobsbawm defended the brutal military invasion as a "tragic necessity." While peers found it indefensible and left, Hobsbawm remained a 'loyal communist.' As his political survival in Britain became difficult, he found resurrection in the intellectually vibrant networks of Italian Eurocommunism, which helped salvage his academic momentum.

Yet, the champion of the working masses harboured a disdain for the actual culture those masses consumed. Inhabiting the centres of British academia while insisting on his marginality, he was an "insider's outsider." He later dismissed the Beatles as a fad of "haircuts", loathed Bob Dylan as a product of mass civilisation, and sneered at identity politics. He loved the proletariat in the abstract but recoiled from its modern realities.

This ideological safari was absurd in Latin America. Bankrolled by Rockefeller, he parachuted into Peru and Colombia for three-week excursions. He championed a Peruvian military dictatorship simply because it promised land reform, brushing off polite rebukes of local intellectuals, who suggested the professor prioritised fantasies over reality. Chabal provides a haunting coda: the very haciendas Hobsbawm romanticised as hotbeds of noble "primitive rebels" were soon burned to the ground by a Maoist insurgency his framework failed to anticipate.

History repeatedly outran the historian, nowhere more distinctly than in India. Hobsbawm instrumentalised Antonio Gramsci's subaltern politics globally, but remained deeply cautious of its application outside Europe. Introduced to the subcontinent via elite Cambridge networks, his Eurocentric theories of the 'pre-political' peasant were swiftly dismantled by Ranajit Guha and the Subaltern Studies school. The Indian subaltern critique took Gramsci's ideas further than Hobsbawm ever dared, proving that colonial India's marginalised were political actors.

Yet these criticisms, including Irfan Habib's on the transition debate, proved no barrier to institutional hegemony. Long after the vanguard moved on, Hobsbawm became the immovable god of the Delhi University and JNU syllabi. A fixture of postcolonial statecraft, his influence culminated in a 2004 hero's welcome and breakfast with then Prime Minister Manmohan Singh. He did not understand India, but he undeniably conquered its classrooms. Back in Britain, he inadvertently birthed his own nemesis. By warning that the working class was fracturing in a prophetic 1978 lecture, the lifelong Communist unwittingly provided the intellectual toolkit for Tony Blair's New Labour, accidentally engineering the political centre he had spent his life trying to overthrow.

Chabal also charts his evolving view of nationalism: viewing it first as a middle-class illusion, then diagnosing it as a dangerous modern religion, and finally warning the Left that it was a toxic force they could never control. Utilising his identity as a Jewish refugee who fled the Nazis, he attacked the foundations of Zionism, proving that for him, nationalism was a trap no matter who sprang it.

Chabal's biography ends on a note of profound melancholy. When the Soviet Union collapsed in 1991, Hobsbawm could not bring himself to face this heartbreak, retreating instead into whataboutism. Privately, he confessed to an old comrade they were "prehistoric survivors... like the lungfish." Chabal unearths a staggering psychological block: The great historian actively avoided researching the Holocaust because, as a Jewish refugee who lost his family, it was 'too difficult to face emotionally.' His celebrated final works, including *The Age of Extremes*, were not objective history, but acts of therapy. Ultimately, Chabal captures the tragedy of a historian incapable of confronting his own. Meticulously researched, this brilliant biography will undoubtedly tempt you to read Hobsbawm for yourself.

ILLUSTRATION: SUVAJIT DEY

Despite being a champion of the working masses, Hobsbawm harboured a disdain for the actual culture those masses consumed

In Other Tongues, Other Wonders

Vivek Shanbhag's translation venture aims to bring India's many literary traditions into conversation with one another, and with the wider world

Paromita Chakrabarti

VIVEK SHANBHAG has a suggestion on how translations ought to be read — simply as literature. "We read Russian or Latin American literature as literature, even though much of it reaches us in translation," he says. "We should do the same with writing from Indian languages."

The Kannada novelist and playwright has some authority on the subject. His 2013 Kannada novella *Ghachar Ghochar*, translated into English by Srinath Perur in 2015, travelled far beyond the language in which it was written, finding readers who encountered it as a work of literature in its own right. The book was longlisted for the International Dublin Literary Award in 2017, was a finalist for the LA Times Book Prize the same year, and won Perur the Sahitya Akademi Translation Prize for English in 2020. Now Shanbhag, 64, wants to make that journey possible for more writers. His answer is *Hyphen*: a literary journal, publishing house and digital platform rolled into one that intends to bring Indian-language writing into a wider conversation.

Shanbhag insists that *Hyphen* did not arrive as a sudden inspiration, that it grew out of conversations that his team had been having with "literary friends in Kannada and other Indian languages." "Hyphen was not an epiphany," he says, "It is an idea that has grown over decades, born out of a need to understand how writers in Indian languages are responding to the political, social and economic changes, larger concerns and conflicts of our times."

Much of *Hyphen*'s DNA can be traced to Shanbhag's seven years editing *Desha Kaala*, the Kannada literary magazine that introduced readers to Tamil, Hindi, Bengali and Marathi writers, including Jeyamohan, Uday Prakash and Meena Kandasamy. That editorship, he says, "made me realise two things. First, the diversity of styles and traditions across Indian languages is extraordinarily rich and distinctive. Second, discovering these writers is difficult when one cannot encounter their work first-hand." The process of scouting new work for the magazine was always "a long and pleasurable journey" — the team "invariably discovered unexpected gems along the way." But it was not without its share of frustrations. Some of the writers *Desha Kaala* championed took decades to reach English-language readers. "Imagine how much richer our literary conversations would have been if these works were available in English 20 years ago, when they first appeared in *Desha Kaala*," says Shanbhag. *Hyphen*, in effect, runs the same experiment in the opposite direction — except its target language is not Kannada but English, and its intended audience is not one linguistic community but the larger world. "As direct translations between Indian languages have steadily declined, English has become the most effective way to access the literature of other Indian languages," he says.

The scale of the ambition explains why *Hyphen* exists as three institutions rather than one, all housed under the Bahuvachana Trust. "*Hyphen*'s objective is to offer a fuller literary experience through these distinct ways of engaging with readers," says Shanbhag. The print journal, he explains, brings together "a rich diversity of writing, allowing readers to explore and reflect at their own pace," while the website adds articles, book reviews, poetry, fiction, plays and interviews through the week. The publishing house, meanwhile, takes on the longer, slower work of bringing full-length books into English and "places them within a larger publishing ecosystem." "No previous initiative has attempted to bring India's diverse literary traditions together on this scale and place them within a shared global conversation," says Shanbhag.

Hyphen launches amid unusual global attention to Indian-language writing — Geetanjali Shree's Tomb of Sand, translated into English by Daisy Rockwell, won the International Booker Prize in 2022, the first novel translated from Hindi to do so; Banu Mushtaq's *Heart Lamp*, translated from Kannada by Deepa Bhasthi, won it in 2025. But Shanbhag is wary of mistaking a prize cycle for lasting change. Awards illuminate their winners, he says, but that attention becomes durable only when readers have access to a range of writers; when it enables Indian-language authors to enter literary conversations on their own terms, rather than being wheeled out periodically as translation's success stories. There are, he insists, "many world-class writers working in Indian languages who deserve to be read" for their ideas, worldview and craft. *Hyphen*'s task is to make sure readers finally get the chance.

Cover of *Hyphen*; Vivek Shanbagh

A QUICK WORD

- One Indian-language book you wish more people had read in translation?
  Marali Mannige, a Kannada novel by Shivaram Karanth
- A language you would love to see more translated into, not just from?
  Bengali
- Translator or author — whose name should appear bigger on the cover?
  Both names in equal size
- The hardest word or phrase you have ever had to let go of in translation?
  Ghachar Ghochar
- *Desha Kaala* or *Hyphen* — which was harder to start?
  ***Hyphen*. Because of its complexity and scale.**
- One myth about translation you would like to bust?
  That translation can be taught and that knowing a few rules is enough to make a good translator.

'Divinity does not cancel entertainment'

In an exclusive interview, actor and dancer Shobana talks about making Bharatanatyam appealing to a new audience, bridging cinema and classical dance and her famed aunts, the Travancore sisters

Suanshu Khurana

DURING A performance at Delhi's Indira Gandhi Sports Complex last week, actor and Bharatanatyam dancer Shobana walked onto the proscenium, turned into the court of Janaka, the king of Mithila. This was the scene of *Sita Swayamvaram* — the episode from the Ramayana where his daughter Sita's suitors compete to lift Shiva's mighty longbow — with a comic twist. As various kings took turns, contemporary film music replaced the expected classical score. When the peppy *Ravana* from the NTR Jr-starrer Telugu film *Jai Lava Kusa* (2017) played, Shobana, as one of the suitors, made her entrance with a cocky flourish, channeling Ravana's swagger. The melody amplifies the comedy. There is inevitable falter, much to the audience's delight, who burst into laughter. Then she becomes Rama, serene and composed, lifting the bow and splitting it in two. The music shifts to *Seetha kalyana vaibhogame*, 18th-century saint Tyagaraja's popular *kriti* (creation) that celebrates the wedding of Rama and Sita and is played at weddings even today.

Shobana's performance was part of South Side Story, a festival otherwise alive with rock, rap, contemporary sounds and

> The strongest claim to historical authenticity of Bharatanatyam lies with the hereditary performing communities. After that, change is inevitable. That is not a criticism. It is how an art form remains alive

the attendance of Gen Z, making Bharatanatyam an unexpected presence in the lineup. Two years in a row.

"It is unquestionably a divine and ritualistic art form, but divinity does not somehow cancel entertainment. The two are not mutually exclusive," says Shobana in an exclusive conversation with *The Indian Express*. She adds that if a platform created space for someone in Delhi to watch a south Indian classical dance performance for the first time and leave with an interest in knowing more about it, then that is already "a meaningful contribution to the growth of the art."

"When the audience connects with art, irrespective of whether they are familiar with the form or not, it becomes a meaningful experience for an artiste," she says.

In a career spanning four decades, Shobana has inhabited distinct artistic worlds that often do not intersect naturally. She is a National Award-winning actor, well regarded in Malayalam and Tamil cinema. She also has a significant career as a Bharatanatyam dancer. This ability to move between the classical and the popular has been the hallmark of Shobana's journey that has often brought the two ideas together.

IN STEP WITH THE TIMES
Actor and dancer Shobana; (left) as Nagavalli in *Manichitrathazhu*

On stage, she integrates the actor into the dancer. She uses theatre, popular music and humour to contemporise traditional stories. Her Bharatanatyam is accessible, even to an audience not part of the classical circuit. She has used electronic beats, presented the Ramayana through the perspective of Ravana with English dialogues and voiceovers, danced to spoken-word poetry in *Krishna* besides showcasing Balinese dance aesthetics and presenting sharp social commentary on dowry in *Shyama*.

"Everybody adapts dance for the medium it is presented in. Cinema adapted it for the camera. Today, people adapt it for social media. The form changes because the frame changes," says Shobana, who has often drawn criticism from purists for her approach. "Perhaps, what people mean is a clarity of form, clean lines. Technical precision, maybe, and some adherence to a recognised vocabulary," she says. "But to call that purity is a misappropriation of the word." She points out that Bharatanatyam, as we recognise it today, is a comparatively modern term compiled around the time of Indian Independence into a movement vocabulary and performance structure called the *margam*. Indian dance has continued to move forward since. "The strongest claim to historical authenticity lies with the *nattuvanars* (traditional dance masters) and hereditary performing communities, including the *devadasis*. After that, change is inevitable. Our gurus changed it. Their gurus changed it. We have changed it. Our students will change it again. That is not necessarily a criticism. It is how an art form remains alive," says Shobana.

Born into a family steeped in the arts, Shobana was introduced to Bharatanatyam early and trained under some of its finest practitioners. Her lineage includes her three aunts, the Travancore sisters: Lalitha, Padmini and Ragini. Padmini was among the most celebrated dancers and actors of her generation who also found attention through Raj Kapoor's *Mera Naam Joker* (1970). But it was her eldest aunt Lalitha, who actually taught her dance as a child. "It was 1975 and the way she used to lure me... dangling a bright green dance costume she had stitched for me, and saying, 'If you want to wear this, you have to dance'," says Shobana, who also trained under the Bharatantyam exponent, Chitra Visweswaran.

Padmini was already married and had left India before Shobana was born. It was during the shooting of Malayalam film *Udayam Padinjaru* (1986) in the US that Shobana stayed with her and the two bonded. Shobana was 16 then. "She was just my *appachi*. One thing I have understood from all the great artistes is that they are all humble," says Shobana, who began acting at nine. Her first lead role came at 14 with Balachandra Menon's *April 18* (1984).

In her long cinematic journey, Shobana

> Everybody adapts dance for the medium it is presented in. Cinema adapted it for the camera. Today, people adapt it for social media. The form changes because the frame changes

has moved fluidly across Malayalam, Tamil and Telugu cinema and worked with leading filmmakers, including Adoor Gopalakrishnan, Priyadarshan and Mani Ratnam. Her notable performances include *Rudraveena* (1988), *Innale* (1990), *Thalapathi* (1991) and *Manichitrathazhu* (1993), in which her dual role as Ganga and her alter ego Nagavalli won her the National Award. She won the coveted honour again for Revathi's *Mitr, My Friend* (2002) for her portrayal of a lonely Indian homemaker in the US searching for an identity. She took a break from acting, returning in 2020 with *Varane Avashyamund*, all the while running her dance school Kalarpana Institute of Bharatanatyam in Chennai.

For her contribution to the arts, Shobana was also awarded a Padma Bhushan in 2025. She won a Padma Shri in 2006.

Shobana made a rare appearance in the political arena. While she stated she was "just an actor with my own hopes and dreams" and was not going to be in active politics, in April 2024, weeks before the Lok Sabha election, she publicly endorsed BJP candidate Rajeev Chandrasekhar in Thiruvananthapuram. Chandrasekhar, then a former Union Minister of State for Electronics and Information Technology, lost to Congress's Shashi Tharoor by a narrow margin. Shobana also attended Prime Minister Narendra Modi's campaign programme and later described meeting him as a "huge fan moment."

WITH INPUTS FROM ANUSREE K C

WAR AND LOVE
A still from *The Revolutionaries*

In the shoes of rebels

Pratibha Ranta and Rohit Saraf on discovering forgotten freedom fighters in The Revolutionaries

Alaka Sahani

SOME FREEDOM fighters are etched into public memory; others remain buried in its footnotes. For actors Pratibha Ranta and Rohit Saraf, being part of Nikkhil Advani's upcoming series, *The Revolutionaries*, became an introduction to the latter. Ranta and Saraf, who essay the characters of Pratibha Lahiri and Sachindra Nath Sanyal respectively, were previously unfamiliar with the two revolutionaries who, alongside Rash Behari Bose and Bagha Jatin, fought against British rule in the early 20th century.

Preparing for the series, which is inspired by Sanjeev Sanyal's book *Revolutionaries: The Other Story of How India Won Its Freedom*, meant not just learning about that period in history but also delving into the lives of people whose stories have largely remained outside the mainstream narrative of India's freedom struggle.

"I was blown away by their courage. Even after a setback, they would regroup and fight again," says Ranta.

Considered to be a master of disguise, Bose planned the 1912 bomb attack on British Viceroy Charles Hardinge during a procession in Delhi as well as organised the failed 1915 nationwide armed revolt in British military cantonments. Known for his fearlessness, Jatin was the founding member of Jugantar, a secret revolutionary society in Bengal.

Sanyal was the founding member of the Hindustan Republican Association and was a close associate of Bose. Lahiri, who was married to Sanyal, supported the freedom movement through underground networks. *The Revolutionaries*, scheduled to premiere on September 11 on Prime Video, features Bhuvan Bam as Bose and Gurfateh Pirzada as Jatin.

"Since there isn't much information about Pratibha Lahiri, we had a lot of room to play around with her character. Nikkhil sir and the team had read about so many young women revolutionaries and studied what they were like and what characteristics we could pick from them," says Ranta, who was praised for her performance in *Laapataa Ladies* (2023) and *Heeramandi* (2024).

Much like Lahiri, Sanyal's story remains largely undocumented. "We could take this character and build him the way we wanted to — from his looks to the way he talks and what he believes in," says Saraf, who made his big screen debut with *Dear Zindagi* (2016), followed by *The Sky Is Pink* (2019) and *Ludo* (2020) and the series *Mismatched*.

Saraf had to go through a physical transformation to play Sanyal. "His character was written as the most able *pehelwan* in his *akhada*. Nikkhil sir said: 'I need you to look like Brad Pitt from *Fight Club*,'" says Saraf, who trained in mallakhamb and kalaripayattu while preparing for the role.

While Ranta didn't have to undergo physical training, even though the poster shows her wielding a gun, she had to crack the comic timing. Advani's tip for her was to "imagine Sridevi from *ChaalBaaz*." Instead of copying Sridevi, Ranta tried to be "honest to the feelings" of her character and truthfully depict what was on the script. "I wondered how it would feel to be in that period, when you leave everything behind and fight for your country," she says.

Singling out a scene, Ranta talks about how the show also examines the societal issues of the period. In the scene, Lahiri tells Sanyal how a woman's struggle for freedom begins the moment she is born. "Moments like this give the show a contemporary touch," says Ranta.

Even as the series explores the interpersonal relationships between the four leads, the romantic relationship between Sanyal and Lahiri gives *The Revolutionaries* an additional emotional layer. Saraf says, "We have managed to do something (as an on-screen couple) that's convincing. Even outside the love story, Pratibha has an incredible arc and I have my own track."

United by the unpredictable

Netflix's Gandhari *marks writer Kanika Dhillon's foray into action films and actor Taapsee Pannu's return to the genre, reuniting them for a story driven by emotion and physicality*

Alaka Sahani

AFTER STAYING away from action films for nearly nine years, actor Taapsee Pannu was eager to return to the genre. But she was clear about not repeating what she had done in her previous movies. Her long-time collaborator, screenwriter-turned-producer Kanika Dhillon knew what the actor was looking for. She came up with *Gandhari*. Dhillon gave Pannu a five-line narration about a mother's extraordinary fight to rescue her kidnapped daughter. That was enough to convince the actor for their sixth collaboration, an emotionally-charged action drama set in the fictional town of Joypurra.

"When I became a mother, the greatest emotion I felt was fear for the safety of my child. That made me wonder: To what extent can a mother go to protect her child? That became the emotional core of *Gandhari*," says Dhillon. Released on Netflix on Thursday, *Gandhari* marks Dhillon's foray into action films as a screenwriter.

Pannu, who has previously done *Baby* (2015) and *Naam Shabana* (2017), is fairly well-versed with what is required to do an action thriller. Since the action sequences in *Gandhari* are raw and shoots were intensive, it required a different kind of preparation. "I had to shoot action scenes for 12 hours at a stretch every day. My endurance had to be high enough for me to recover within the limited time I had. That was what I focused on," recalls Pannu, who practises aerial yoga regularly.

To essay the character of Bani, who suffers a head injury while chasing her daughter's kidnapper and loses her vision, Pannu had to undergo additional training. "Someone who had experienced similar

WHEN WAVVELENGTHS MATCH
Taapsee Pannu (left) and Kanika Dhillon; (above right) a still from *Gandhari*

> For her character who loses her vision after a head injury, Pannu was trained by someone who experienced the trauma

blindness was appointed to teach me how this particular kind of traumatic blindness works — how much one can see and how it changes with time as the nerve recovers. I was also taught how to move around physically, how to walk, climb stairs and turn," says Pannu. These movements were incorporated in the action choreography of the film which was shot in Maharashtra's Bhor.

From their first collaboration *Manmarziyaan* (2018) to talked-about *Haseen Dillruba* (2021) and now *Gandhari*, this actor-writer partnership has thrived on creating unconventional women characters. Dhillon believes Pannu's strength lies in her ability to inhabit characters, who refuse to be neatly categorised and willingness to give her best to make her performance compelling.

"What makes grey female characters, written by Kanika, stay with the audience long after the film is over is their authenticity. A section of the audience will hate Rumi of *Manmarziyaan* and Rani of *Haseen Dillruba*. Some will love them. But they cannot ignore these characters. That's because they're just so real and unapologetically grey," says Pannu. *Gandhari*, directed by Devashish Makhija, captures Bani's refusal to give up, even when odds are stacked against her.

There is a deep understanding that binds Dhillon and Pannu together in their creative pursuit. For Dhillon, the element of "surprise" is central to their partnership. "Taapsee surprises me with every character she takes on. That's why I come to her with my stories," she says. What they have in common is a passion for telling different stories and surprising their audiences. The writer shares that the whole idea is to push each other to get more exciting stories.

Their dark sense of humour has also made their collaborations delightful. "At least she can understand my humour and not get offended and vice-versa. Our talks, if somebody else is hearing us, might sound crazy," says Dhillon. In spite of that, they do have their disagreements. "We both are opinionated. We agree to disagree, at times, over silly things. It's a sign of a healthy partnership," says Pannu.

Building with Scarcity

Chef Vanshika Bhatia on making do with little and why she runs a restaurant that behaves like a home kitchen

Heena Khandelwal

LONG BEFORE zero waste became a term she had been associated with, before Le Cordon Bleu, before Noma and Gaggan and a decade in some of the world's most feted kitchens, chef Vanshika Bhatia was a 13-year-old in Kanpur being punished with a dinner order for 10.

"My mom sent me to fetch an ingredient and I didn't know where it was. As punishment, I had to make dinner for 10 people that day," she recalls, laughing. That first forced meal — dhoti dal (moong dhuli dal), a quick pyaaz-tamatar ki sabzi and a few attempted rotis before her mother and sister took over — is, in hindsight, the origin of everything that followed. Together at 12th, her first restaurant; Petit Pie Shop, the country's only dedicated pie shop; her three-year run as chef partner at the all-vegetarian, all-Indian-ingredient Omo; and now Gram Street, the coffee-and-croissant brand she opened three months, before giving birth.

Cooking at home was never forbidden territory. "As soon as we could reach the stovetop, it was, make the tea and bring it," she says. Baking began as a way of dealing

CHEF AT HOME

with board-exam stress. "My elder sister taught me to bake my first pound cake; she gave me a cookbook. Soon people started gifting me cookbooks — I would finish one before moving to the next. I finished 10-12 that year, before my mother hid them all before the boards," she says, now sitting in her Gurugram living room with a cup of tea — her first break since flying in from Kanpur that morning with her husband and two-month-old son, ordering in momos for lunch, and pulling up BlinkIt for the last few things she needs for her mum's signature dish, which she's preparing for this interview.

But to pursue culinary science formally, she had to put up a fight, her elder sister being the one fighting her case. The sisters won. Bhatia went to Le Cordon Bleu in 2012, and the rest, as they say, is history. She also met her husband at a food fest.

What sets her home cooking apart from her restaurant cooking isn't technique — it's memory. Bhatia belongs to the Bannuwali community, descendants of the Valbhatiya clan who migrated from Bannu, now in Pakistan, and settled largely across Uttar Pradesh after Partition. It's a cuisine built around scarcity: nothing thrown away, everything dried or pickled.

"Resources were so little you couldn't afford to waste anything. The cuisine just became like that." She grew up eating these dishes, but only started documenting them during lockdown in 2020, craving *ghar ka khana* while stuck in Gurugram. "I tried to Google recipes and found nothing, and that is when I realised this is specifically our home food." She called her *nana* and *dadi* and a few cousins, mostly for the non-veg recipes — in her grandmother's generation, only men cooked and ate meat and always outside home.

A favourite is Andhi Kukdi, which literally translates to "blind chicken" but has nothing to do with chicken. It is a dish made from leftover roti boiled down with black pepper, water, and ghee, invented by mothers who told hungry children to close their eyes and imagine they were eating chicken. "Now it's a delicacy for us — something we make out of nostalgia." Alongside it sits Tukkar, leftover roti cooked with onion, tomato, and a fiery *tadka*, eaten at breakfast with dahi and green chillies, and Arbi wala mutton to make a bigger pot of sabzi with a smaller portion of mutton. "It tells you about the times."

Her research trips took her to a hill in Nagaland, where a variety of sticky millet grows, and to a farm in Coorg, who had never hosted a stranger before

Today, she is recreating her mom's dahiwala chicken, which gets done under 45 minutes, with minimal ingredients and one skillet. "I have added cardamom, but traditionally it's just onion, ginger, garlic, green chillies, pepper and salt. It was made with chicken on the bone, but I have adapted it to boneless," she says. The result is a comforting, tangy, and velvety dish that is polished off with fluffy *angaare wali* rotis, coming to the plate right off the stove.

That instinct for using everything runs into her professional identity too. It's why, at Omo, where she was chef-partner, she insisted on sourcing every ingredient from within India — the olive oil, the chocolate, the cheese. It's why her research trips, later formalised as "Omo Adventures", took her to a hill in Nagaland, which has a variety of sticky millet that grows nowhere else, and to a farm in Coorg run by a family who had never hosted a stranger before her. "You can't go in acting like you are a chef who already knows everything," she says, still watching the skillet, stirring in the chicken and finally adding the *dahi*. Her husband, who has also invested in Gram Street Coffee, takes over parenting duties while we talk.

Motherhood has changed the shape of her ambition. A restaurant she had spent two years planning has been quietly shelved. "After having my baby, my passion for cooking was dying a bit because I had turned it into a business," she says.

She worked at Gram Street until her ninth month of pregnancy, resting only in the final two weeks on her doctor's advice, and returned almost fully after her 45-day rest period.

To keep the hot-kitchen passion alive while she works up to a full restaurant again, she has decided to host small, invite-only tables for five or 10 people out of her base kitchen in an industrial pocket of Gurugram — no fixed calendar, no intention to scale. "Not really even to sell. Just for the passion of it." A restaurant that behaves like a home kitchen: open only when she feels like cooking.

Meanwhile, her hands are also full with Gram Street Coffee, which opened its second outpost this week. She is now eyeing a third one. While the purple coffee made from blueberry milk has taken over the internet, their flaky bakes are just as good, and they also travel well.

ABHINAV SAHA

LESS IS MORE
Chef Vanshika Bhatia checking the dahiwala chicken at home in Gurugram

Dahi wala Chicken

INGREDIENTS

750g–1kg chicken
4 onions
2 green chillies
4 tsp ginger garlic paste
2 cardamom pods
1 bay leaf
200g yogurt
Ghee
Salt and pepper

METHOD

- Make a rough paste of the onions and green chillies
- To a pan, add ghee, cardamom, and bay leaf. Add the onion paste and roast for five minutes
- Add the ginger garlic paste and cook for 10 minutes
- Add salt, pepper, and chicken. Cover and cook till the chicken is tender
- In the end, add the yogurt, mix well, and adjust seasoning. Garnish with coriander leaves

ADVERTORIAL

The Strangest Rules in the Sky

Board, sit, land - that's the illusion. Behind it, mountains, borders, and the earth's curve write rules stranger than fiction.

Neil Patil
Founder, COO & CTO, Veena World
neil@veenaworld.com

Last week, we spoke about how a hotel room tells you everything about a country before you have even unpacked. Today I want to turn our attention somewhere else entirely: planes, and the strange rules that govern how, where, and whether they can actually land.

I will be honest about why. I am a flight nerd. If you have been following my Instagram, you already know how deep I go into this stuff, the routes, the runways, the aircraft. And ever since we launched flight bookings on veenaworld.com, that habit has only gotten worse. I have been falling down rabbit hole after rabbit hole on the odd corners of commercial aviation, and I started collecting these stories individually, one flight here, one airport there, before realising they actually belong together. Each one answers the same question in a completely different way: what decides how a plane gets from one point on earth to another. Let me walk you through a few.

The Captain-Only Landing

Innsbruck sits inside a valley in the Austrian Alps, boxed in by nine-thousand-foot peaks on almost every side. There is no vertical guidance beam here, the radio signal that normally tells a pilot's instruments the correct angle to descend at, feeding them a steady glide path all the way down to the runway, the terrain blocks it, so pilots fly the descent using a beacon and their own judgement, banking through the valley largely by feel. There is exactly one way in and one way out, and which one you use depends entirely on the wind that day. Add Alpine downdrafts that can arrive without warning, and Innsbruck has one of the highest flight diversion rates in Europe every winter.

Because of this, regulations require that only the captain, never the first officer, is allowed to fly the approach into Innsbruck, and only after specific training for this exact airport. At EasyJet, reportedly, fewer than four per cent of pilots hold that qualification, and some airlines require the captain to have first sat in the jumpseat for a live approach before flying the route themselves.

The scenery, ironically, is what makes the approach so demanding. Pilots track visually along the Inn Valley, following the terrain by eye, precisely because the same mountains that make the landing beautiful make a straightforward instrument approach impossible. For the pilot, it is one of the most demanding approaches anywhere in Europe. For the passenger, it is one of the most beautiful landings in the world, snow peaks close enough to touch the wingtip, a medieval city rising out of the valley floor. Difficult for the pilot. Unforgettable for you.

The Runway on the Roof of the World

If Innsbruck asks a lot of the pilot, Lukla in Nepal asks even more. Tenzing-Hillary Airport, as it is officially known, sits at nearly nine and a half thousand feet in the Khumbu region, the main gateway for trekkers heading towards Everest Base Camp. Its runway is just 527 metres long, a fraction of the length most commercial airports consider standard, and it slopes uphill at a gradient of roughly twelve per cent, steep enough that the incline itself helps slow the aircraft down after landing and helps it gather speed on the way out. One end of the runway meets a mountain wall. The other ends in a sheer drop into the valley.

There is no room here for a go-around. Once a pilot commits to the final approach at Lukla, there is no option to pull up, circle, and try again the way there would be almost anywhere else in the world. The decision has to be made earlier, and it has to be final. Only small, specially certified aircraft fly the route, mostly Twin Otters and similar short-takeoff planes, and flights operate strictly by visual rules, which means the moment cloud or mist rolls in, and it does so quickly and often in the Himalayas, every flight simply stops until it clears. Despite all of this, close to fifty flights a day move through Lukla in peak season, because for most trekkers it is this or a fortnight of walking simply to reach the point where the actual expedition begins.

The Flight That Got Four Hours Longer Overnight

Since 2022, one flight route has quietly gotten hours longer, and most passengers flying it have no idea why.

Helsinki to Tokyo used to take around nine and a half hours, flying more or less straight across Russia, the shortest path the earth's curve allows between Europe and Japan. Since Russia closed its airspace to Western airlines, and the West closed its skies to Russian ones, that flight now takes closer to thirteen hours, arcing north over Scandinavia and out over the Arctic and Alaska to avoid Russian skies entirely.

It is not weather. It is not technology. It is a border in the sky that simply did not exist for these airlines a few years ago, and it now costs every passenger several extra hours, on every single flight, indefinitely. Over 3,60,000 flights a year used to cross Russian airspace before 2022, according to European aviation regulators. Almost none of them do now. The map of the world has not changed. The sky above it has.

The Flight With No Economy Class

Here's one that has fascinated me for a while. Singapore Airlines flies the longest scheduled nonstop passenger route in the world, Singapore to New York, close to nineteen hours in the air, covering more than fifteen thousand kilometres. And there is no economy class on it at all. Only business class and premium economy.

The reason comes down to fuel. Covering that distance nonstop requires an enormous amount of it, and every kilogram the aircraft carries is weight it must lift and hold for nineteen straight hours. So the airline made a calculated trade: every economy seat removed is weight saved and range gained. Fewer, larger seats mean the aircraft can carry the fuel needed to make the distance in one stretch. The flight is so long the airline can no longer afford to sell the cheap seat that makes most long-haul routes viable in the first place.

Which makes this possibly the hardest bucket-list flight in the world to book cheap. No economy fare to chase, no seat sale to wait for. Once aboard, the airline treats the journey less like transport and more like a stay: three full meal services, cabin lighting shifted gradually to nudge your body clock towards New York time, crews rotating through dedicated rest areas because no one is expected to stay sharp for nineteen hours straight. Depart Singapore in the evening, and thanks to the International Date Line, you land in New York earlier the same calendar day you left. Somewhere around hour eleven, it stops feeling like a flight and starts feeling like a hotel moving at nine hundred kilometres an hour, forty thousand feet above the Pacific.

Why Your Flight Path Looks Wrong on the App

Next time you check a flight tracker, look at the route from Delhi to New York, or London to Los Angeles. It does not run straight across the map. It arcs up towards the Arctic. That is not a mistake, and it is not a longer route either. It is actually the shortest one.

A flat map lies to you. The earth is a sphere, and you cannot flatten a sphere onto paper without distorting it, which is exactly what every map projection does. So a straight line on your phone screen is almost never the shortest real-world path. Pilots fly what is called a great circle route. Stretch a piece of string across a globe between two cities and pull it tight, and that curved-looking path on a flat map is actually the straight line, on the sphere. It only looks curved because the map is flat and the world is not.

This single fact saves airlines thousands of kilograms of fuel on every long-haul flight. The plane is not taking the scenic route. It is taking the only straight line that actually exists.

The Runway Made of Frozen Ocean

McMurdo Station in Antarctica is the busiest aviation hub on the entire continent, and for much of the season, its runway is frozen ocean, compacted and groomed sea ice, strong enough to hold aircraft the size of a C-17 Globemaster on ordinary wheels. No tarmac, no concrete, just ice thick enough not to crack under the weight.

The ice has to be constantly monitored, because if it thins, or the season turns warmer than expected, the runway simply stops existing. Some aircraft here do not use wheels at all. The LC-130 Hercules flies with retractable skis instead, and the crews who operate it have nicknamed it the skibird. There is no permanent, fixed airport at McMurdo in the way we would normally understand one. The runway itself shifts and gets rebuilt from scratch each year, on whatever ice will hold. It is, as far as I can tell, the only place on earth where the runway is seasonal, and where a successful landing depends entirely on how cold the planet has been that year.

The Flight With No Destination

And finally, my favourite of these, a flight that takes off, flies for around twelve hours, and lands back at the exact same airport it left from.

Qantas runs this from Brisbane, Melbourne, Perth, and Sydney, straight down towards Antarctica and back, with no landing on the ice at all. Passengers get two boarding passes for the one flight, because halfway through, everyone swaps seats so that both sides of the aircraft get a turn at the window. Around four hours of the journey is spent flying directly over Antarctica itself, mountains, ice shelves, a landscape almost nobody on earth ever sees in person.

These flights actually stopped entirely for over a decade after a tragic accident in 1979, when an Air New Zealand sightseeing flight crashed into Mount Erebus, killing everyone on board. Qantas did not resume Antarctic overflights until 1994, this time with far stricter protocols and satellite navigation that did not exist the first time around. Today, it is considered one of the most extraordinary day trips available anywhere. You fly to the bottom of the earth and you are home again in time for dinner.

What Connects All Seven

Each of these stories is really about the same quiet tension. A flight looks, from the outside, like the simplest thing in modern travel. You board, you sit, you land. But behind almost every unusual route or runway is a specific, hard constraint deciding everything else, a mountain, a border, a curve of the earth, an ocean. Innsbruck and Lukla solve it through the pilot. Singapore Airlines solves it through the cabin. Helsinki-Tokyo solves it through distance. McMurdo solves it through nature. Qantas solves an entirely different problem, seeing without landing at all. We treat a flight as the dullest part of travel. These seven say otherwise. See you next week…

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